“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 5

Determining the Truth of Śrī Nityānanda

(English translation from the Bengali, following the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition and the Anubhāṣya, 2026)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya

Summary. In the fifth chapter the glory of Śrī Nityānanda is described in five verses, as follows. Śrī Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself; His *vilāsa-mūrti*, that is, His second body, is Śrī Balarāma. Beyond *prakṛti* there is a spiritual abode called “Paravyoma,” and in its highest part lies “Kṛṣṇaloka.” In Kṛṣṇaloka are Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula; there abides the original *catur-vyūha*: Kṛṣṇa, Baladeva, Pradyumna (that is, Kāmadeva) and Aniruddha. The abode in Vṛndāvana within that Kṛṣṇaloka is called “Śvetadvīpa.” Below Kṛṣṇaloka is the Vaikuṇṭha called “Paravyoma,” where four-armed Nārāyaṇa, the *vilāsa-mūrti* of Kṛṣṇa, resides. He who is Baladeva in Kṛṣṇaloka is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa (*mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*). His *vilāsa-mūrti* in the Vaikuṇṭha of Paravyoma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. By the *cit-śakti* of this Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa everything made of *śuddha-sattva* in Paravyoma is manifest, and by His *jīva-śakti* pure jīvas dwell there; *māyā-śakti* has no place there. In the abode of Nārāyaṇa is the second *kāya-vyūha*. Beyond Paravyoma lies “Brahmaloka,” the abode of effulgence. Beyond it is the Causal Ocean (*Kāraṇa-samudra*), filled with spiritual water. On the far shore of the Causal Ocean lies māyā, untouched by it. In the Causal Ocean is Mahā-Viṣṇu, the original *puruṣa-avatāra*, a part of *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*. From afar He casts His glance (*īkṣaṇa*) upon māyā. And by a semblance of His body (*aṅgābhāsa*) — something that appears to be His body but is not — He unites with māyā as the material cause. *Māyā* herself, as the material cause (*upādāna-kāraṇa*), is called “*pradhāna*,” and as the efficient cause (*nimitta-kāraṇa*), “*prakṛti*.” The original efficient cause of material *prakṛti* is the glance of Mahā-Viṣṇu; *prakṛti* is therefore only a secondary efficient cause.

This same Mahā-Viṣṇu, lying in the Causal Ocean, enters the aggregate universe as Garbhodaśāyī, and enters each universe and each jīva as Kṣīrodaśāyī. The Kṣīrodaśāyī Puruṣa manifests a Vaikuṇṭha in each universe and resides there as Viṣṇu, the Paramātmā, the Īśvara and so on; in the waters of the universe He lies on the bed of Śeṣa. He is the father of Brahmā, and one part of Him is conceived of as the Virāṭ. In each universe a "Śvetadvīpa" is manifest in the Ocean of Milk, and Viṣṇu resides there. Thus two Śvetadvīpas are manifest: one in Kṛṣṇaloka, and the other in the Ocean of Milk of every universe. The "Śvetadvīpa" of Kṛṣṇaloka is nondifferent from the Vṛndāvana there; it is the land of certain supplementary pastimes of Kṛṣṇa. Śeṣa within the universe serves Viṣṇu by becoming His umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, dwelling, sacred thread, throne and so on. The Baladeva of Kṛṣṇaloka is Prabhu Nityānanda Himself; He is therefore *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*. Hence Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of Paravyoma and His *puruṣa-avatāras* are the parts and portions (*aṁśas* and *kalās*) of Nityānanda Prabhu.

In this chapter the author has included an account of his journey to Vṛndāvana and of how he attained complete perfection there. From it we learn that he formerly lived in the village of Jhāmaṭapura near Naihāṭī, in the region of Kāṭoyā. There were two brothers. Śrī Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, an associate of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, came to his house at his invitation and was displeased with the priest, Guṇārṇava Miśra. The brother of Kavirāja Gosvāmī took the priest's side and did not acknowledge the glory of Śrī Nityānanda. For this Śrīla Kavirāja Gosvāmī rebuked his brother. Rāmadāsa broke his flute and left, and Kavirāja Gosvāmī's brother was at once utterly ruined. That same night, in a dream, Kavirāja Gosvāmī received the grace and the command of Śrī Nityānanda Prabhu, and on the very next day he set out for Vṛndāvana.

By the mercy of Nityānanda one comes to know the true nature of Nityānanda

—

বন্দেঽনন্তাদ্ভুতৈশ্বর্য্যং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দমীশ্বরম্ ।
যস্যেচ্ছয়া তৎস্বরূপমজ্ঞেনাপি নিরূপ্যতে ॥ ১ ॥

vande 'nantādbhutaiśvaryaṁ
I bow of endless wondrous opulence (possessed)
śrī-nityānandam īśvaram
Śrī Nityānanda the Lord
yasyecchayā tat-svarūpam
by whose will His true nature
ajñenāpi nirūpyate
by an ignorant one even is described

1 I bow to the Lord Śrī Nityānanda, whose divine opulence is endless and wondrous. By His will even a fool can come to know and describe His true nature.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow to the Lord (*Īśvara*) Nityānanda, whose majesty is endless and wondrous. By His will even a fool is able to describe His true nature.

Anubhāṣya.
yasya (Nityānanda's) **icchayā** (by the mercy) **ajñena** (by one unversed in the scriptures) **api** (even [by me]) **tat-svarūpam** (the truth of Nityānanda) **nirūpyate** (is described), **tam anantādbhutaiśvaryam** (Him whose majesty is endless and wondrous, that is, who possesses a majesty beyond place, time and circumstance) **īśvaram** (the God of gods) **śrī-nityānandam ahaṁ vande**.

জয় জয় শ্রীচৈতন্য জয় নিত্যানন্দ ।
জয়াদ্বৈতচন্দ্র জয় গৌরভক্তবৃন্দ ॥ ২ ॥

jaya jaya śrī-caitanya jaya nityānanda
glory glory to Śrī Caitanya glory to Nityānanda
jayādvaita-candra jaya gaura-bhakta-vṛnda
glory to Advaitacandra glory of Gaura the devotees to the multitude

2 Glory, glory to Śrī Caitanya! Glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Advaitacandra! Glory to all the devotees of Gaura!

In six verses the truth of Gaura, in five verses the truth of Nityānanda —

এই ষট্‌শ্লোকে কহিল কৃষ্ণচৈতন্য-মহিমা ।
পঞ্চশ্লোকে কহি নিত্যানন্দতত্ত্ব-সীমা ॥ ৩ ॥

ei ṣaṭ-śloke kahila kṛṣṇa-caitanya-mahimā
in these six verses I have told of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya the glory
pañca-śloke kahi nityānanda-tattva-sīmā
in five verses I tell of the truth of Nityānanda the full extent

3 In these six verses I have told of the glory of Kṛṣṇa Caitanya; in five verses I now tell the whole truth of Nityānanda.

The truth of Baladeva —

সর্ব্ব-অবতারী কৃষ্ণ স্বয়ং ভগবান্ ।
তাঁহার দ্বিতীয় দেহ শ্রীবলরাম ॥ ৪ ॥

sarva-avatārī kṛṣṇa svayaṁ bhagavān
of all avatāras the source Kṛṣṇa Himself Bhagavān
tāṁhāra dvitīya deha śrī-balarāma
His second body Śrī Balarāma

4 Kṛṣṇa, the source of all avatāras, is Bhagavān Himself, and Śrī Balarāma is His second body.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
His second body: the *vilāsa* body of Śrī Kṛṣṇa.

একই স্বরূপ দোঁহে, ভিন্নমাত্র কায় ।
আদ্য কায়ব্যূহ, কৃষ্ণলীলার সহায় ॥ ৫ ॥

eka-i svarūpa doṁhe, bhinna-mātra kāya
one and the same nature of the two different only the bodies
ādya kāya-vyūha, kṛṣṇa-līlāra sahāya
the first bodily expansion of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes the helper

5 The two are one in nature; only Their bodies differ. Balarāma is the first expansion of Kṛṣṇa's body and His helper in His pastimes.

Kṛṣṇa is Gaura; Balarāma is Nitāi —

সেই কৃষ্ণ — নবদ্বীপে শ্রীচৈতন্যচন্দ্র ।
সেই বলরাম — সঙ্গে শ্রীনিত্যানন্দ ॥ ৬ ॥

sei kṛṣṇa — navadvīpe śrī-caitanya-candra
that Kṛṣṇa in Navadvīpa Śrī Caitanyacandra
sei balarāma — saṅge śrī-nityānanda
that Balarāma with Him Śrī Nityānanda

6 That Kṛṣṇa is Śrī Caitanyacandra in Navadvīpa, and that Balarāma is Śrī Nityānanda, who is with Him.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Baladeva is the first *kāya-vyūha* of Kṛṣṇa, that is, an expansion of His body; He assists Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes. That same Kṛṣṇa descended in Navadvīpa as Śrī Caitanyacandra, and Śrī Balarāma, the first *kāya-vyūha*, came with Him as Śrī Nityānanda.

Explanation of the seventh of the fourteen opening verses: Nityānanda, or Baladeva, is the whole whose parts are Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lords who lie in the waters of the Causal, Garbha and Milk Oceans, and Śeṣa — (a verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

সঙ্কর্ষণঃ কারণতোয়শায়ী
গর্ভোদশায়ী চ পয়োঽব্ধিশায়ী ।
শেষশ্চ যস্যাংশকলাঃ স নিত্যা-
নন্দাখ্যরামঃ শরণং মমাস্তু ॥ ৭ ॥

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ kāraṇa-toya-śāyī
Saṅkarṣaṇa Kāraṇodakaśāyī
garbhoda-śāyī ca payo 'bdhi-śāyī
Garbhodakaśāyī and Kṣīrodakaśāyī
śeṣaś ca yasyāṁśa-kalāḥ sa nityā-
and Śeṣa whose portions and parts He Nityā-
nandākhya-rāmaḥ śaraṇaṁ mamāstu
-nanda named Rāma refuge my may be

7 “Saṅkarṣaṇa, the Lord who lies in the Causal Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Garbha Ocean, the Lord who lies in the Ocean of Milk, and Śeṣa are His portions and the parts of His portions: may that Rāma who is called Nityānanda be my refuge.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[1]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

May Nityānanda-Rāma be my shelter — He whose parts and portions are Saṅkarṣaṇa, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodaśāyī, Payobdhiśāyī and Śeṣa.

Anubhāṣya.

saṅkarṣaṇaḥ (Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa in Paravyoma), **kāraṇa-toya-śāyī** (the original *puruṣa-avatāra*), **garbhoda-śāyī** (the second *puruṣa-avatāra*, Hiraṇyagarbha, the aggregate Viṣṇu), **payo ’bdhi-śāyī** (the third *puruṣa-avatāra*, who lies in the Ocean of Milk, the individual Viṣṇu), **śeṣaḥ** (Anantadeva) — **yasya aṁśa-kalāḥ**, **saḥ nityānandākhya-rāmaḥ** (Baladeva) **mama śaraṇam astu**.

The mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa Baladeva serves Kṛṣṇa in five forms —

শ্রীবলরাম গোসাঞি মূল-সঙ্কর্ষণ ।
পঞ্চরূপ ধরি’ করেন কৃষ্ণের সেবন ॥ ৮ ॥

śrī-balarāma gosāñi mūla-saṅkarṣaṇa
Śrī Balarāma Gosāñi the original Saṅkarṣaṇa
pañca-rūpa dhari’ karena kṛṣṇera sevana
five forms assuming He performs Kṛṣṇa’s service

8 Śrī Balarāma Gosāñi is the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. Assuming five forms, He serves Kṛṣṇa.

আপনে করেন কৃষ্ণলীলার সহায় ।
সৃষ্টিলীলা-কার্য্য করে ধরি’ চারি কায় ॥ ৯ ॥

āpane karena kṛṣṇa-līlāra sahāya
Himself He performs of Kṛṣṇa’s pastimes assistance
sṛṣṭi-līlā-kārya kare dhari’ cāri kāya
of the pastime of creation the work He does assuming four bodies

9 He Himself assists Kṛṣṇa in His pastimes, and in four other bodies He carries out the work of creation.

In four forms — for creating the spiritual and the material, for maintenance, for entering into creation and so on — and as Śeṣa, in ten bodies, He serves —

সৃষ্ট্যাদিক সেবা, তাঁর আজ্ঞার পালন ।
'শেষ'-রূপে করে কৃষ্ণের বিবিধ সেবন ॥ ১০ ॥

sṛṣṭy-ādika sevā, tāṁra ājñāra pālana
creation and the rest service His order's carrying out
'śeṣa'-rūpe kare kṛṣṇera vividha sevana
Śeṣa in the form of He performs Kṛṣṇa's manifold service

10 His work of creation and the rest is service done at Kṛṣṇa's command; and as Śeṣa He serves Kṛṣṇa in many ways.

Anubhāṣya.
The five forms of Śrī Balarāma: 1) Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, 2) Kāraṇodaśāyī, 3) Garbhodaśāyī, 4) Kṣīrodaśāyī and 5) Śeṣa.

সর্ব্বরূপে আস্বাদয়ে কৃষ্ণ-সেবানন্দ ।
সেই বলরাম — গৌরসঙ্গে নিত্যানন্দ ॥ ১১ ॥

sarva-rūpe āsvādaye kṛṣṇa-sevānanda
in all forms He tastes of Kṛṣṇa's service the bliss
sei balarāma — gaura-saṅge nityānanda
that Balarāma Gaura's companion Nityānanda

11 In all these forms He tastes the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa. And that same Balarāma is Nityānanda, the companion of Gaura.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śrī Balarāma, the first *kāya-vyūha*, may be called the original Saṅkarṣaṇa (*mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*). For He assumes five forms and serves Kṛṣṇa in them: as a part (*aṁśa*) belonging to His second form He is "Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa," and as portions (*kalās*) He is "Kāraṇābdhiśāyī," "Garbhodaśāyī," "Payobdhiśāyī" and "Śeṣa." He Himself remains Kṛṣṇa's assistant in His pastimes, and in four forms — Mahā-

Saṅkarṣaṇa, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, Garbhodaśāyī and Payobdhiśāyī — He carries out creation and other works. As Ananta, who is called Śeṣa, He serves Kṛṣṇa in many ways. In all these forms Balarāma relishes the bliss of serving Kṛṣṇa.

Describing the truth of Nityānanda, the author explains the seventh verse in four verses —

সপ্তম শ্লোকের অর্থ করি চারিশ্লোক ।
যাতে নিত্যানন্দতত্ত্ব জানে সর্ব্বলোক ॥ ১২ ॥

saptama ślokera artha kari cāriśloka
of the seventh verse the meaning I make in four verses
yāte nityānanda-tattva jāne sarvaloka
by which of Nityānanda the truth know all people

12 I shall explain the meaning of the seventh verse in four verses, so that all may know the truth of Nityānanda.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The meaning of the seventh verse: what is said in the seventh verse I explain in verses 8, 9, 10 and 11.

(a verse from the diary of Śrī Svarūpa Gosvāmī)

মায়াতীতে ব্যাপিবৈকুণ্ঠলোকে
পূর্ণৈশ্বর্য্যে শ্রীচতুর্ব্যূহমধ্যে ।
রূপং যস্যোদ্ভাতি সঙ্কর্ষণাখ্যং
তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ১৩ ॥

māyātīte vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke
beyond māyā in all-pervading Vaikuṇṭha world
pūrṇaiśvarye śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye
full of opulence amid the fourfold expansion
rūpaṁ yasyodbhāti saṅkarṣaṇākhyaṁ
form whose shines forth Saṅkarṣaṇa named
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

13 “I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma, whose form called Saṅkarṣaṇa shines amid the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha) in the all-pervading world of Vaikuṇṭha, full of every opulence and beyond māyā.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[2]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I take shelter of Rāma, who is Nityānanda. In Vaikuṇṭha, which lies beyond māyā and pervades all, abides the *catur-vyūha* full of complete majesty — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha; among them shines His form named Saṅkarṣaṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

māyātīte (beyond the region made of the *guṇas*) **vyāpi-vaikuṇṭha-loke** (in Vaikuṇṭha, the undivided support, free from māyā and unlimited), **pūrṇaiśvarye** (full of the complete range of potencies), **śrī-catur-vyūha-madhye** (among the four Viṣṇus — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha) **yasya** (Nityānanda-Rāma’s) **saṅkarṣaṇākhyaṁ rūpam udbhāti** (shines), **tam nityānanda-rāmam ahaṁ prapadye**.

“Paravyoma,” endowed with six transcendental opulences —

প্রকৃতির পার ‘পরব্যোম’-নামে ধাম ।
কৃষ্ণবিগ্রহ যৈছে বিভূত্যাদি-গুণবান্ ॥ ১৪ ॥

prakṛtira pāra ‘paravyoma’-nāme dhāma
material nature’s beyond Paravyoma named an abode
kṛṣṇa-vigraha yaiche vibhūty-ādi-guṇavān
Kṛṣṇa’s form just as with opulence and other qualities endowed

14 Beyond material nature lies the abode called Paravyoma. Like Kṛṣṇa’s own form, it is endowed with every opulence and every divine quality.

The world of Brahman and the worlds above it, the abode of Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras —

সর্ব্বগ, অনন্ত ব্রহ্ম-বৈকুণ্ঠাদি ধাম ।
কৃষ্ণ, কৃষ্ণ-অবতারের তাহাঞি বিশ্রাম ॥ ১৫ ॥

sarvaga, ananta brahma-vaikuṇṭhādi dhāma
all-pervading endless Brahman Vaikuṇṭha and others abodes
kṛṣṇa, kṛṣṇa-avatārera tāhāñi viśrāma
of Kṛṣṇa of Kṛṣṇa's avatāras there the dwelling

15 There lie endless, all-pervading abodes — Brahman, Vaikuṇṭha and others — and in them Kṛṣṇa and His avatāras dwell.

Above Paravyoma, Kṛṣṇaloka in three forms —

তাহার উপরিভাগে 'কৃষ্ণলোক' খ্যাতি ।
দ্বারকা-মথুরা-গোকুল — ত্রিবিধত্বে স্থিতি ॥ ১৬ ॥

tāhāra upari-bhāge 'kṛṣṇa-loka' khyāti
its in the upper part Kṛṣṇaloka renowned
dvārakā-mathurā-gokula — tri-vidhatve sthiti
Dvārakā Mathurā Gokula in three divisions it abides

16 In its highest region is the realm known as Kṛṣṇaloka, which abides in three divisions — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Above the *prakṛti* of twenty-four elements there is a spiritual abode called "Paravyoma." Like the form of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, this abode is endowed with every excellence, such as all-pervading power (*vibhūti*). Within it lie all-pervading, endless abodes — the abode of Brahman, Vaikuṇṭha and others. In all these abodes Kṛṣṇa Himself and all kinds of avatāras of Kṛṣṇa reside. Higher still, in the third part of this abode, is the supreme spiritual world, called "Kṛṣṇaloka." This Kṛṣṇaloka is varied: it exists in three forms — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula.

On the very highest level, Vraja, Goloka and Śvetadvīpa —

সর্ব্বোপরি শ্রীগোকুল — ব্রজলোকধাম ।
শ্রীগোলোক, শ্বেতদ্বীপ, বৃন্দাবন-নাম ॥ ১৭ ॥

sarvopari śrī-gokula — vrajaloka-dhāma
above all Śrī Gokula the abode of the world of Vraja
śrī-goloka, śvetadvīpa, vṛndāvana-nāma
Śrī Goloka Śvetadvīpa Vṛndāvana named

17 Above all is Śrī Gokula, the abode of Vraja, which is also called Śrī Goloka, Śvetadvīpa and Vṛndāvana.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Highest of all in the abode of Paravyoma are Śrī Gokula, that is, the abode of Vrajaloka; Śrī Goloka, that is, the abode of Kṛṣṇa where the mood of *svakīyā* prevails; Śvetadvīpa; and Vṛndāvana.

Goloka-Vṛndāvana, an abode wholly nondifferent from Kṛṣṇa —

সর্ব্বগ, অনন্ত, বিভু, কৃষ্ণতনুসম ।
উপর্য্যধো ব্যাপিয়াছে, নাহিক নিয়ম ॥ ১৮ ॥

sarvaga, ananta, vibhu, kṛṣṇa-tanu-sama
all-pervading endless vast like Kṛṣṇa's body
upary-adho vyāpiyāche, nāhika niyama
above and below it pervades there is no limit

18 Like Kṛṣṇa's body, it is all-pervading, endless and vast; it extends above and below without any bound.[3]

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva writes in the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-sandarbha* (section 106): "What, then, is that abode where He sports? To this it is said. The *Skanda Purāṇa* says: 'As the cities dear to Bhagavān exist on earth, so they exist in Vaikuṇṭha, honoured for the sake of those pastimes.' According to these words, the places that exist in Vaikuṇṭha should be understood to be these very places. And they lie above all the Vaikuṇṭhas. * * * The *Svāyambhuva-āgama* also says that this place stands in its own right, above all: in the dialogue of Īśvara and Devī, in the section on meditation on the fourteen-syllable [mantra], in the eighty-fifth chapter (*paṭala*): 'One should remember the all-pervading Vaikuṇṭha, strewn with many wish-fulfilling creepers. Below it is *prakṛti*, the equilibrium of the *guṇas*, the cause of all.' * * * Therefore, by the rule 'as they exist on earth' as well, it is established that Śrī Kṛṣṇaloka, consisting of Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula, exists in its own right and, as the place of the pastimes of Bhagavān Himself, lies above all. Hence Vṛndāvana is that very Gokula which shines above all and is renowned as Goloka. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: 'The great abode called Gokula is a lotus of a thousand petals. * * * Around it is a wondrous quadrangle called Śvetadvīpa.' * * * The abode of this Śrī Kṛṣṇa, fit for liv-

ing together with Nanda, Yaśodā and others, is the great inner palace; of its nature it is said that its origin, that is, its eternal manifestation, is from a part of Ananta, Śrī Baladeva. Read in a double sense,[17] the words also convey this: there is the origin, that is, the dwelling, of Śrī Baladeva Himself, whose part is Ananta. * * * Next the coverings of Gokula are described, beginning 'Outside it is a quadrangle.' Outside that Gokula, on every side, a quadrangular, that is, four-cornered, place is called Śvetadvīpa, since that part has no particular name 'Gokula.' But the inner circle of the quadrangle should be known as Vṛndāvana, and the outer circle only as Śvetadvīpa; its other name is 'Goloka.' * * * Vaikuṇṭha is called Brahmaloka. * * * In the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in the *Vijaya-ākhyāna*: 'There, above all, in Goloka, Śrī Govinda Himself always sports, full of supreme bliss, the Lord of the gopīs and of Gokula.' Thus it is established that Śrī Kṛṣṇaloka lies above all. It is also determined that this world, divided into parts according to the differences of those pastimes and associates, consists of three places — Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula. Elsewhere [in scripture], however, the places of the same names renowned on earth are spoken of as these very places: for of them, as of the other Vaikuṇṭhas, it is said that they lie beyond the material world, are eternal, have an unearthly form and are the eternal abode of Bhagavān."

In what kind of abode does this Bhagavān move about? On this it is said: "As cities dear to Bhagavān exist in this material world, so three cities abide in Vaikuṇṭha for the sake of His pastimes." According to these words of the *Skanda Purāṇa*, it should be known that the places existing in Vaikuṇṭha are the very same places that are in the material world. Above the material creation lie all the Vaikuṇṭhas. The *Svāyambhuva-tantra*, too, says that the place of Vaikuṇṭha stands in its own right, above all. In that book, in the section on meditation on the fourteen-syllable [mantra], in the 85th *paṭala*, in the dialogue of Devī and Maheśvara, it is said: "One should remember the all-pervading, undivided Vaikuṇṭha, strewn with many wish-fulfilling creepers. Below it lies *prakṛti* — the equilibrium of the *guṇas*, the cause of all material causes." Therefore from the rule "as the abodes of Hari exist on earth, so also there" we understand that Kṛṣṇaloka, consisting of Dvārakā, Mathurā and Gokula, exists in its own right. It is the field of the pastimes of Bhagavān Himself, and so it is established that these abodes lie above all. Hence Vṛndāvana-Gokula is renowned as "Goloka," shining above all. In the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: "The great abode shaped like a lotus of a thousand petals is known as 'Gokula.' The wondrous place around it, a quadrangle — that is, bounded by four straight lines — is called 'Śvetadvīpa.'" In that abode of Kṛṣṇa is His great inner

palace, fit for living with Nanda, Yaśodā and others. Its nature is described thus: that abode eternally arises from Ananta, the part of Baladeva Prabhu. The *tantra* scriptures convey the same: the abode of Bhagavān is where Anantadeva, the part of Baladeva, appears and dwells. The coverings of Gokula are described thus. Outside Gokula, on every side, lies a quadrangular place (a four-cornered field) known as "Śvetadvīpa." The part that is Śvetadvīpa does not bear the name "Gokula"; but the inner circle of the quadrangle is known by the name "Vṛndāvana," and only the outer circle should be known as "Śvetadvīpa"; its other name is "Goloka." The word "Brahmaloka" means "Vaikuṇṭha." In the *Nārada-pañcarātra*, in the account of the *Vijaya-ākhyāna*, it is said that in that abode, above all, in Goloka, Govindadeva Himself — Gopīnātha, the Lord of Gokula — always sports in supreme bliss. From this it is established that Kṛṣṇaloka lies above all worlds. It is also determined that this very Kṛṣṇaloka, by the differences of pastimes and associates and by the differences of parts, is the three places with many chambers, named "Dvārakā," "Mathurā" and "Gokula." Elsewhere [in scripture] we hear that the places of the same names on earth, in the material world, are of the same nature: for of them, as of the other Vaikuṇṭhas, it is said that they lie beyond the material world, are eternal, have an unearthly form and are the eternal abode of Bhagavān. Therefore they too should be known as nondifferent [from the abodes of Kṛṣṇaloka].

It is self-manifest — by Kṛṣṇa's will it descends into the material world —

ব্রহ্মাণ্ডে প্রকাশ তাঁর কৃষ্ণের ইচ্ছায় ।
একই স্বরূপ তাঁর, নাহি দুই কায় ॥ ১৯ ॥

brahmāṇḍe prakāśa tāṁra kṛṣṇera icchāya
in the universe manifestation its by Kṛṣṇa's will
eka-i svarūpa tāṁra, nāhi dui kāya
one and the same nature its there are not two bodies

19 By Kṛṣṇa's will it is manifest within the universe, yet it remains one and the same: it does not have two bodies.

To eyes that seek enjoyment it looks like the material world, but to the eyes of

devotion it is the field of Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, a spiritual land of cintāmaṇi —

চিন্তামণি-ভূমি, কল্পবৃক্ষময় বন ।
চর্ম্মচক্ষে দেখে তাঁরে প্রপঞ্চের সম ॥ ২০ ॥

cintāmaṇi-bhūmi, kalpa-vṛkṣa-maya vana
of cintāmaṇi the land of wish-fulfilling trees full forests
carma-cakṣe dekhe tāṁre prapañcera sama
with eyes of flesh one sees it the material world like

20 Its land is cintāmaṇi, its forests are full of wish-fulfilling trees; yet eyes of flesh see it as no different from the material world.

প্রেমনেত্রে দেখে তাঁর স্বরূপ-প্রকাশ ।
গোপ-গোপীসঙ্গে যাঁহা কৃষ্ণের বিলাস ॥ ২১ ॥

prema-netre dekhe tāṁra svarūpa-prakāśa
with eyes of love one sees its true form's manifestation
gopa-gopī-saṅge yāṁhā kṛṣṇera vilāsa
with the cowherd boys and girls together where Kṛṣṇa's pastimes

21 With eyes of love one sees it as it truly is — the place where Kṛṣṇa sports with the cowherd boys and girls.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

This spiritual abode of Vraja, by Kṛṣṇa's will, is manifest within the material universe, yet even here it remains in the very same form. Some think that Goloka and the other abodes in Paravyoma are different from the abode of Vraja manifest in the material world. But that is not so: it is one and the same abode, only manifest at the same time both in Paravyoma and in the material world. Even in the Vraja manifest in the material world the ground is *cintāmaṇi* and the forests consist of wish-fulfilling trees. The eyes of prema see the true form of this abode, while to material eyes it looks like the material world.

Govinda in Goloka — (Brahma-saṁhitā, Chapter 5, verse 29)

চিন্তামণিপ্রকরসদ্মসু কল্পবৃক্ষ-
লক্ষাবৃতেষু সুরভীরভিপালয়ন্তম্ ।
লক্ষ্মীসহস্রশতসম্ভ্রমসেব্যমানং
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ২২ ॥

cintāmaṇi-prakara-sadmasu kalpa-vṛkṣa-
of cintāmaṇi gems of clusters in abodes wish-fulfilling trees
lakṣāvṛteṣu surabhīr abhipālayantam
by millions surrounded the surabhi cows tending
lakṣmī-sahasra-śata-sambhrama-sevyamānaṁ
by Lakṣmīs thousands hundreds with reverence being served
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

22 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, who tends the surabhi cows in abodes built of cintāmaṇi gems and surrounded by millions of wish-fulfilling trees, and who is served with reverence by hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.29)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the original Puruṣa, Śrī Govindacandra. He tends the wish-fulfilling cows in places made of heaps of *cintāmaṇi*, surrounded by hundreds of thousands of wish-fulfilling trees, and hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs serve Him with reverence.

Anubhāṣya.

kalpa-vṛkṣa-lakṣāvṛteṣu (surrounded, that is, adorned, by hundreds of thousands — countless — wish-fulfilling trees, trees that give whatever fruit one may fittingly ask for) **cintāmaṇi-prakara-sadmasu** (in abodes, that is, palaces, built of heaps of *cintāmaṇi*, jewels able to grant desired fruits) **surabhīḥ** (the wish-fulfilling cows) **abhipālayantam** (tending in every way — as a cowherd should care for his cows), **lakṣmī-sahasra-śata-sambhrama-sevyamānam** (served with reverence by hundreds of thousands of Lakṣmīs — the beautiful cowherd girls) **tam ādi-puruṣam govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi**.

“The original catur-vyūha” —

মথুরা-দ্বারকায় নিজরূপ প্রকাশিয়া ।
নানা-রূপে বিলসয়ে চতুর্ব্যূহ হৈঞা ॥ ২৩ ॥

mathurā-dvārakāya nija-rūpa prakāśiyā
in Mathurā Dvārakā His own form manifesting
nānā-rūpe vilasaye catur-vyūha haiñā
in many forms He sports the catur-vyūha becoming

23 In Mathurā and Dvārakā He manifests His own form and, becoming the fourfold expansion (catur-vyūha), sports in many forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
In the part of Kṛṣṇa’s abode called Mathurā and Dvārakā, Kṛṣṇa manifests the original *catur-vyūha* — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — and sports in various forms. The *catur-vyūha* of Dvārakā is the whole of which all other *catur-vyūhas* are parts; it is pure and spiritual.

The whole of all the catur-vyūhas —

বাসুদেব-সঙ্কর্ষণ-প্রদ্যুম্নানিরুদ্ধ ।
সর্ব্বচতুর্ব্যূহ-অংশী, তুরীয়, বিশুদ্ধ ॥ ২৪ ॥

vāsudeva-saṅkarṣaṇa-pradyumnāniruddha
Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa Pradyumna Aniruddha
sarva-catur-vyūha-aṁśī, turīya, viśuddha
of all catur-vyūhas the source transcendent pure

24 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the source of every catur-vyūha; They are transcendent (*turīya*) and pure.

In Gokula, Mathurā and Dvārakā — pastimes in the two-armed form —

এই তিন লোকে কৃষ্ণ কেবল-লীলাময় ।
নিজগণ লঞা খেলে অনন্ত সময় ॥ ২৫ ॥

ei tina loke kṛṣṇa kevala-līlā-maya
in these three abodes Kṛṣṇa wholly of pastimes full
nija-gaṇa lañā khele ananta samaya
His own associates taking He plays endless time

25 In these three abodes Kṛṣṇa is wholly given to His pastimes; there He plays with His own associates without end.

Anubhāṣya.
In three worlds: in Gokula, in Mathurā and in Dvārakā.

In the Vaikuṇṭha of Paravyoma — pastimes in the form of four-armed Nārāyaṇa —

পরব্যোম-মধ্যে করি' স্বরূপপ্রকাশ ।
নারায়ণরূপে করেন বিবিধ বিলাস ॥ ২৬ ॥

para-vyoma-madhye kari' svarūpa prakāśa
of Paravyoma in the midst making of His own form manifestation
nārāyaṇa-rūpe karena vividha vilāsa
of Nārāyaṇa in the form He performs various pastimes

26 In the midst of Paravyoma He manifests His own form and, as Nārāyaṇa, enjoys pastimes of many kinds.

Kṛṣṇa, the svayaṁ-rūpa, is two-armed; Nārāyaṇa, the manifestation of His majesty, is four-armed —

স্বরূপবিগ্রহ কৃষ্ণের কেবল দ্বিভুজ ।
নারায়ণরূপে সেই তনু চতুর্ভুজ ॥ ২৭ ॥

svarūpa-vigraha kṛṣṇera kevala dvi-bhuja
own form Kṛṣṇa's only two-armed
nārāyaṇa-rūpe sei tanu catur-bhuja
of Nārāyaṇa in the form that body four-armed

27 Kṛṣṇa's own form has only two arms; in the form of Nārāyaṇa that same body has four.

শঙ্খ-চক্র-গদা-পদ্ম, মহৈশ্বর্য্যময় ।
শ্রী-ভূ-নীলা-শক্তি যাঁর চরণ সেবয় ॥ ২৮ ॥

śaṅkha-cakra-gadā-padma, mahaiśvarya-maya
conch disc club lotus of great majesty full
śrī-bhū-nīlā-śakti yāṁra caraṇa sevaya
Śrī Bhū Nīlā potencies whose feet serve

28 He holds the conch, disc, club and lotus and is full of supreme majesty; His feet are served by His potencies Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kṛṣṇa's *svarūpa-vigraha*, His original form, is always two-armed. His *svarūpa-prakāśa* in Paravyoma is four-armed Nārāyaṇa, served by the potencies Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā. These three potencies are described in detail in the books of the Vaiṣṇavas of the Śrī-sampradāya.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī, Bhū and Nīlā. Following a Bengali reading, some call Nīlā "Līlā-śakti." These three potencies abide in Vaikuṇṭha beside Nārāyaṇa. Once Bhūta-yogī, Sara-yogī and Bhrānta-yogī (the Āḻvārs) took shelter at night in a brāhmaṇa's house in the village of Gehalī. Then Nārāyaṇa entered that house and revealed His form to them.

Prapannāmṛta, Chapter 77, verses 61–62: "They saw Viṣṇu, the original Bhagavān. He was mounted on Tārkṣya (Garuḍa) and looked like a cloud with lightning; He bore Lakṣmī on His chest, His eyes were like lotuses, and in two hands shone the conch and the disc. His arms reached to His knees, His body was lovely, and Bhūmi and Nīlā shone at His two sides. He wore yellow garments, His body was adorned with ornaments and anointed with sandal paste, and He had four arms."

In the *Sītā Upaniṣad*: "Mahālakṣmī of the Lord of the gods is both different and nondifferent from Him; She consists of the conscious and the unconscious. As potency this goddess is of three kinds: *icchā-śakti* (the potency of will), *kriyā-śakti* (the potency of action) and *sākṣāt-śakti* (the direct potency). *Icchā-śakti* is of three kinds: Śrī, Bhūmi and Līlā."

In his commentary on the *Gītā* (Chapter 4, verse 6) Śrī Madhvācārya cites scripture: "She who is the mother of the *mahat* and the rest, conceived of as Śrī, Bhū

and Nīlā, and the bewildering one named Durgā — through them Viṣṇu, though unborn, by the power of His own *cit*[-potency] is renowned as if born among those whose minds are bewildered." * * * "Mahāmāyā, Vaiṣṇavī, divided as Śrī, Bhū and Durgā, is infinitely below His potency. Yet because she has taken shelter of the Lord, even Ananta, Brahmā, Rudra and others have not a fraction of her power. Without the grace of Viṣṇu even they cannot overcome her." (*Vyāsa-yoga*, Chapter 7, section 14.)

Madhva's commentary on the *Gītā* (Chapter 14, verse 3): "'The great Brahman' is *prakṛti*. She is divided as Śrī, Bhū and Durgā. Umā, Sarasvatī and others are other jīvas, possessing a part of her." So too the *Kārṣāyaṇa-śruti*: "Śrī, Bhū and Durgā are the great māyā; she brings forth the worlds and binds the universe. Umā, Vāk and others are other jīvas, her parts; in all the Vedas they are sung as one with her in nature."

Śrī Jīva Prabhu in the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 80): "As the *Padma Purāṇa* says: 'The eternal, auspicious form of the Lord abides in the supreme abode; He is eternally delighted by the sovereign Śrī and by Bhūmi and is surrounded by them.' In the *Mahā-saṁhitā* this is distinguished by name and nature as well: 'His three-fold potency — Śrī, Bhū and Durgā — which is divided, is the *jīva-māyā* of the Great Soul. *Ātma-māyā* is His will, and *guṇa-māyā* is material.'" (Ibid., section 22): "Śrī here is the potency that maintains the world, Bhū the potency of its creation, Durgā the potency of its dissolution. His potency that has become distinct in these forms and is directed towards the *jīvas* is called *jīva-māyā*. In the *Padma Purāṇa*, in the dialogue of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and Satyabhāmā, after the words 'I Myself, dividing threefold, abide through the three kinds of *guṇas*,' it is said: 'Then all the gods, hearing this and urged by those words, full of devotion, bowed down to Gaurī, Lakṣmī and Dharā.'"

Though Kṛṣṇa is absorbed in pastime alone, He is full of causeless mercy towards the jīvas —

যদ্যপি কেবল তাঁর ক্রীড়ামাত্র ধর্ম্ম ।
তথাপি জীবেরে কৃপায় করে এক কর্ম্ম ॥ ২৯ ॥

yadyapi kevala tāṁra krīḍā-mātra dharma
although only His play merely nature
tathāpi jīvere kṛpāya kare eka karma
still to the jīvas out of mercy He does one work

29 Though His nature is simply to play, out of mercy to the jīvas He does one work:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Though His nature is pastime alone, out of mercy for the jīvas He also performs this pastime: He delivers the jīvas.

By four kinds of liberation He delivers the jīvas, that is, brings them to Vaikuṇṭha —

সালোক্য-সামীপ্য-সার্ষ্টি-সারূপ্য-প্রকার ।
চারি মুক্তি দিয়া করে জীবেরে নিস্তার ॥ ৩০ ॥

sālokya-sāmīpya-sārṣṭi-sārūpya-prakāra
sālokya sāmīpya sārṣṭi sārūpya kinds
cāri mukti diyā kare jīvere nistāra
four liberations giving He makes of the jīvas deliverance

30 Granting the four kinds of liberation — sālokya, sāmīpya, sārṣṭi and sārūpya — He delivers the jīvas.

Those who know the featureless Brahman remain outside Vaikuṇṭha —

ব্রহ্মসাযুজ্য-মুক্তের তাঁহা নাহি গতি ।
বৈকুণ্ঠ-বাহিরে হয় তা-সবার স্থিতি ॥ ৩১ ॥

brahma-sāyujya-muktera tāṁhā nāhi gati
in Brahman by merging of the liberated there there is no access
vaikuṇṭha-bāhire haya tā-sabāra sthiti
Vaikuṇṭha outside is of them all the dwelling

31 Those liberated by merging into Brahman have no access there; they all remain outside it.

Beyond Paravyoma, the spiritual Brahmaloka —

বৈকুণ্ঠ-বাহিরে এক জ্যোতির্ম্ময় মণ্ডল ।
কৃষ্ণের অঙ্গের প্রভা, পরম উজ্জ্বল ॥ ৩২ ॥

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire eka jyotir-maya maṇḍala
Vaikuṇṭha outside one luminous sphere
kṛṣṇera aṅgera prabhā, parama ujjvala
of Kṛṣṇa's body the radiance supremely bright

32 Outside Vaikuṇṭha lies a sphere of light — the radiance of Kṛṣṇa's body, supremely bright.

Though beyond māyā, it has no spiritual pastimes — it is spirit alone —

'সিদ্ধলোক' নাম তার প্রকৃতির পার ।
চিৎস্বরূপ, তাঁহা নাহি চিচ্ছক্তি-বিকার ॥ ৩৩ ॥

'siddha-loka' nāma tāra prakṛtira pāra
Siddhaloka name its material nature beyond
cit-svarūpa, tāṁhā nāhi cic-chakti-vikāra
spiritual in nature there there are not of the spiritual potency transformations

33 It is called Siddhaloka and lies beyond material nature. It is spiritual, yet the spiritual potency displays no variety there.

An example of the abode of Brahman —

সূর্য্যমণ্ডল যেন বাহিরে নির্ব্বিশেষ ।
ভিতরে সূর্য্যের রথ-আদি সবিশেষ ॥ ৩৪ ॥

sūrya-maṇḍala yena bāhire nirviśeṣa
the sun's disc as outside without variety
bhitare sūryera ratha-ādi saviśeṣa
within the sun's chariot and the rest full of variety

34 It is like the disc of the sun: from outside it is a featureless glow, but within are the sun's chariot and all its variety.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The word "Vaikuṇṭha" should be understood as "the abode of Kṛṣṇa" and "Paravyoma." Beyond Paravyoma the radiance of Kṛṣṇa's body spreads out and forms a sphere of light. It is called "Siddhaloka," "Brahmaloka" and so on. It is the only place for the liberation of merging into Brahman (*brahma-sāyujya*). This abode is indeed spiritual, but it has no transformations of the *cit-śakti*, that is, no variety. From outside, the disc of the sun is without features (*nirviśeṣa*): it is mere light, without any variety. But within the disc one sees the sun's chariot and the rest — things with features (*saviśeṣa*), that is, rich variety. So it is here: the outer part of the sun's disc is like the abode of Brahman.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 7, Chapter 1, verse 29)[12]

কামাদ্দ্বেষাৎ ভয়াৎ স্নেহাৎ যথা ভক্ত্যেশ্বরে মনঃ ৷
আবেশ্য তদঘং হিত্বা বহবস্তদ্গতিং গতাঃ ॥ ৩৫ ॥

kāmād dveṣāt bhayāt snehāt
from desire from enmity from fear from affection
yathā bhaktyeśvare manaḥ
as by devotion on the Lord the mind
āveśya tad aghaṁ hitvā
fixing that sin casting off
bahavas tad gatiṁ gatāḥ
many His destination have attained

35 "Many have fixed their minds on the Lord — some by devotion, others by loving desire (*kāma*), enmity, fear or affection — and, casting off the sin in those feelings, have attained Him." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 7.1.29)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Many fixed their minds on Him through *kāma*, enmity, fear and affection — just as through devotion — gave up that sin and attained Him. In another reading one more verse is found: "The gopīs through *kāma*, Kaṁsa through fear, Caidya and other kings through enmity, the Vṛṣṇis through kinship, you through affection, and we through devotion, O mighty Lord."[12]

Anubhāṣya.

Dharmarāja Yudhiṣṭhira asked: “Why did Śiśupāla, through his enmity towards Kṛṣṇa, become worthy of *sāyujya-mukti*?” In reply Śrī Nārada said:

yathā ([by prescribed]) **bhaktyā** (service) **īśvare manaḥ āveśya** ([people attain Him]), [so too,] **tad aghaṁ** (the sin caused by *kāma* and the rest) **hitvā**, **kāmāt** — like the gopīs, **dveṣāt** — like Dantavakra, Śiśupāla and others, **bhayāt** — like Kaṁsa and others, **snehāt** — like the Pāṇḍavas — **bahavaḥ** (many [such]) **tad gatiṁ** (one or another kind of liberation) **gatāḥ** (attained).

See Yudhiṣṭhira’s question and Śrī Nārada’s answer in the first chapter of the seventh canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (verses 22–46), and also the various interpretations in the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on verses 3.30, 32 and 34.

(Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Pūrva-vibhāga, Sādhana-bhakti-laharī, verse 278)

যদরীণাং প্রিয়াণাঞ্চ প্রাপ্যমেকমিবোদিতম্ ।
তদ্ব্রহ্মকৃষ্ণয়োরৈক্যাৎ কিরণার্কোপমা-জুষোঃ ॥ ৩৬ ॥

yad arīṇāṁ priyāṇāṁ ca
which of the enemies of the beloved and
prāpyam ekam ivoditam
the attainment one as if is spoken of
tad brahma-kṛṣṇayor aikyāt
that of Brahman and Kṛṣṇa from the oneness
kiraṇārkopamā-juṣoḥ
like the rays and the sun of those two

36 “The goal of the Lord’s enemies and that of His beloved ones are sometimes spoken of as one, because Brahman and Kṛṣṇa are one, as the rays are one with the sun.” (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.278)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Wherever scripture says that the enemies of Bhagavān and His beloved ones attain the same thing, it speaks only of the oneness of Brahman, which is like the rays, and Kṛṣṇa, who is like the sun. The upshot is this: the beloved ones of Bhagavān attain the variety of Vaikuṇṭha, while the enemies of Bhagavān attain “Siddhaloka,” which is without pastimes.

Anubhāṣya.

yat (if in some scripture) **arīṇāṁ** (of the enemies of Bhagavān) **priyāṇāṁ ca** (and of the devotees of Bhagavān) **ekam prāpyam uditam** (is declared), **tat kiraṇārkopamā-juṣoḥ brahma-kṛṣṇayoḥ aikyāt** (because of the oneness — that is, it should be understood that the featureless Brahman, which is like the rays, and Kṛṣṇa, who is like the sun, are in truth nondifferent).

Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.2.32: "Others, O lotus-eyed Lord, think themselves liberated, but their intelligence is impure because they lack devotion to You. Having climbed with difficulty to the highest position, they fall down from there, for they have neglected Your feet."

Śrī Rūpa Prabhu writes in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the glory of Śrī Kṛṣṇa (25–37): "There, in the fourth part [of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*] (*Viṣṇu Purāṇa* 4.15.1–10), is Maitreya's question: 'Slain by Viṣṇu as Hiraṇyakaśipu and as Rāvaṇa, he obtained enjoyments unattainable even by the immortals. Yet then he did not attain *sāyujya* with Him. How, then, did he, as Śiśupāla, attain *sāyujya* with the eternal Hari?' Parāśara's answer: 'To slay the lord of the Daityas, He who creates, maintains and destroys all the worlds took an unprecedented body and manifested the form of Nṛsiṁha. But Hiraṇyakaśipu did not think, "This is Viṣṇu." He thought, "This is a being born of an unsurpassed store of merit." His one-pointed mind, driven by an excess of *rajas*, was absorbed in that thought. Therefore, having died at His hand, he obtained, as the Ten-headed One (Rāvaṇa), an unsurpassed wealth of enjoyment surpassing everything in the three worlds. But his mind did not dissolve into that beginningless and endless Bhagavān, the Supreme Brahman, for he had not made Him his support. As the Ten-headed One, too, subject to Anaṅga (Kāma), he gave his heart to Jānakī and saw only the form of Him who had taken the form of Daśaratha's son. He did not think, "This is Acyuta," and because of his attachment, at the hour of death his heart saw in Him only a man. Then the sole fruit of being felled by Acyuta was birth as Śiśupāla in the line of the kings of Cedi, renowned throughout the earth, and unimpeded wealth. At that time all the names of Bhagavān found their causes [in Kṛṣṇa]. Therefore his mind, bound by an enmity towards Him that had run through many births, endlessly uttered all these names of Acyuta, prompted by those causes — in abuse, threats and the like. And because of his deep-rooted enmity, His form never left his mind — not while he walked, ate, bathed, sat or lay down, nor in any other state. So, uttering His names in his abuse and holding Him alone in his heart, when the hour of his destruction came, freed of faults such as enmity, he saw Bhagavān — shining with the garland of rays of the disc He had hurled, the embodiment of imperishable effulgence, the

Supreme Brahman. At that very moment he was slain by Bhagavān's disc; remembrance of Him burned up his entire store of sins; Bhagavān brought him to his end — and he dissolved into Him alone. All this I have told you. For this Bhagavān, even when glorified and remembered with persistent enmity, bestows a fruit that all the gods and *asuras* find hard to attain. What then of those who possess true devotion?'

"Parāśara did not say here that these two were [the Lord's] associates. It is said only that the two of them had three births. Therefore they are not held to be [the Lord's] associates in every *kalpa*; otherwise their fall in every *kalpa* would make no sense.

"When Hari manifested the wondrous form of Nṛsiṁha, Hiraṇyakaśipu had no firm idea that this was Viṣṇu. He concluded, 'This is someone endowed with merit.' His mind was driven by an excess of *rajas*, and, absorbed in that idea, he then obtained as Rāvaṇa the best of all and most rare wealth of enjoyment, whose only cause was his death [at His hand]. Since he was not certain that this was Viṣṇu, there was no unbroken absorption through intense enmity. And without it enmity leads only to hell, as with Vena. Yet he obtained wealth as the fruit of death at His hand. Remembering this good, the sage spoke with the word *eva* ('only'). Since there was no absorption and his faults were not destroyed, he did not see [the Lord] as pure; and so, although the form of the Supreme Brahman was manifest, he did not dissolve into Him. As Rāvaṇa too, having given himself over to great *kāma*, he likewise saw a man in Śrī Rāma even at the hour of death. Therefore, as king of Cedi, he again obtained the highest wealth. Then in Kṛṣṇa there arose causes for all the names of the Lord of Ramā. From this he concluded that He was Viṣṇu — for He had twice been the cause of his death. Out of intense enmity and great absorption he endlessly uttered all those names, constantly abusing, threatening and so on. And seeing such a form and knowing for certain, 'This is Viṣṇu,' he remembered it everywhere and always, just like the names. His heap of sins born of enmity was burned; when the disc was hurled, its radiance removed his demonic nature, and at the end, his vision purified, he saw the radiant Supreme Brahman in a form like a man's. When the blow of the disc destroyed the body of the Daitya, he dissolved into that very Supreme Brahman. Having said this, [the sage] recalled that Bakī (Pūtanā) and others attained liberation through [Kṛṣṇa's] childhood pastimes, while Kālanemi and others, even by the Lord's will, did not attain liberation in other [avatāras] — and he said again: 'For this Bhagavān …' *Hi* ('for') means 'as is well known': this Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Therefore He quickly draws

the hearts both of those who love Him and of those who hate Him. Hence the greatness spoken of in the words 'when glorified …' is no wonder here."

Paraphrase of the meaning: "In the fourth part of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* Maitreya asks Parāśara: 'That Daitya who, in the bodies of Hiraṇyakaśipu and Rāvaṇa, obtained enjoyments unattainable even by the immortals, yet did not obtain liberation — how did he, in the body of Śiśupāla, attain *sāyujya* with Śrī Kṛṣṇa?' Parāśara's answer: 'When Śrī Nṛsiṁhadeva appeared, Hiraṇyakaśipu did not think of Him, "This is Viṣṇu," but took Him for some being born of a heap of merit. Because of the predominance of *rajo-guṇa*, at the hour of death he could not think of His form. But because he died at His hand, in the body of Rāvaṇa he obtained boundless wealth of enjoyment that gave him power over the three worlds. He did not regard Bhagavān as his support (*ālambana*), that is, as the *viṣaya-vigraha*, the one to be served — so his mind did not dissolve into Bhagavān. In the body of Rāvaṇa, subject to *kāma*, he set his heart on Jānakī and only saw the form of Bhagavān Śrī Rāmacandra. But at the hour of death he did not understand that Śrī Rāma was Viṣṇu: in his heart there was only the idea that He was a man. Then, because he fell at Śrī Rāma's hand, he was born in the body of Śiśupāla in the renowned line of the kings of Cedi and obtained great wealth. Śrī Kṛṣṇa was called Vāsudeva, and [Śiśupāla] saw Viṣṇu in Him. For many births he had been hostile to Him; that enmity had grown firmly into his heart, and so even in abuse and threats he uttered the names of Kṛṣṇa. Because of his deep-rooted enmity the beautiful form of Bhagavān never left the mind of Śiśupāla, absorbed in Kṛṣṇa, in any state — not while he walked, ate, bathed, sat, lay down and so on. He uttered that name in anger and the like and held that form in his heart; so at the last hour his offences — enmity and the rest — went away, and in the radiance of the rays of the Sudarśana disc that had come to destroy him, he saw the true form of Bhagavān, the Supreme Brahman. Remembrance of Bhagavān (though hostile) burned up his heap of sins; slain by Bhagavān's disc, Śiśupāla came near to Bhagavān and dissolved into Him. O Maitreya, this is the answer to your question. If the haters of Kṛṣṇa, by hostile cultivation (*pratikūla-anuśīlana*), even while persisting in enmity, attain a good destination, what doubt can there be that pure devotees, by favourable cultivation, will attain the highest goal of all — the lotus feet of Kṛṣṇa, that is, love for Kṛṣṇa?' Parāśara did not say that these two Daityas had formerly been Bhagavān's associates Jaya and Vijaya; he said only that they took birth three times. Therefore Parāśara did not mean that these two associates of Bhagavān are born as *asuras* in every *kalpa*. Otherwise the associates of Bhagavān would fall in every *kalpa*, and

that is entirely incongruous. (That is to say: in Bhagavān Viṣṇu, just as the will to create, the will to fight is also eternally present. A *mahārāja* fond of sport always plays with rivals set against him. When there are no rivals, he makes his own courtiers or servants into opponents and sports with them; and these servants, playing in a hostile mood, give their master delight. So too Bhagavān Viṣṇu: He makes hostile the jīvas who have been turned away from Him since time without beginning, or some of His own associates; they take on a hostile mood, and so both sides satisfy their longing for the play of battle. Therefore the fall of Bhagavān's associates in every *kalpa* is incongruous.) When Bhagavān appeared in the unearthly form of Nṛsiṁha, Hiraṇyakaśipu did not see Viṣṇu in Him: He seemed to him merely a being born of a heap of merit. The predominance of *rajo-guṇa* disordered his intelligence: he thought of Nṛsiṁha, 'This is some mighty creature,' and so at the last hour he could not think of His form. Therefore, merely because he died at Nṛsiṁha's hand, he obtained in the body of Rāvaṇa a rare wealth of enjoyment. Since there was no firm conviction that this was Viṣṇu, and no intense enmity, his absorption in Bhagavān did not grow. Enmity without such growing absorption in Bhagavān, as with King Vena, leads only to hell. Without the most intense absorption the offences born of abuse and the like are not destroyed. There was no absorption, the offences did not vanish, and so Hiraṇyakaśipu did not see the pure form of Bhagavān and could not dissolve into Him, though the Supreme Brahman Nṛsiṁhadeva stood manifest before him. In the body of Rāvaṇa, too, his mind was wholly subject to *kāma*, and so, like Hiraṇyakaśipu, he saw a man in Śrī Rāma. Therefore that Daitya, in the form of Śiśupāla, again obtained, as before, a fine wealth of enjoyment. Śrī Kṛṣṇa was called Vāsudeva, and by that name [Śiśupāla] then concluded that He was the cause of his death in his two previous births. Out of intense enmity and great absorption he constantly uttered all those names, even in abuse and threats; seeing in Him the four-armed form and so on, and convinced that this was Viṣṇu, he thought of that form unceasingly, just as he uttered the names. Therefore his heap of sins born of enmity was burned; the radiance of the disc hurled by Śrī Kṛṣṇa destroyed his demonic nature; gaining purified, divine vision, he saw the form of the Supreme Brahman, like that of a man. Then the blow of the Sudarśana disc destroyed his demonic body, and he dissolved into the Supreme Brahman. Having said that Śiśupāla, through the most intense absorption in Śrī Kṛṣṇa by way of enmity, attained merging (*sāyujya-laya*) in Him, and having considered that Pūtanā and others slain in His childhood pastimes attained liberation, while Kālanemi and others slain in other avatāras, by the design of the Lord, did not, [the sage] uttered this prose passage. *Hi* is used in the sense 'as is well

known.' If one glorifies and remembers the source of the avatāras rather than other avatāras — even with enmity, that is, in a hostile mood — even such *asuras* attain a good destination." See also the commentary of Śrīpāda Baladeva Vidyābhūṣaṇa.

Śrī Sanātana Prabhu in the *Bṛhad-bhāgavatāmṛta* (second part, called *Goloka-māhātmya*, 30–31): "Ah, how can liberation be praised, when even the Daityas obtain it — those whom the scriptures themselves condemn as killers of cows, brāhmaṇas and others? *Sādhus* and *asuras* are opposites in every way; so it is fitting that their means and their goal be opposite too."

In the tenth volume of the *Śrī Sajjana-toṣaṇī*, the translation by Śrīmad Bhaktivinoda Ṭhākura: "The scriptures condemn the Daityas — Kaṁsa and others — as killers of cows, brāhmaṇas and others. How then can the *sāyujya* liberation those Daityas obtained be praised? The sādhus are the devotees of Bhagavān, and the *asuras* are those who hate Him. Just as *sādhus* and *asuras* are always opposite in nature, so their means and goals must be opposite too. The means of the *asuras* is enmity towards the sādhus and the killing of cows and brāhmaṇas, and their goal is liberation. The means of the devotees is devotion, and their goal is *prema*. Therefore those who strive for such liberation, like wicked people, take up a wicked means — the mere endeavour of jñāna."

Above Brahmaloka, Paravyoma, full of spiritual pastimes —

তৈছে পরব্যোমে নানা চিচ্ছক্তিবিলাস ।
নির্ব্বিশেষ জ্যোতির্বিম্ব বাহিরে প্রকাশ ॥ ৩৭ ॥

taiche para-vyome nānā cic-chakti-vilāsa
so in Paravyoma manifold of the spiritual potency pastimes
nirviśeṣa jyotir-bimba bāhire prakāśa
featureless of light a sphere outside is manifest

37 So in Paravyoma there are manifold pastimes of the spiritual potency, while outside it a featureless sphere of light is manifest.

That sphere of light is the featureless Brahman; those who attain sāyujya-mukti

reach it —

নির্ব্বিশেষ-ব্রহ্ম সেই কেবল জ্যোতির্ম্ময় ।
সাযুজ্যের অধিকারী তাঁহা পায় লয় ॥ ৩৮ ॥

nirviśeṣa-brahma sei kevala jyotir-maya
featureless Brahman that only luminous
sāyujyera adhikārī tāṁhā pāya laya
for sāyujya the qualified there attain absorption

38 That featureless Brahman is light alone, and those who are fit for *sāyujya* are absorbed in it.

The destination of jñānīs, yogīs and the haters of Hari — (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Pūrva-vibhāga, verse 280; words of the Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa)

সিদ্ধলোকস্তু তমসঃ পারে যত্র বসন্তি হি ।
সিদ্ধা ব্রহ্মসুখে মগ্না দৈত্যাশ্চ হরিণা হতাঃ ॥ ৩৯ ॥

siddha-lokas tu tamasaḥ
Siddhaloka but darkness
pāre yatra vasanti hi
beyond where dwell indeed
siddhā brahma-sukhe magnā
the siddhas in the bliss of Brahman immersed
daityāś ca hariṇā hatāḥ
the demons and by Hari slain

39 "Beyond darkness lies Siddhaloka, where dwell the siddhas, immersed in the bliss of Brahman, and the demons slain by Hari." (Brahmāṇḍa-purāṇa; Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.280)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Beyond *tamas*, that is, beyond the world of māyā, lies "Siddhaloka," the abode of Brahman. There dwell the *māyāvādīs* immersed in the happiness of Brahman, and the *asuras* — Kaṁsa and others — slain by Bhagavān. The yogīs of Patañjali's school, even after attaining *kaivalya*, will also reach that world.

Anubhāṣya.

tamasaḥ pāre (in the region beyond the three *guṇas*) **tu siddha-lokaḥ** ([lies]), **yatra siddhāḥ** (those perfected in the knowledge of undifferentiated Brahman and in the yoga of *kaivalya*) **hariṇā** (by Kṛṣṇa) **hatāḥ daityāḥ ca brahma-sukhe** (in *sāyujya* with the featureless Brahman) **magnāḥ** ([being] immersed) **vasanti hi**.

See the *Anubhāṣya* to 35–36 above.

The second catur-vyūha in Paravyoma is a manifestation of the original catur-vyūha of Dvārakā —

সেই পরব্যোমে নারায়ণের চারি পাশে ।
দ্বারকায় চতুর্ব্যূহ দ্বিতীয় প্রকাশে ॥ ৪০ ॥

sei para-vyome nārāyaṇera cāri pāśe
in that Paravyoma of Nārāyaṇa on four sides
dvārakāya catur-vyūha dvitīya prakāśe
of Dvārakā the catur-vyūha in a second manifestation

40 In that Paravyoma, on the four sides of Nārāyaṇa, the catur-vyūha of Dvārakā is present in a second manifestation.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Rūpa Prabhu in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (describing the *catur-vyūha*, 83–84): "The *Padma Purāṇa*, however, says that the four *vyūhas* — Vāsudeva and the others — abide in order in the four directions of Paramavyoma, beginning with the east. Likewise in the *pāda-vibhūti* they abide in order: in the city of Vedavatī, in the Vaikuṇṭha within the covering of water; in the world of Viṣṇu above Satya; in the eternal city of Dvārakā; and in Śvetadvīpa, north of the Ocean of Pure Water, in the city of Airāvatī — in the abode that is the couch on Ananta's lap, in the Ocean of Milk."

The *Padma Purāṇa* says that in the four directions of Paravyoma, beginning with the east, the *catur-vyūha* — Vāsudeva and the others — abides in order. And in the *eka-pāda-vibhūti*, that is, in the material world, these four forms — Vāsudeva and the others — dwell in order in four places. Vāsudeva dwells in the Vaikuṇṭha within the covering of water, in the city of Vedavatī; Saṅkarṣaṇa in Viṣṇuloka above Satyaloka; Pradyumna in the eternal city of Dvārakā; and Aniruddha on the bed of Ananta, in the city of Airāvatī in Śvetadvīpa, in the middle of the Ocean of Milk, on the northern shore of the Ocean of Pure Water.

They are turīya, beyond the Virāṭ, the Garbha and the Kāraṇa —

বাসুদেব-সঙ্কর্ষণ-প্রদ্যুম্নানিরুদ্ধ ।
'দ্বিতীয় চতুর্ব্যূহ' এই — তুরীয়, বিশুদ্ধ ॥ ৪১ ॥

vāsudeva-saṅkarṣaṇa-pradyumnāniruddha
Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa Pradyumna Aniruddha
'dvitīya catur-vyūha' ei — turīya, viśuddha
the second catur-vyūha this transcendent pure

41 Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — this is the second catur-vyūha, transcendent and pure.

Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of the second catur-vyūha is the original shelter of the cit-śakti —

তাঁহা যে রামের রূপ — মহাসঙ্কর্ষণ ।
চিচ্ছক্তি-আশ্রয় তিঁহো, কারণের কারণ ॥ ৪২ ॥

tāṁhā ye rāmera rūpa — mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa
there which of Rāma form Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa
cic-chakti-āśraya tiṁho, kāraṇera kāraṇa
of the spiritual potency the shelter He of causes the cause

42 There the form of Rāma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is the shelter of the spiritual potency, the cause of all causes.

The splendour of that form is a transformation of the sandhinī of the cit-śakti —

চিচ্ছক্তিবিলাস এক — 'শুদ্ধসত্ত্ব'-নাম ।
শুদ্ধসত্ত্বময় যত বৈকুণ্ঠাদি-ধাম ॥ ৪৩ ॥

cic-chakti-vilāsa eka — 'śuddha-sattva'-nāma
of the spiritual potency a manifestation one śuddha-sattva named
śuddha-sattva-maya yata vaikuṇṭhādi-dhāma
of śuddha-sattva made all Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes

43 One manifestation of the spiritual potency is called *śuddha-sattva*, pure spiritual existence, and of it all the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha are made.

The six opulences and all the rest are the spiritual splendour of Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa —

ষড়্বিধৈশ্বর্য্য তাঁহা সকল চিন্ময় ।
সঙ্কর্ষণের বিভূতি সব, জানিহ নিশ্চয় ॥ ৪৪ ॥

ṣaḍ-vidhaiśvarya tāṁhā sakala cinmaya
of six kinds opulence there all spiritual
saṅkarṣaṇera vibhūti saba, jāniha niścaya
of Saṅkarṣaṇa the splendour all know for certain

44 The six kinds of opulence there are all spiritual; know for certain that all of them are the splendour of Saṅkarṣaṇa.

Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of the jīva-śakti —

'জীব' নাম তটস্থাখ্য এক শক্তি হয় ।
মহাসঙ্কর্ষণ — সব জীবের আশ্রয় ॥ ৪৫ ॥

'jīva' nāma taṭasthākhya eka śakti haya
jīva named marginal called one potency there is
mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa — saba jīvera āśraya
Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa of all jīvas the shelter

45 There is a potency called *jīva*, known as the marginal (*taṭasthā*) potency; and Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all jīvas.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The *catur-vyūha* of Dvārakā — Kṛṣṇa, Baladeva and the others — is manifest a second time in Paravyoma. This *catur-vyūha* is called "the second *catur-vyūha*"; it too is spiritual and pure. There the form of Balarāma is Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. In Paravyoma there is a manifestation of the *sandhinī* aspect of the *cit-śakti* called "*śuddha-sattva*"; from it come the abodes of Vaikuṇṭha and the rest, made of *śuddha-sattva*, and the six kinds of majesty. All this is the splendour (*vibhūti*) of Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa. Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of all jīvas, and therefore the

shelter of the *jīva-śakti*, called marginal (*taṭastha*). The being of the jīva, a particle of spirit, springs from the *jīva-śakti*, yet it is made such that the *māyā-śakti* can overpower it. It therefore stands on the border between two realms — māyā and spirit (*cit*) — and so has received the name "marginal" (*taṭastha*).

A part of Saṅkarṣaṇa — Viṣṇu who lies in the Causal Ocean —

যাঁহা হৈতে বিশ্বোৎপত্তি, যাঁহাতে প্রলয় ।
সেই পুরুষের সঙ্কর্ষণ সমাশ্রয় ॥ ৪৬ ॥

yāṁhā haite viśvotpatti, yāṁhāte pralaya
from whom of the universe the origin in whom the dissolution
sei puruṣera saṅkarṣaṇa samāśraya
of that Puruṣa Saṅkarṣaṇa the shelter

46 Saṅkarṣaṇa is the shelter of the Puruṣa from whom the universe arises and into whom it dissolves.

সর্ব্বাশ্রয়, সর্ব্বাদ্ভুত, ঐশ্বর্য্য অপার ।
'অনন্ত' কহিতে নারে মহিমা যাঁহার ॥ ৪৭ ॥

sarvāśraya, sarvādbhuta, aiśvarya apāra
of all the shelter all-wondrous opulence boundless
'ananta' kahite nāre mahimā yāṁhāra
Ananta to describe cannot the glory whose

47 He is the shelter of all, wondrous in every way, His opulence boundless; even Ananta cannot describe His glory.

তুরীয়, বিশুদ্ধসত্ত্ব, 'সঙ্কর্ষণ' নাম ।
তিঁহো যাঁর অংশ, সেই নিত্যানন্দ-রাম ॥ ৪৮ ॥

turīya, viśuddha-sattva, 'saṅkarṣaṇa' nāma
transcendent pure sattva Saṅkarṣaṇa named
tiṁho yāṁra aṁśa, sei nityānanda-rāma
He whose part that Nityānanda-Rāma

48 The transcendent Saṅkarṣaṇa, pure spiritual existence (*viśuddha-sattva*), is a part of Nityānanda-Rāma.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa is spiritual, pure *sattva* (*viśuddha-sattva*); He is a limb (*aṅga*), that is, a manifestation (*prakāśa*), of Nityānanda-Rāma.

Anubhāṣya.
The verse itself reads *aṁśa* ("portion"), the *Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya* reads *aṅga* ("body"); both readings convey the same meaning.

Anubhāṣya.
Saṅkarṣaṇa is another name for "Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa" (He is described below, in 42–48).

In the second *pāda* of the second chapter of the *Brahma-sūtra*, in the *Utpatty-asambhava-adhikaraṇa*, Śrī Śaṅkarācārya in his commentary put forward a mistaken argument about the *catur-vyūha*. Settling the matter, the author refutes that doctrine in 41–47. Śrīpāda [Śaṅkara] erred in taking Viṣṇu, the nondual Knowledge (*advaya-jñāna*), for one of the objects of the visible world; in the *Pañcarātra* Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself made this clear to him. Yet to bewilder the conditioned jīvas of demoniac nature he had to resort to deception (*vipralipsā*). Because of this the followers of Advaita — Appayya Dīkṣita and others — have reached the utmost limit of error. With the capacities of conditioned jīvas, knowledge of the *catur-vyūha* is not possible. The ācārya spoke such ill words to increase their folly. The *catur-vyūha* is made of *śuddha-sattva*, delights in the play of the *cit-śakti* and possesses the six kinds of majesty. To call Them poor and powerless, and to think of Them so, is the trait of deluded jīvas. Such jīvas are fit only to be bewildered by māyā. Whoever cannot understand [the difference between] Vaikuṇṭha and the realm of māyā falls into just this kind of error. In his commentary on sūtras 42–45 of the second *pāda* of the second chapter of the *Brahma-sūtra*, Śrīpāda Śaṅkara made a vain attempt to refute "the doctrine of the *catur-vyūha*." Below are quoted from Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya's commentary his words on the "*catur-vyūha*," rooted in his distorted understanding.

Utpatty-asambhavāt (42) (Śaṅkara's commentary): * * * "On this the Bhāgavatas hold: Bhagavān Vāsudeva alone, stainless, whose nature is knowledge, is the highest reality. Dividing Himself fourfold, He abides in the form of the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva, the *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa, the *vyūha* of Pradyumna and the *vyūha* of

Aniruddha. Vāsudeva is the name for the Supreme Self, Saṅkarṣaṇa for the jīva, Pradyumna for the mind, Aniruddha for the ego (*ahaṅkāra*). Of these, Vāsudeva is the highest *prakṛti*, and the others — Saṅkarṣaṇa and the rest — are effects. To this we say: what is asserted — that the supreme Nārāyaṇa, the Supreme Self, the Self of all, by Himself dividing Himself in many ways, abides in the form of *vyūhas* — is not refuted. But what is said further — that from Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa is born, from Saṅkarṣaṇa Pradyumna, and from Pradyumna Aniruddha — to this we say: the birth of the jīva called Saṅkarṣaṇa from the Supreme Self called Vāsudeva is impossible, for then defects such as impermanence would follow. If the jīva were born, defects such as impermanence would attach to it, and then liberation — attaining Bhagavān — would be impossible for it, for an effect, on reaching its cause, would dissolve into it. And the Ācārya will reject the birth of the jīva [by the sūtra] 'The self [is not born], because *śruti* does not speak [of its birth], and because of eternity [known] from them.' Therefore their construction is incoherent."

The meaning of the commentary is this: "The Bhāgavatas hold that Bhagavān Vāsudeva is one, stainless, His body is knowledge, and He is the highest reality. He Himself has divided Himself into four and so abides. These four *vyūhas* are: 1) the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva, 2) the *vyūha* of Saṅkarṣaṇa, 3) the *vyūha* of Pradyumna, 4) the *vyūha* of Aniruddha; these four *vyūhas* are His body. Another name of Vāsudeva is 'Paramātmā'; of Saṅkarṣaṇa, '*jīva*'; of Pradyumna, 'mind'; and of Aniruddha, '*ahaṅkāra*.' Of the four *vyūhas*, the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva is the highest *prakṛti*, that is, the root cause. Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others have arisen from the *vyūha* of Vāsudeva, and so Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the effects of that highest *prakṛti*. For a long time the jīva goes to the temple of Bhagavān, gathers [the articles of worship], performs worship (*ijyā*), studies [scripture] and practices yoga; thus it becomes free from sin, obtains a pure body and attains the highest *prakṛti*, Bhagavān. The great-souled Bhāgavatas say that Nārāyaṇa is beyond *prakṛti*, renowned as the Paramātmā, and is the Self of all — this does not contradict *śruti*. We also accept that He by Himself abides in the form of many *vyūhas*. Therefore this part of the Bhāgavata doctrine is not refuted by this sūtra. The Ācārya composed this sūtra only to reject the part where the Bhāgavatas say that from Vāsudeva Saṅkarṣaṇa was born, from Saṅkarṣaṇa Pradyumna, and from Pradyumna Aniruddha. The birth of the jīva called Saṅkarṣaṇa from the Paramātmā called Vāsudeva is utterly impossible: the jīva would then be subject to defects such as impermanence. If the jīva is born, defects such as impermanence are unavoidable for it. And if the jīva is perishable by nature, liberation — attaining

Bhagavān — is impossible for it altogether. When the cause perishes, the effect must perish too. Ācārya Vedavyāsa rejected the birth of the jīva by the sūtra of the third *pāda* of the second chapter, 'The self [is not born], because *śruti* does not speak [of its birth], and because of eternity [known] from them,' and by rejecting its birth he will prove its eternity. Therefore this construction is incoherent."

Na ca kartuḥ karaṇam (43) (Śaṅkara's commentary): "For this reason too their construction is incoherent: in the world we do not see an instrument, such as an axe, arising from an agent such as Devadatta. Yet the Bhāgavatas describe that from the agent, the jīva called Saṅkarṣaṇa, there arises the instrument, the mind called Pradyumna, and from that, born of the agent, arises the ego called Aniruddha. Without an example we cannot accept this. Nor do we find any such *śruti*."

The meaning of the commentary is this: "There is a reason why such a construction is incoherent. In the world we do not see an instrument — a sickle and the like — arising from an agent such as Devadatta. Yet the Bhāgavatas describe that from the agent, the jīva named Saṅkarṣaṇa, there arose the instrument, the mind named Pradyumna, and from that Pradyumna, born of the agent, arises Aniruddha, the *ahaṅkāra*. If the Bhāgavatas cannot explain this by an example, how can it be accepted? Nor do we hear any words of *śruti* that disclose this truth."

Vijñānādi-bhāve vā tad-apratiṣedhaḥ (44) (Śaṅkara's commentary): "It may also be said thus: Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others are not meant as the jīva and the rest. What, then? All of them are accepted as Lords, endowed with the attributes of the Lord — knowledge, sovereignty, power, strength, valour and splendour; all of them are Vāsudevas, faultless, without [external] support, untainted. Therefore the defect described — the impossibility of origin — does not apply to them. To this it is said: even so, *tad-apratiṣedhaḥ* — the impossibility of origin is still not removed. The point is that this defect, the impossibility of origin, arises in another way. How? If the intention is that these four — Vāsudeva and the others — are Lords distinct from one another, of equal attributes, and have no single self, then positing many Lords is pointless, for the Lord's work is accomplished by one Lord alone. And their own doctrine collapses, since they accept that Bhagavān Vāsudeva alone is the highest reality. If, however, the intention is that these four *vyūhas* of equal attributes belong to one Bhagavān, the impossibility of origin remains as before. For Saṅkarṣaṇa cannot arise from Vāsudeva, nor Pradyumna from Saṅkarṣaṇa, nor Aniruddha from Pradyumna, since there is no pre-eminence (*atiśaya*) among them. Between effect and cause there must be pre-eminence, as between clay and pot.

Without pre-eminence one cannot establish which is the effect and which the cause. And the followers of the *Pañcarātra* doctrine accept no difference — whether in any one of them or in all — arising from greater or lesser knowledge, sovereignty and the like: they hold all the *vyūhas* to be Vāsudeva without distinction. Nor would the *vyūhas* of Bhagavān stop at the number four, for the whole world, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, is understood to be a *vyūha* of Bhagavān."

The meaning of the commentary is this: "The Bhāgavatas may also intend the following: Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others named are not of the nature of the jīva; all of them are Lords, all possess the potency of knowledge and the potency of sovereignty, are endowed with power, valour and splendour, all are Vāsudeva, all are faultless, without [external] support and untainted. So the defect of impossibility of origin does not apply to them. To this we say: even with such an intention the defect of impossibility of origin is not removed — it remains, only in another form. Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are different from one another and not of one self, and at the same time all are alike in attributes and all are Lords. If this is meant, one must accept many Lords. But there is no need to accept many Lords: the purpose is served by accepting one Lord. Moreover, since it is asserted that Bhagavān Vāsudeva is one, that is, without a second, and is the highest reality, the defect of contradicting one's own doctrine (*siddhānta-hāni*) also arises. And if this *catur-vyūha* belongs to Bhagavān Himself and They are all alike in attributes, the defect of impossibility of origin still cannot be avoided. For without some pre-eminence (inequality — more or less) Saṅkarṣaṇa cannot be born of Vāsudeva, Pradyumna of Saṅkarṣaṇa, or Aniruddha of Pradyumna. One must accept that there is some distinction between effect and cause, as when a pot comes from clay. Without pre-eminence one cannot point out which is the effect and which the cause. And consider further: the adherents of the *Pañcarātra* doctrine do not accept a difference between Vāsudeva and the others in greater or lesser knowledge and so on; on the contrary, they honour the four *vyūhas* as Vāsudeva without distinction. Are the *vyūhas* of Bhagavān exhausted by the number four? Certainly not. Both *śruti* and *smṛti* prove that the whole world, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, is a *vyūha* of Bhagavān."

Vipratiṣedhāc ca (45) (Śaṅkara's commentary): "And in this scripture many kinds of contradiction are found, such as the positing of quality and possessor of qualities. For we see [statements such as]: 'Knowledge, sovereignty, power, strength, valour and splendour are qualities; and they are the Self, the Bhagavāns, the Vāsudevas.'"

The meaning of the commentary is this: “In the *Pañcarātra* and other scriptures of the Bhāgavatas many contradictory constructions are seen — for instance, on the relation of quality and its possessor. It is in no way possible to be at once the quality and the possessor of qualities. Yet the Bhāgavatas say that the potency of knowledge, the potency of sovereignty, power, valour and splendour — these qualities — and Pradyumna and the others, though different, are the Self and Bhagavān Vāsudeva.”

In reply to this doctrine of Śrīpāda Śaṅkarācārya, Śrī Rūpa Prabhu writes in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (describing the *catur-vyūha*, verses 80–83): “Of the four *vyūhas* renowned by the name ‘Mahāvasthā,’ He [Vāsudeva] is the first; He is to be worshipped in the *citta*, for He is its presiding deity (*adhidaivata*). He is also spoken of as the seat of *viśuddha-sattva*. His own part is Bhagavān Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa. This Saṅkarṣaṇa is regarded as the second *vyūha*; He may also be called the jīva, for He is the place from which all jīvas become manifest. His lustre is sweeter than myriads of full autumn moons. He is worshipped in the *ahaṅkāra*; He has placed His own part in Śeṣa. Becoming the indwelling ruler (*antaryāmī*) of Rudra, the enemy of Smara (Kāma), and of *adharma*, the serpents, Antaka and the enemies of the gods, He brings about the destruction of the world. The third *vyūha* is Pradyumna, renowned as His *vilāsa*. The wise worship this Pradyumna in the *buddhi-tattva*. In Ilāvṛta the goddess Śrī serves Him, singing His praises. His lustre is like pure *jāmbūnada* gold, and in places like a dark rain-cloud. He is the source of the creation of the universe; He has placed His own part in Kāma. Becoming the indwelling ruler of Vidhi (Brahmā), the Prajāpatis, the attached and Smara, He properly accomplishes creation. The fourth *vyūha* is Aniruddha, praised as His *vilāsa*. The thoughtful worship this Aniruddha in the *manas-tattva*. Like a dark-blue cloud, He is intent on protecting the universe. Becoming the indwelling ruler of Dharma, the Manus, the gods and kings, He maintains the world. In the *Mokṣa-dharma*, however, it is said that Pradyumna is the presiding deity of the mind and Aniruddha of the *ahaṅkāra*. Yet the order given [above] is accepted in all the *Pañcarātras*. The *Padma Purāṇa*, however, says that the four *vyūhas* — Vāsudeva and the others — abide in order in the four directions of Paramavyoma, beginning with the east.”

Of the four renowned *vyūhas* of Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Mahā-Vaikuṇṭha in Paravyoma, called “Mahāvasthā,” this Vāsudeva is “the first *vyūha*.” He is to be worshipped in the *citta*, for He is its presiding deity and abides in *viśuddha-sattva* (*Bhāgavatam* 4.3.23). Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa is His own part, that is, His *vilāsa*.

Saṅkarṣaṇa is called "the second *vyūha*," and since He is the source from which all jīvas become manifest, He is also called "*jīva*." The radiance of His body is sweeter than the white rays of countless full autumn moons. He is worshipped in the *ahaṅkāra-tattva*. He has invested His supporting potency (*ādhāra-śakti*) in Anantadeva, and as the *antaryāmī* of Rudra, the enemy of Smara, and of *adharma*, the serpents, Antaka and the *asuras*, He carries out the destruction of the world. The *vilāsa-mūrti* of that Saṅkarṣaṇa is Pradyumna, the third *vyūha*. The wise worship this Pradyumna in the *buddhi-tattva*. The goddess Lakṣmī serves Him in Ilāvṛta-varṣa, singing of His qualities. The radiance of His body is in some places like molten *jāmbūnada* gold, in others like a fresh dark rain-cloud. He is the source of the creation of the universe; He has invested His creative potency in Kandarpa. As the *antaryāmī* of the creator (Vidhātā), of all the Prajāpatis, of beings attached to sense objects — gods, humans and others — and of Kandarpa, He accomplishes creation. His *vilāsa-mūrti* is the fourth *vyūha*, Aniruddha. The thoughtful worship this Aniruddha in the *manas-tattva*. The radiance of His body is like a dark-blue cloud. He is intent on protecting the universe. As the *antaryāmī* of Dharma, the Manus, the gods and kings, He maintains the world. The *Mokṣa-dharma* names Pradyumna the presiding deity of the mind and Aniruddha the presiding deity of the *ahaṅkāra*. The order stated before (that is, that Pradyumna is the presiding deity of *buddhi* and Aniruddha of the mind) is accepted by all kinds of *Pañcarātra*. [The *Padma Purāṇa*, however, describes the four *vyūhas* — Vāsudeva and the others — as abiding in order in the four directions of Paravyoma, beginning with the east.]

On the *vilāsa* of Bhagavān and His inconceivable potency the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* (44–66) says: "But surely we hear in scripture the words of the *Mahā-varāha Purāṇa*: 'All the bodies of that Supreme Self are eternal and everlasting; they are neither given up nor taken on, and never anywhere born of *prakṛti*. They are masses of supreme bliss, knowledge through and through; all are full of every excellence and free from every fault.' And in the *Śrī Nārada-pañcarātra*: 'As a gem, joined with blue, yellow and other colours, takes on different appearances, so Acyuta [appears differently] according to the difference of meditation.' How, then, do you explain gradation (*tāratamya*) among Them? To this it is said: oneness and separateness, and likewise being a part and being the whole, are quite fitting in Him, the One, by His inconceivable, unlimited potency. Separate manifestation within oneness — as [in the *Bhāgavatam* 10.69.2]: 'How wonderful! The one [Kṛṣṇa], in one body, at the same time married sixteen thousand women in separate

palaces.' Oneness of form within separateness — as in the *Padma Purāṇa*: 'That God, the Supreme Person, beyond the *guṇas*, having become many, again becomes one and lies down — the faultless Hari, the original creator.' That one and the same is both part and whole and has opposing potencies — as [in the *Bhāgavatam* 10.40.7]: 'Those absorbed in You worship You, who have many forms and one form.' And in the *Kūrma Purāṇa*: 'He is neither large nor small, yet in every way large and small; He is said to be colourless in every way, yet He is dark, with eyes reddish at the corners. Because He possesses majesty, Bhagavān is said to have opposing attributes. Yet faults are in no way to be ascribed to the Supreme; these attributes, though opposed, are to be reconciled in Him in every respect.' In the sixth canto — on His inconceivable potency that unites opposites — in prose (*Bhāgavatam* 6.9.34–37): 'This play of Yours seems hard to understand: without needing support, without a body, without waiting for our help, You Yourself, remaining unchanged — beyond the *guṇas* — create, destroy and maintain this world endowed with the *guṇas*. So do You, like a Devadatta here, fallen into the stream of the *guṇas*, out of dependence accept the fruits of Your good and bad deeds? Or, delighting in Yourself, tranquil, seeing all equally, do You remain indifferent? Truly, we do not know. For in You — Bhagavān, the Lord of countless excellences, whose greatness is unfathomable — the two do not contradict each other. You are beyond the reach of the disputes of disputants whose hearts and intentions are shaped by recent fancies, doubts, deliberations, false proofs and scriptures of bad logic, and who cling stubbornly to their views. In You, the One, in whom all that is made of māyā has ceased — when Your own māyā is set in between — what thing could be hard to accomplish? You have no two natures; yet You follow the opinions of people of even and uneven minds, as a piece of rope [seems] a snake and the like to those who think so.'

"Here are the *kārikās*: 'Without bodily effort, without the support of earth and the like, without helpers — the work of You, the changeless, is very hard to understand. By "the stream of the *guṇas*" the battles of the gods and *asuras* and so on are meant. "Fallen" means attached to it; that would be dependence — for Your dependence on the gods who have taken shelter of You is born of mercy. Hence: "Your own deeds," that is, the good and the other, done by Your own [gods], in the form of happiness, suffering and so on — do You accept these as Your fruit? Or, delighting in Yourself, do You remain wholly indifferent to them? We do not know. But in You the two are not contradictory at all. The reason is given by the two words beginning with *bhagavati*, and likewise by the five words beginning with *īśvare*. By

the word “Bhagavān” omniscience is clearly indicated, by another word the possession of good qualities, and by the word *kevala* the nature of Brahman. Though by the nature of Brahman there would be indifference everywhere, the first two qualities give partiality towards the devotees. “But how can one nature be twofold at one and the same time?” To this he says, “recent …” and so on — for You are beyond the disputes of such disputants, beyond their range. Therefore, when that inconceivable potency of Your own is set in between, what thing, even a contradictory one, could be hard to accomplish here? For such indeed is its inconceivability. And that it is inconceivable is understood from its being the support of many opposing actions. The author of the *Brahma-sūtra* says: “Because of *śruti*, because the basis is the word.” And the *Skanda Purāṇa*: “What is inconceivable should not be subjected to reasoning.” This is seen even in gems and the like. Without such potency the Supreme Lord’s supreme lordship would not be established, for His greatness is spoken of as unfathomable. Ignorance or sorcery (*indra-jāla*) can be seen anywhere; therefore the Lord’s supreme lordship is not established by them. That these are not in Him is clearly stated by the words “in whom has ceased ….” Otherwise the six words beginning with *bhagavati* would have been used to no purpose. Therefore, by scripture and by reason, the two do not contradict each other. Yet according to the opinions of people of high and low minds, who do not know the truth, You appear now this way, now that, like the rope. “But surely knowledge alone is Brahman, while Bhagavān has many attributes; so here too two natures are seen.” To this he says, “… no two natures …” — for there is never duality in His nature: these are certainly two attributes of the One. Therefore, if contradiction is seen in the manifestations (*vilāsas*) of His potency, that is His inconceivable majesty: it adorns Him and is no fault. The same statement of contradiction is found in the third canto too (*Bhāgavatam* 3.4.16): “You are free from desire, yet You act; You are unborn, yet You take birth; You are Time itself, yet in fear of an enemy You take refuge in a fortress and flee; You delight in Yourself, yet You live as a householder among many women. Here the intelligence of the wise is bewildered.” If all this were not real, the intelligence of the wise would not be bewildered. Thus the cause in the pastimes is the inconceivable potency alone: as His will is, so it manifests.’”

Here the following objection may be raised. In the *Mahā-varāha Purāṇa* we hear: “All the bodies of that Supreme Self, Hari, are eternal, and all of them appear in the world again and again. These bodies are neither given up nor taken on, and so they are never products of *prakṛti*. All these bodies are condensed supreme bliss, by na-

ture of the single taste of spirit; they are endowed with every spiritual quality and free from every fault." And the *Nārada-pañcarātra* says: "As a *vaidūrya* gem takes on blue, yellow and other colours in different places, so Bhagavān Acyuta, according to the difference of worship, manifests His form in different ways." Why, then, do you explain a gradation among these avatāras? In answer to this doubt it may be said: by the power of His inconceivable, unlimited potency, in one vessel — in one and the same Puruṣottama — oneness and separateness, being a part and being the whole, are in no way impossible or incongruous. Separate manifestation within oneness — as in the Tenth Canto (the words of Nārada): "How wonderful! One and the same Śrī Kṛṣṇa at one and the same time married sixteen thousand women in separate palaces." Oneness of form within separateness — as in the *Padma Purāṇa*: "That faultless original creator, beyond the *guṇas*, Puruṣottama, the God Hari, having taken many forms, again lies down in one form." That one and the same is both part and whole and has opposing potencies — as in the Tenth Canto: "You, of many forms, are one; the devotees whose minds are absorbed in You worship You." And the *Kūrma Purāṇa* says: "Bhagavān is in every respect not large, yet large; not small, yet small; colourless, yet dark, with eyes reddish at the corners. By the power of His majesty He is called the possessor of opposing forms. Yet faults are in no way to be ascribed to the Supreme Lord; on the contrary, all these mutually opposed qualities are to be reconciled in Him in every respect." And the prose of the Sixth Canto speaks of His inconceivable potency that unites opposites: "O Bhagavān, Your transcendental play, or sport, seems hard to understand; that is, the ordinary relation of cause and effect is not seen in You. For You need no support, make no bodily effort, are Yourself beyond the *guṇas* and do not wait for our help — and by Your own nature alone You create, maintain and destroy this world endowed with the *guṇas*, without undergoing any change at all. O Lord, do You, like an ordinary man named Devadatta, fallen into the stream of the *guṇas* in this world, out of dependence regard as Your own the fruits of action — happiness, suffering and the like? Or, without losing Your *cit-śakti*, delighting in Yourself and at peace, do You remain indifferent to all this, that is, abide only as a witness? This we do not know. You are full of the six opulences, Your excellences cannot be counted to the end, You are the Lord, the ruler of all, and Your greatness cannot become the object of anyone's intellect. There are disputants whose intelligence is covered and scattered by fancies that claim to reveal the nature of things, by doubts, deliberations, false proofs and scriptures full of bad logic; their disputes cannot touch You. In You, the possessor of inconceivable potency, both of these qualities are not opposed to each other. You are beyond all material knowledge and

consist of pure knowledge alone; when Your potency of will is set in between, what work could be hard to accomplish in You? The impersonal and the personal, or that which has spiritual qualities and that which is without qualities, are not two different natures of Yours: they are only two perceptions of Your one nature, according to the difference of conceptions. But just as, for those whose minds are occupied with a snake and the like, one piece of rope appears in different forms — as a snake and so on — so You follow the intentions of those whose minds are even and uneven, that is, unsteady — that is, You manifest different doctrines among them."

Here is the *kārikā* on this passage: "Without bodily effort, without the support of earth and the like, without helpers — the stick, the wheel and so on — Your work, free from change, is very hard to understand. By 'the stream of the *guṇas*' the battles of the gods and *asuras* and the like are meant. 'Fallen' means attached; this is what is called *pāratantrya*, that is, dependence. For Your dependence on the gods who have taken shelter of You is born of mercy (that is, Your independence does not suffer by it). Therefore — do You regard as Your own 'Your own deeds,' that is, 'the deeds of Your own people' — the good and bad fruits in the form of happiness, suffering and the like earned by Your gods? Or, delighting in Yourself, do You remain wholly indifferent to them? This we do not know. But in You (the possessor of opposing qualities) both are possible. The reason is the two epithets beginning with *bhagavati* and the five epithets beginning with *īśvare*. Of these, by the word *bhagavat* omniscience is clearly understood, by the epithet *aparigaṇita* and the others the possession of good qualities, and by the word *kevala* the nature of Brahman. Though by the nature of Brahman one might expect indifference everywhere, the two qualities beginning with *bhagavati* make partiality towards the devotees possible. If you say, 'How can one nature be twofold at the same time?' — in answer to this doubt it is said, '*arvācīna* …' and so on; that is, You are beyond the disputes of those disputants who cannot grasp the nature of the Truth — You are out of their reach. Therefore, when the inconceivable potency of Your own is set in between, what work, even a contradictory one, could be hard to accomplish in You? Your nature is inconceivable to disputants who lack devotion; Your potency is likewise inconceivable. Only by seeing that it is the support of many opposing actions can one infer that this potency of Yours is inconceivable. The author of the *Brahma-sūtra* has said: 'The inconceivable object of service is within the reach of *śruti* alone, that is, of the evidence of the word.' And the *Skanda Purāṇa* says: 'One should not build inferences about the inconceivable.' Such inconceivable power can be noticed even in material gems, potent herbs and the like.

Without such inconceivable potency the Supreme Lord's supreme lordship could not be established. It is by the power of this inconceivable potency that the Lord's greatness is glorified as unfathomable. Ignorance and the art of sorcery can be seen anywhere; therefore ignorance, sorcery and the like do not prove the Supreme Lord's supreme lordship. For the epithet *uparata* and the others show that neither is present in the Lord. If ignorance and sorcery were accepted in the Lord, the use of the six epithets beginning with *bhagavati* would become pointless. Therefore, by the scripture and reasoning that reveal the inconceivable potency, these two qualities — that He protects the universe and that He is indifferent to it — cannot contradict each other. Just as for those whose minds, through ignorance, are occupied with a snake and the like, a piece of rope appears as a snake and so on, so You, for those whose thoughts are occupied with various conceptions and who therefore lack true knowledge, appear in this or that way according to their opinions. If you say, 'Knowledge alone is called Brahman, and that which bears many attributes is called "Bhagavān"; so here two different natures are seen,' — to remove this doubt it is said, 'for there are not two natures.' By this no duality at all is asserted of His nature; only two attributes of one and the same nature are determined. Therefore, if contradiction is seen in the manifestations of His potency, that is called inconceivable majesty: it adorns Him and is no fault at all. Such contradiction is mentioned in the Third Canto too: 'Action in Him who is free from material endeavour; birth in the Unborn; He who is Time itself takes refuge in a fortress out of fear of the enemy and flees from Mathurā; He who delights in Himself enjoys with sixteen thousand women — in all this even the intelligence of the knowers of truth is bewildered.' If all these deeds were not real, the intelligence of the knowers of truth would never be bewildered. Thus the cause of the pastimes is Bhagavān's inconceivable potency: as His will is, such are the pastimes it manifests."

The *Pañcarātra* scripture is a book that unfolds the Vedas; it is wholly approved by the Vedas and devoted to the section on worship (*upāsanā-kāṇḍa*). It is not a *rājasic* or *tāmasic tantra*: the wise know it as the "*Sātvata-saṁhitā*." Śrī Nārāyaṇa Himself spoke it; this is specially stated in the *Mahābhārata*, in the *Mokṣa-dharma-parva* of the *Śānti-parva*, Chapters 3–9, verse 68. It was propagated by divine sages (*divya-sūris*) — Śrī Nārada and others — free from the four defects beginning with *bhrama*. The book *Śrī Bhāgavatam* is also known as the "*Sātvata-saṁhitā*." Śaṅkara puts forward as a *pūrvapakṣa*, as if it were the *Pañcarātra* doctrine, what is wholly opposed and contrary to that doctrine, and then tries to refute

it. This is merely an utter violation of logic and truth, and below it is shown briefly by way of refutation.

(1) In his commentary on sūtra 42 Śrīpāda Śaṅkara called Saṅkarṣaṇa "the jīva." In fact the Bhāgavatas have never called Saṅkarṣaṇa "the jīva." He Himself is Adhokṣaja, Acyuta, *viṣṇu-tattva*, the presiding Lord of the jīva, the complete whole (*aṁśī*), all-pervading consciousness (*vibhu-caitanya*), the cause of all material and transcendental creation — not the jīva, a part, a minute consciousness (*aṇu-caitanya*). The *jīvātmā* has neither birth nor death — this is accepted by the Bhāgavatas and by any follower of *śruti* who studies and hears the scriptures.

(2) In reply to the commentary on sūtra 43: the manifestation of all the other *viṣṇu-tattvas* from *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa* is described in the *Brahma-saṁhitā*: "As the flame of a lamp, passing to another [wick], itself shines as a lamp, with the same qualities though its cause is separate, so He who in just this way shines forth as Viṣṇu — Govinda, the original Puruṣa — Him I worship." That is: "As the ray of a lamp on another base acts as a separate lamp — having the same qualities as the first lamp — so the original Puruṣa Govinda manifests Himself by becoming Viṣṇu. Him I worship."

(3) In the commentary on sūtra 44 Śrīpāda puts forward the *pūrvapakṣa*: "They are different from one another and not of one self." The followers of the *Pañcarātra* never accept this as their doctrine. In his commentary on sūtra 42, as quoted above, Śrīpāda Śaṅkara himself accepted: "that He by Himself, dividing Himself in many ways, abides in the form of *vyūhas* — this is not refuted," that is, "that He by Himself abides in the form of many *vyūhas* we too accept as agreeing with *śruti*." This contradicts the *pūrvapakṣa* objection in this sūtra. In other words, his commentaries on sūtras 44 and 42 contradict each other: what he accepted before, he now tries to refute as a *pūrvapakṣa*. By accepting the *catur-vyūha* of Nārāyaṇa the Bhāgavatas do not thereby accept "a doctrine of many Lords." They know the Truth as Bhagavān, nondual Knowledge, and never preach a plurality of Gods contrary to the Vedas. They firmly believe in the inconceivable great potency of Śrī Nārāyaṇa. See the paraphrase of the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* given above. Among these four *tattvas* — Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha — there is no relation of cause and effect: "there is nothing else beyond the existent and the nonexistent"; "this difference between body and the possessor of the body never exists in the Lord" (*Kūrma Purāṇa*). All of Them are the *tattva* that rules over māyā, the presiding Lords of *śuddha-sattva*, *turīya*; in Their manifestation there can be no power of māyā, no change, no transformation, no fragmentation. They

are the one nondual Knowledge, Adhokṣaja, the complete Reality. The evidence of *śruti*: "Oṁ. That is full, this is full; from the full the full comes forth. When the full is taken from the full, the full remains." (*Bṛhad-āraṇyaka Upaniṣad* 5.1.) The whole world, from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, is the gross, external manifestation of Bhagavān Viṣṇu. Those who teach the merging of spirit and matter (*cid-acit-samanvaya*) vainly try to identify it with, or make it equal to, the Śrī *catur-vyūha*, the Lord of the three potencies. This is mere atheism rooted in extreme enmity towards Bhagavān. The world from Brahmā down to a blade of grass, or the universal form of Viṣṇu, is His external splendour, the *eka-pāda-vibhūti*; it is connected with māyā, or *prakṛti*, and is therefore material. To think the *catur-vyūha*, the Lord of spirit and matter, equal to it, or to strive to make it so, is the trait of the *māyāvādīs*.

(4) In reply to the commentary on sūtra 45 — a paraphrase of the words quoted in the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta* in describing the transcendence of Bhagavān's qualities (97–99): "If you say, 'Every quality is a product of *prakṛti* and therefore like a mirage; what wonder, then, that they cannot be counted?' — you have no right to say so. Bhagavān's qualities can never be material: all His qualities constitute His very nature, and so all of them are certainly, by nature, bliss. As in the *Brahma-tarka*: 'Bhagavān Hari possesses qualities that constitute His own nature; therefore the qualities of Viṣṇu and of liberated jīvas are never separate from their nature.' In the *Śrī Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: 'May Hari be gracious — the supreme, utterly pure, original Puruṣa, the Supreme Lord untouched by the material qualities such as *sattva*.' And in that same *Viṣṇu Purāṇa*: 'Knowledge, power, strength, sovereignty, valour and splendour in their fullness — without the *heya*, that is, material, qualities — are what the word *bhagavat* denotes.' And in the *Padma Purāṇa*: 'That the Supreme Lord is glorified in scripture as *nirguṇa* (without qualities) means only that He has no *heya*, that is, material, qualities.' And in the first chapter of the first canto: 'O Dharma, the qualities I have listed, and many other great qualities, abide eternally in Śrī Kṛṣṇa; the qualities sought by those who desire greatness never leave Śrī Kṛṣṇa.'[19] Thus this Śrī Kṛṣṇa possesses countless transcendental qualities and boundless potency, and His form is a mass of complete bliss." See *Bhāgavatam* 3.26.21, 25, 27, 28.

A paraphrase of how Śrī Rāmānujapāda refuted Śaṅkara's arguments in his *Śrī-bhāṣya*:

Śrī Śaṅkara rejected certain parts even of the *Pañcarātra* scripture, spoken by Bhagavān and leading to the highest good: he suspected that, like the scriptures of Kapila and others, they contradict *śruti* and are therefore not authoritative. The *Pañcarātra* scripture says: "From Vāsudeva, the supreme cause, whose nature is Brahman, was born the jīva named 'Saṅkarṣaṇa'; from Saṅkarṣaṇa, the mind named 'Pradyumna'; and from the mind, the *ahaṅkāra* named 'Aniruddha.'" [The objection is:] one cannot speak here of the birth of the jīva, for that contradicts *śruti*. With the words "The spiritual *jīvātmā* is never born and never dies" (*Kaṭha Upaniṣad* 2.18), all the *śrutis* speak of the jīva as beginningless, that is, as unborn. Therefore what is meant here is the appearance of the presiding deities of the jīva, the mind and the *ahaṅkāra* (*sūtra* 42).

It is said that from Saṅkarṣaṇa the mind named Pradyumna is born. Here too it is impossible for the instrument, the mind, to be born from the agent, the jīva, for *śruti* says that "the vital breath, the mind and all the senses are born from the Paramātmā." If, then, the mind is said to be born from the jīva, this contradicts such words of *śruti* as "they are born from the Paramātmā." Therefore, since this statement establishes a meaning contrary to *śruti*, its authority is rejected (*sūtra* 43).

[The answer is:] Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha have the nature of the Supreme Brahman, and therefore the authority of the scripture that teaches this can never be rejected. That is, these *vyūhas* — Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others — are by no means meant to be like ordinary jīvas, liable to fall under the sway of māyā: all of Them are Lords, all possess the six opulences — knowledge, sovereignty, power, strength, valour, splendour and the rest. Therefore the *Pañcarātra* doctrine is not without authority. Only those unversed in the *Pañcarātra*, or the Bhāgavata doctrine, could say such unscriptural things as "it speaks of the birth of the jīva, and that is a contradiction." The Bhāgavata doctrine is this. He who loves the devotees who have taken shelter of Him, and who is called the Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva, by His own will abides in four ways, so that those who seek His shelter may approach Him. Thus the *Pauṣkara-saṁhitā* says: "The scripture in which brāhmaṇas, as is their duty, worship the *cāturātmya* (the *catur-vyūha*), calling It by names handed down in succession — that is the '*āgama*.'" And the *Sātvata-saṁhitā* says that the worship of this *cāturātmya* is worship of the Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva. The Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva, whose body is the fullness of the six opulences, is divided [into forms] as *sūkṣma*, *vyūha* and *vibhava*. The devotees, each according to his qualification (*adhikāra*), worship

Him by acts informed by knowledge, and so fully attain Him. By worshipping the *vibhavas* — Nṛsiṁha, Raghunātha, or the avatāras Matsya, Kūrma and others — one attains the *vyūhas*, Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others; and by worshipping the *vyūhas* one attains the Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva. For the *Pauṣkara-saṁhitā* says: "By this scripture, through acts informed by knowledge, one attains the unmanifest Supreme Brahman named Vāsudeva." Hence it is established that Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others too are the Supreme Brahman, for They too have forms by Their own will. The *śrutis* declare: "He, without being born as material things are born, descends, that is, appears, in many forms." Out of love for those who have taken shelter of Him He accepts form by His own will, and so the authority of the *Pañcarātra* scripture, which teaches this, is not rejected. In this scripture Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna and Aniruddha are the presiding deities of, respectively, the jīva, the mind and the *ahaṅkāra*; therefore there is no contradiction in Their being called by the words "*jīva*" and so on. In the same way Brahman is called by the words "*ākāśa*," "*prāṇa*" and so on (*sūtra* 44).

In this scripture the birth of the jīva is denied. For the *Parama-saṁhitā* says: "The three *guṇas* — unconscious, serving another's purpose, always subject to change — are the field of those who perform karma: such is the form of *prakṛti*. The Puruṣa's connection with it is by way of pervasion, and that this connection is beginningless is also true." Thus in all the *saṁhitās* the "*jīva*" is eternal, and therefore the *Pañcarātra* doctrine denies its birth. Whatever is born must perish: accepting the birth of the jīva, one would have to accept its destruction as well. But since the jīva is eternal, its birth is excluded of itself, by its eternity. Above, the *Parama-saṁhitā* said: "the form of *prakṛti* is always subject to change"; so birth, destruction and the like should be understood as included in this "constant change." Thus Śaṅkarācārya's charge that Saṅkarṣaṇa and the others are born as *jīvas* has been refuted (*sūtra* 45). See Śrīdhara [Svāmī]'s commentary on *Bhāgavatam* 3.1.34.

অষ্টম শ্লোকের কৈল সংক্ষেপ বিবরণ ।
নবম শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন দিয়া মন ॥ ৪৯ ॥

aṣṭama ślokera kaila saṅkṣepa vivaraṇa
of the eighth verse I gave a brief explanation
navama ślokera artha śuna diyā mana
of the ninth verse the meaning hear giving the mind

49 Thus I have briefly explained the eighth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the ninth.

The meaning of the ninth of the fourteen opening verses —

মায়াভর্ত্তাজাণ্ডসঙ্ঘাশ্রয়াঙ্গঃ
শেতে সাক্ষাৎ কারণাম্ভোধিমধ্যে ৷
যস্যৈকাংশঃ শ্রীপুমানাদিদেব-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ৫০ ॥

māyā-bhartājāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ
māyā's master of universes multitudes shelter whose body
śete sākṣāt kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye
lies in person of the Causal Ocean in the midst
yasyaikāṁśaḥ śrī-pumān ādi-devas
whose one part the Puruṣa the original Lord
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

50 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of Him is the original Lord, the Puruṣa, the master of māyā, who lies in person in the midst of the Causal Ocean, His body the shelter of countless universes." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[4]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Nityānanda-Rāma, one part of whom is the master of māyā, Kāraṇābdhiśāyī, the shelter of the host of universes, the first deity, the Puruṣa-avatāra.

Anubhāṣya.
sākṣāt māyā-bhartā (the very master of māyā, her Lord) **ajāṇḍa-saṅghāśrayāṅgaḥ** (He whose body is the shelter of the host of universes: *ajāṇḍa*, universes; *saṅgha*, host) **kāraṇāmbhodhi-madhye** (upon the waters of the Causal Ocean) **śete** (lies) (He) — **śrī-pumān ādi-devaḥ** (the first Puruṣa-avatāra), **yasya** (of Śrī Nityānanda) **ekāṁśaḥ** (one part); **taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ** (to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma) (I) **prapadye** (surrender).

Description of the Causal Waters —

বৈকুণ্ঠ-বাহিরে যেই জ্যোতির্ময় ধাম ।
তাহার বাহিরে 'কারণার্ণব' নাম ॥ ৫১ ॥

vaikuṇṭha-bāhire yei jyotir-maya dhāma
Vaikuṇṭha outside which luminous abode
tāhāra bāhire 'kāraṇārṇava' nāma
of it outside Kāraṇārṇava named

51 Outside Vaikuṇṭha is the luminous abode, and beyond it lies what is called the Kāraṇārṇava, the Causal Ocean.

The Causal Ocean at the border of Paravyoma —

বৈকুণ্ঠ বেড়িয়া এক আছে জলনিধি ।
অনন্ত, অপার — তার নাহিক অবধি ॥ ৫২ ॥

vaikuṇṭha beḍiyā eka āche jala-nidhi
Vaikuṇṭha encircling one there is an ocean
ananta, apāra — tāra nāhika avadhi
endless shoreless its there is no limit

52 Encircling Vaikuṇṭha is an ocean, endless and shoreless; it has no bound.

Anubhāṣya.
Jalanidhi (ocean): the "Virajā," or the "Causal Waters" (see Madhya 15.175–176; Madhya 20.268–269; and Madhya 21.52).

The great elements and all else in Vaikuṇṭha are beyond māyā —

বৈকুণ্ঠের পৃথিব্যাদি সকল চিন্ময় ।
মায়িক ভূতের তথি জন্ম নাহি হয় ॥ ৫৩ ॥

vaikuṇṭhera pṛthivy-ādi sakala cinmaya
of Vaikuṇṭha earth and the rest all spiritual
māyika bhūtera tathi janma nāhi haya
material of the elements there birth not is

53 In Vaikuṇṭha earth and all the elements are spiritual; material elements never arise there.

Anubhāṣya.
Māyika bhūta (the elements of *māyā*): the five great elements, earth and the rest.

The spiritual nature of the Causal Waters —

চিন্ময়-জল সেই পরম-কারণ ।
যার এক কণা গঙ্গা পতিতপাবন ॥ ৫৪ ॥

cinmaya-jala sei parama-kāraṇa
spiritual water that the supreme cause
yāra eka kaṇā gaṅgā patita-pāvana
of which one drop the Gaṅgā of the fallen the purifier

54 That spiritual water is the supreme cause; a single drop of it is the Gaṅgā, purifier of the fallen.

Anubhāṣya.
Kāraṇa (cause): although it is a designation (*upādhi*) connected with māyā, in reality it is free of *rajas* and *tamas* mixed with *sattva*; that is, it consists of *sattva*. See Ādi 2.53.

Saṅkarṣaṇa of Paravyoma, in one part of Himself, is Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī —

সেই ত' কারণার্ণবে সেই সঙ্কর্ষণ ।
আপনার এক অংশে করেন শয়ন ॥ ৫৫ ॥

sei ta' kāraṇārṇave sei saṅkarṣaṇa
in that very Causal Ocean that Saṅkarṣaṇa
āpanāra eka aṁśe karena śayana
His own in one part He makes lying down

55 In that Causal Ocean the same Saṅkarṣaṇa lies in the form of one of His parts.

He is the first Puruṣa-avatāra, the one who glances at māyā —

মহৎস্রষ্টা পুরুষ, তিঁহো জগৎ-কারণ ।
আদ্য-অবতার করে মায়ার দরশন ॥ ৫৬ ॥

mahat-sraṣṭā puruṣa, tiṁho jagat-kāraṇa
of the mahat the creator Puruṣa He of the world the cause
ādya-avatāra kare māyāra daraśana
the first avatāra makes of māyā the glance

56 He is the Puruṣa, creator of the *mahat-tattva*, the cause of the world. This first avatāra casts His glance upon māyā.

Māyā does not touch the Causal Ocean —

মায়াশক্তি রহে কারণাব্ধির বাহিরে ।
কারণ-সমুদ্র মায়া পরশিতে নারে ॥ ৫৭ ॥

māyā-śakti rahe kāraṇābdhira bāhire
māyā potency remains the Causal Ocean outside
kāraṇa-samudra māyā paraśite nāre
the Causal Ocean māyā to touch cannot

57 The potency māyā stays outside the Causal Ocean; māyā cannot touch its waters.

The two forms of māyā, "pradhāna" and "prakṛti" —

সেই ত' মায়ার দুই-বিধ অবস্থিতি ।
জগতের উপাদান 'প্রধান', 'প্রকৃতি' ॥ ৫৮ ॥

sei ta' māyāra dui-vidha avasthiti
of that very māyā twofold state
jagatera upādāna 'pradhāna', 'prakṛti'
of the world the material cause pradhāna prakṛti

58 That māyā exists in two ways; as the material cause of the world it is called *pradhāna* or *prakṛti*.

Anubhāṣya.

"Pradhāna" and "prakṛti": see Madhya 20.271. Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Paramātma-sandarbha* (section 49):

"This māyā has two portions. One is the efficient portion (*nimitta*): it consists of the *guṇas* and is called *māyā*. The other is the material portion (*upādāna*): it is substance and is called *pradhāna*. The difference between them is described in four verses (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.24.1–4). … (section 53) Elsewhere (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.63.26) the differences between these two, the material and the efficient, are also stated according to the difference in their functions: 'Time, destiny, karma, the jīva, his nature, the subtle elements, the field, the vital air, the ego, the transformations, their aggregate, and the flow like seed and sprout — this is Your māyā. I take shelter of You, the limit of its negation.' Here time, destiny, karma and nature are efficient portions; the rest are material portions. The jīva, who possesses them, is of a dual nature: thus a particle of the efficient potency is present within the material class as well. … (section 55) The potency well known by the name *māyā*, as the efficient portion, is seen to be threefold: knowledge, desire and action. … Now the characteristic of *pradhāna*, the material portion (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.26.10): 'That which is made of the three *guṇas*, unmanifest, eternal, consisting of cause and effect, without distinctions and yet containing distinctions, they call *pradhāna* and *prakṛti*.' That which is made of the three *guṇas* — the combination of the three *guṇas*, *sattva* and the others — is what they call the unmanifest, *pradhāna* and *prakṛti*. Why is it called unmanifest? It is 'without distinctions': the three *guṇas* are in balance in it, so its distinctions are not manifest; hence one understands why it is also called *avyākṛta*, the undeveloped. Why is it called *pradhāna*? It 'contains distinctions': the *mahat* and the other distinctions are effects of its own portions, and it is their shelter and therefore superior (*śreṣṭha*) to them. … The efficient portion is *māyā*; the material portion is *pradhāna*."

Bhagavān's external potency, māyā, has two portions: the efficient portion, "*māyā* made of the *guṇas*," and the material portion, "*pradhāna* made of substance." The mutual difference between these two names is described in four verses of the twenty-fourth chapter of the eleventh canto of the *Bhāgavatam*. Elsewhere, in the twenty-sixth verse of the sixty-third chapter of the tenth canto, the two portions — material and efficient — are divided according to the difference in their functions: "O Bhagavān! Agitating 'time,' efficient '*karma*,' 'destiny,' which brings forth the fruits, and its impression, 'nature' (*svabhāva*) — this is the conditioned jīva, marked by these four efficient portions of māyā. The subtle elements are 'sub-

stance'; *prakṛti* is the 'field'; the sūtra is the 'vital air'; *ahaṅkāra* is the 'self'; and the eleven senses and earth, water, fire, air and ether are the sixteen transformations; their total aggregate is the 'body.' From the body comes karma as a seed, and from karma the body as a sprout: this endless flow is '*māyā*.' O Prabhu, You are the Truth at which all this is negated; You I worship." "Although the jīva is a particle of the efficient potency, he possesses portions of both natures and so follows the material class as well." The potency known by the word "*māyā*," the efficient portion, has three divisions: "knowledge," "desire" and "action." The characteristic of "*pradhāna*," the material portion: "That in which the three *guṇas* — *sattva*, *rajas* and *tamas* — are combined is called 'the unmanifest,' '*pradhāna*' and '*prakṛti*.' The reason for the name 'unmanifest' is this: it is without distinctions — the three *guṇas* are in balance in it — so its distinctive qualities are not manifest; therefore *pradhāna* also received the name *avyākṛta*. The reason for the name '*pradhāna*': the *mahat-tattva* and the other distinctions are māyā's own effects, and she, like a distinct object, is their shelter and is therefore superior to them." … In the efficient portion, "*māyā*"; in the material portion, "*pradhāna*."

Māyā, made of the guṇas, is never the chief cause of the world —

জগৎকারণ নহে প্রকৃতি জড়রূপা ।
শক্তি সঞ্চারিয়া তারে কৃষ্ণ করে কৃপা ॥ ৫৯ ॥

jagat-kāraṇa nahe prakṛti jaḍa-rūpā
of the world the cause is not prakṛti inert in nature
śakti sañcāriyā tāre kṛṣṇa kare kṛpā
potency infusing into her Kṛṣṇa shows mercy

59 Inert prakṛti is not the cause of the world; Kṛṣṇa shows her mercy by infusing her with His potency.

By the power of Bhagavān's glance prakṛti becomes the secondary cause of the world —

কৃষ্ণশক্ত্যে প্রকৃতি হয় গৌণ কারণ ।
অগ্নিশক্ত্যে লৌহ যৈছে করয়ে জারণ ॥ ৬০ ॥

kṛṣṇa-śaktye prakṛti haya gauṇa kāraṇa
by Kṛṣṇa's potency prakṛti becomes the secondary cause
agni-śaktye lauha yaiche karaye jāraṇa
by fire's power iron as does burning

60 By Kṛṣṇa's potency prakṛti becomes a secondary cause, just as iron burns by the power of fire.

Bhagavān is the original cause of the world —

অতএব কৃষ্ণ মূল-জগৎকারণ ।
প্রকৃতি — কারণ, যৈছে অজাগলস্তন ॥ ৬১ ॥

ataeva kṛṣṇa mūla-jagat-kāraṇa
therefore Kṛṣṇa the original of the world cause
prakṛti — kāraṇa, yaiche ajā-gala-stana
prakṛti the cause as of a goat on the neck the teats

61 Therefore Kṛṣṇa is the original cause of the world. To call prakṛti the cause is like taking the teats on a goat's neck for an udder.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.259–261. The external potency, māyā, is known in the material portion of the world by the names "*pradhāna*" and "*prakṛti*," and in the efficient portion of the world by the name "*māyā*." Inert *prakṛti* is not the cause of the world. For Kṛṣṇa, as Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, grants *prakṛti* the material, substantial potency and so infuses her with power. The example is red-hot iron. Iron has no "power" to burn or give heat, but touched by fire, red-hot iron can burn and heat other things. In the same way inert *prakṛti*, which is like iron, has no independent capacity to be the substance or the material cause. Only when the glance-potency of Kāraṇodakaśāyī, who is like fire, is infused into her does iron-like *prakṛti*, a mere likeness of the material cause, acquire the power to burn and give heat. To regard *prakṛti*, known as the material, as the material cause of the world is therefore sheer delusion. Śrī Kapiladeva also says: "As the firebrand, the sparks and the smoke are born of the fire itself and are thought of as one with it, yet the fire is distinct from the firebrand…" (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.28.40) Smoke, the burning log and the sparks contain the substance of fire, and so they are spoken of as one with fire; nevertheless fire is something distinct from the firebrand. "The el-

ements," like the smoke, "the jīva," like the sparks, and "*pradhāna*," like the fire-brand — all of them receive their powers from Bhagavān, who is like the fire, the substance of everything, and so each displays its own separate identity. Even so, the substance of them all is Bhagavān. "*Pradhāna*" is held to be the material of the world, but it appears as such only through the substance Bhagavān has placed in it. "*Pradhāna*" cannot be an independent material cause separate from Bhagavān. To forget Kṛṣṇa, the root shelter of all material causes, and to ascribe that role to the *prakṛti* of Sāṅkhya is as fruitless as expecting milk from the teat-like lumps of flesh on a goat's neck.

Śrī Nārāyaṇa is the efficient cause —

মায়া-অংশে কহি তারে নিমিত্ত-কারণ ।
সেহ নহে, যাতে কর্ত্তা-হেতু — নারায়ণ ॥ ৬২ ॥

māyā-aṁśe kahi tāre nimitta-kāraṇa
in the māyā aspect I call her the efficient cause
seha nahe, yāte kartā-hetu — nārāyaṇa
even that is not so because the agent cause Nārāyaṇa

62 In her aspect as māyā I call her the efficient cause of the world; but even that is not so, for the true maker and cause is Nārāyaṇa.

The original Director is Bhagavān, the all-pervading Consciousness —

ঘটের নিমিত্ত-হেতু যৈছে কুম্ভকার ।
তৈছে জগতের কর্ত্তা — পুরুষাবতার ॥ ৬৩ ॥

ghaṭera nimitta-hetu yaiche kumbhakāra
of the pot efficient cause as the potter
taiche jagatera kartā — puruṣāvatāra
so of the world the maker the Puruṣa-avatāra

63 As the potter is the efficient cause of the pot, so the Puruṣa-avatāra is the maker of the world.

Kṛṣṇa creates the world through māyā —

কৃষ্ণ — কর্ত্তা, মায়া তাঁর করেন সহায় ।
ঘটের কারণ — চক্র-দণ্ডাদি উপায় ॥ ৬৪ ॥

kṛṣṇa — kartā, māyā tāṁra karena sahāya
Kṛṣṇa the maker māyā to Him gives help
ghaṭera kāraṇa — cakra-daṇḍādi upāya
of the pot cause wheel stick and other instruments

64 Kṛṣṇa is the maker, and māyā only helps Him, as the wheel, the stick and other tools are causes of the pot.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Beyond the abode of Paravyoma lies the effulgent "abode of Brahman," and beyond that the "Causal Ocean" (*Kāraṇa-samudra*). The spiritual world is free of causes, while māyā is full of them. The region between the two is called the "Causal Ocean," an ocean of spiritual water. For the glance of Bhagavān, who lies upon that water, is directed towards māyā beyond it, and it carries out creation and the other acts. Kṛṣṇa and the Lord of Paravyoma are Themselves free of creation and such acts, and no act connected with māyā takes place in Their *svarūpa*. Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, by a portion of Himself — His glance (*īkṣaṇa*) — lies in that ocean and creates the *mahat-tattva*; He is the first avatāra. *Māyā-śakti* stays outside the Causal Ocean, and Bhagavān casts His glance upon her. *Māyā* cannot touch the Causal Ocean. Bhagavān's glance enters māyā and makes her active. *Māyā* exists in two forms: as "*pradhāna*," the material cause of the world, and as "*māyā*," its efficient cause. *Prakṛti* is in truth inert. But when the power of Bhagavān's glance is infused into her, by that power *prakṛti* becomes the "secondary cause" of creating the world — just as fire, entering iron, gives it the power to burn. Kṛṣṇa, therefore, is the original cause of the world, and *prakṛti*'s being its substantial cause is like the nipples on a goat's neck. *Māyā* in her portion — that is, the portion made of the *guṇas* — is called the efficient cause; yet even then the efficient cause is Nārāyaṇa. When a pot is made, the wheel, the rod and the like, as well as the potter, are its efficient causes. Nārāyaṇa is the efficient cause in the potter's place (the chief one), and māyā the efficient cause in the place of the wheel and rod (the secondary one). So, just as without a potter there is no pot, without Nārāyaṇa there is no world. The efficient cause made of the *guṇas*, in the place of the wheel and rod, works as the helper of Nārāyaṇa, the root efficient cause.

Kāraṇābdhiśāyī glances at māyā and brings the jīvas into manifestation —

দূর হৈতে পুরুষ করে মায়াতে অবধান ।
জীবরূপ বীর্য্য তাতে করেন আধান ॥ ৬৫ ॥

dūra haite puruṣa kare māyāte avadhāna
from afar the Puruṣa makes on māyā a glance
jīva-rūpa vīrya tāte karena ādhāna
in the form of jīvas the seed into her He makes placing

65 From afar the Puruṣa glances upon māyā and places in her the seed — the jīvas.

By a semblance of His body He touches māyā, and so Bhagavān Himself is the material cause —

এক অঙ্গাভাসে করে মায়াতে মিলন ।
মায়া হৈতে জন্মে তবে ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের গণ ॥ ৬৬ ॥

eka aṅgābhāse kare māyāte milana
by one semblance of His body makes with māyā union
māyā haite janme tabe brahmāṇḍera gaṇa
from māyā are born then of universes the multitudes

66 By a mere semblance of His body He unites with māyā, and from māyā the hosts of universes are then born.

Anubhāṣya.

In the Vedic view, the world is created only by the joining of potency that comes from the Reality itself, and in that form it appears before the conditioned jīva. In the non-Vedic view, the visible world is born of *prakṛti*. The potency of the Reality works in three ways: as *cit*, as *acit*, and as a potency that partakes of both. Some, following a path foreign to the Śrutis, think that the world arose from inert *prakṛti*; the Vedas do not accept that view. The Reality, Bhagavān, is nondifferent from His spiritual potency. When the *cit-śakti* is infused into the *acit* potency, a temporary, perishable semblance of spiritual being appears. Bhagavān's *jīva-śakti*, called *taṭasthā*, combines *cit* and *acit*. It is eternally subordinate to the spiritual potency, yet from time without beginning it is liable to wander in the visible world, the transformation of the *acit* potency. Cut off from the Reality, the jīva misuses pure

spirit, and this gradually becomes his experience of bondage. In truth, once the jīva knows his own *svarūpa*, he can understand that readiness to serve is the ground of his eternal highest good. When he turns away from service, this potency called *taṭasthā* imagines itself the possessor of potency and sets out to enjoy. To become masters of *acit*, his senses begin to act against the purely spiritual potency. Only Kṛṣṇa's own potency gives power to His *acit* potency, which is of a different nature (*vijātīya*). An example: fire and its power to burn, infused into iron that has no fire, display the iron as fire. In truth the *acit* potency gains its activity only from Kṛṣṇa's *cit-śakti*. The *taṭasthā jīva*, driven by the *acit* potency, thinks that the visible material world is born of *prakṛti*. But the liberated jīva, situated in pure spirit, can understand that the *cit-śakti* of the Possessor of potency imparts a share of strength to the *acit* potency and so makes it active. *Prakṛti*, the root cause of the *acit* potency, brings with it every kind of undesirability, limitation and inferiority. A jīva who follows reasoning in the conceit of his bondage sees the goat's milk-giving udder and yet vainly seeks milk from the teat-like growths on her neck. Equally foolish is it to call *prakṛti*, whose root is *acit*, the cause of the material world. Bhagavān's *acit* potency, "*māyā*," appears before the jīva who is averse to Hari as the "efficient" and the "material" cause and turns him away from accepting the true Reality. When knowledge of his *svarūpa* dawns, the jīva notices the twofold action of the *acit* potency: "covering" (*āvaraṇī*) and "projecting" (*vikṣepātmikā*). A thing such as a pot has a twofold cause: the potter is the efficient cause, while the clay, the wheel, the rod and the like are the material cause and the instruments. In the same way, when one considers the Reality, the controller of the visible world and its elements is shown to be the Possessor of potency (*śaktimat-tattva*). If, however, one considers the potencies separately, māyā, made of the three *guṇas*, governs the elements — the material portion — through the *guṇas*. The *taṭasthā-śakti*, the jīva, turning away from Hari in this visible world, takes on the role of enjoyer. That the Reality is perceived in the visible world as *acit* is merely the fruit of aversion to Kṛṣṇa. The perception of *acit* displays enjoyment, that is, devotion to the senses. But in perceiving Bhagavān with readiness to serve, the jīva sees his own relationship with Him. Kṛṣṇa is the cause of the eternal spiritual world. He is also the cause of the world of *acit*, whose truth is covered, and He is the root cause and ordainer of the jīva called *taṭasthā*. The perception of *acit* is the work of Bhagavān's external potency, and the perception of *cit* is the work of His internal potency. From the word born of spiritual perception we can learn that every attribute of independent agency and of being the source of all is established in the Reality, Bhagavān. That Reality is the Great (*Bṛhat*), and His minute fragments are what the word "*jīva*" denotes.

The Reality, Bhagavān, though divided, does not display the quality of fragmentation; and fragmented perception is never identical with undivided perception. In terms of pervaded and pervader, Brahman and the jīva are of the same kind. Yet the Lord is the master of māyā, while the dependent is subject to māyā. But when one who is subject to māyā becomes subject to the Lord of māyā, his subjection to māyā can no longer remain.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.271–273 and *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.5.26 and 3.26.18.

The fruit of Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī's glance —

অগণ্য, অনন্ত যত অণ্ড-সন্নিবেশ ।
ততরূপে পুরুষ করে সবাতে প্রবেশ ॥ ৬৭ ॥

agaṇya, ananta yata aṇḍa-sanniveśa
countless endless as many universes' arrangements
tata-rūpe puruṣa kare sabāte praveśa
in so many forms the Puruṣa makes into all entrance

67 Into all those countless, endless universes the Puruṣa enters, taking as many forms.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
The Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa casts His glance upon māyā from afar. That glance, by nature a fruit of *cit*, acts in two ways. As particles of His rays He places countless jīvas within māyā, and Himself, uniting with māyā by a semblance of His body (*aṅgābhāsa*), creates countless universes. He enters each of them in the form of a Puruṣa. "*Aṅgābhāsa*" means a mere semblance of bodily contact; in truth there is no contact of His body.

With His exhalation and inhalation the universes are created and dissolved —

পুরুষ-নাসাতে যবে বাহিরায় শ্বাস ।
নিশ্বাস সহিতে হয় ব্রহ্মাণ্ড-প্রকাশ ॥ ৬৮ ॥

puruṣa-nāsāte yabe bāhirāya śvāsa
the Puruṣa's from the nostrils when goes out the breath
niśvāsa sahite haya brahmāṇḍa-prakāśa
the exhalation together with becomes of universes the manifestation

68 When the breath goes out of the Puruṣa's nostrils, the universes become manifest with His exhalation.

পুনরপি শ্বাস যবে প্রবেশে অন্তরে ।
শ্বাস-সহ ব্রহ্মাণ্ড পৈশে পুরুষ-শরীরে ॥ ৬৯ ॥

punarapi śvāsa yabe praveśe antare
again the breath when enters within
śvāsa-saha brahmāṇḍa paiśe puruṣa-śarīre
with the breath the universes enter of the Puruṣa into the body

69 And when the breath enters again, the universes enter the Puruṣa's body with it.

In His bodily pores are countless universes —

গবাক্ষের রন্ধ্রে যেন ত্রসরেণু চলে ।
পুরুষের লোমকূপে ব্রহ্মাণ্ডের জালে ॥ ৭০ ॥

gavākṣera randhre yena trasareṇu cale
of a window through the holes as specks of dust move
puruṣera loma-kūpe brahmāṇḍera jāle
of the Puruṣa in the pores of universes the multitudes

70 As specks of dust move through the holes of a lattice window, so hosts of universes move through the pores of the Puruṣa's skin.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Trasareṇu: six *paramāṇus* (the finest particles) make one *trasareṇu*.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 20.277–280.

(Brahma-saṁhitā, Chapter 5, verse 48) —

যস্যৈকনিশ্বসিতকালমথাবলম্ব্য
জীবন্তি লোমবিলজা জগদণ্ডনাথাঃ ।
বিষ্ণুর্মহান্ স ইহ যস্য কলাবিশেষো
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ৭১ ॥

yasyaika-niśvasita-kālam athāvalambya
whose one exhalation's span then depending on
jīvanti loma-vila-jā jagad-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ
live from the pores born of the universes the lords
viṣṇur mahān sa iha yasya kalā-viśeṣo
Viṣṇu the Great He here whose kalā particular
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

71 "The lords of the universes, born from His pores, abide for the span of one of His breaths. That Mahā-Viṣṇu is a particular kalā of Govinda, the original Person, whom I worship." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.48)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I worship the original Person Govinda, whose *kalā* is that Mahā-Viṣṇu from whose bodily pores all the lords of the universes are born and live for the span of one of His exhalations.

Anubhāṣya.

atha yasya loma-vila-jāḥ (born from the bodily pores) **jagad-aṇḍa-nāthāḥ** (the lords of the universes — the aggregate Viṣṇu and others) **eka-niśvasita-kālam** (a time equal to one exhalation) **avalambya** (resorting to) **iha jīvanti** (remain manifest), **saḥ mahān viṣṇuḥ** (that Mahā-Viṣṇu) is **yasya** (Govinda's) **kalā-viśeṣaḥ** (particular *kalā*); **tam ādi-puruṣaṁ govindam ahaṁ bhajāmi** (that original Person, Govinda, I worship).

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 14, verse 11)

ক্বাহং তমো-মহদহং-খ-চরাগ্নিবার্ভূ-
সংবেষ্টিতাণ্ডঘট-সপ্তবিতস্তিকায়ঃ ।
ক্বেদৃগ্বিধাহবিগণিতাণ্ডপরাণুচর্য্যা-
বাতাধ্বরোমবিবরস্য চ তে মহিত্বম্ ॥ ৭২ ॥

kvāhaṁ tamo-mahad-ahaṁ-kha-carāgni-vār-bhū-
where I by darkness the mahat false ego ether air fire water earth
saṁveṣṭitāṇḍa-ghaṭa-sapta-vitasti-kāyaḥ
enclosed universe in the pot seven spans of body
kvedṛg-vidhā 'viganitāṇḍa-parāṇu-caryā-
where such countless universes like atoms moving
vātādhva-roma-vivarasya ca te mahitvam
through the windows the pores of the skin and Your greatness

72 "Where am I, a creature with a body seven spans tall, enclosed in the pot of a universe wrapped in prakṛti, the mahat, false ego, ether, air, fire, water and earth? And where is Your greatness, when countless such universes drift like atoms through the pores of Your skin, as through the openings of a lattice?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.14.11)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Where am I, enclosed in this body made of *prakṛti*, the *mahat-tattva*, *ahaṅkāra* and the five elements and measuring seven spans? And where is Your greatness, such that all the universes, like the finest particles, wander through the openings of Your bodily pores? That is, my body — the universe — is nothing compared with Your greatness.

Anubhāṣya.
After stealing the calves, Brahmā prayed to atone for his offence. This is one of those prayers:

tamo-mahad-ahaṁ-kha-carāgni-vār-bhū-saṁveṣṭitāṇḍa-ghaṭa-sapta-vitasti-kāyaḥ (*tamaḥ*, the unmanifest; *mahat*, the *mahat-tattva*; *aham*, *ahaṅkāra*; *kha*, ether; *cara*, air; *agni*, fire; *vāḥ*, water; *bhū*, earth; the *aṇḍa-ghaṭa*, the pot of the universe, enclosed by all these from *pradhāna* to earth, is the body, and within it is one whose body, by his own measure, is seven spans) **ahaṁ kva** (where am I?)

īdṛg-vidhāvigaṇitāṇḍa-parāṇu-caryā-vātādhva-roma-vivarasya (of Him whose bodily pores are like windows [*vātādhva*, window] through which wander countless universes like this one, which are themselves the finest particles) **te** (Your) **mahitvaṁ ca kva** (and where is the greatness?).

The relationship of mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa, Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa and the three Puruṣas

—

অংশের অংশ যেই, ‘কলা’ তার নাম ।
গোবিন্দের প্রতিমূর্ত্তি শ্রীবলরাম ॥ ৭৩ ॥

aṁśera aṁśa yei, ‘kalā’ tāra nāma
of a part the part which kalā its name
govindera pratimūrti śrī-balarāma
of Govinda the second body Śrī Balarāma

73 A part of a part is called a *kalā*. Śrī Balarāma is Govinda’s second body.

Anubhāṣya.
Pratimūrti (image): the second body (Ādi 5.4–5; Madhya 20.174).

তাঁর এক স্বরূপ — শ্রীমহাসঙ্কর্ষণ ।
তাঁর অংশ ‘পুরুষ’ হয় কলাতে গণন ॥ ৭৪ ॥

tāṁra eka svarūpa — śrī-mahā-saṅkarṣaṇa
His one form Śrī Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa
tāṁra aṁśa ‘puruṣa’ haya kalāte gaṇana
His part the Puruṣa is among the kalās counted

74 One of His forms is Śrī Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa, and Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa’s part, the Puruṣa, is counted as a *kalā*.

যাঁহাকে ত’ কলা কহি, তিঁহো মহাবিষ্ণু ।
মহাপুরুষাবতারী, সেহো সর্ব্বজিষ্ণু ॥ ৭৫ ॥

yāṁhāke ta' kalā kahi, tiṁho mahā-viṣṇu
whom indeed kalā I call He Mahā-Viṣṇu
mahā-puruṣāvatārī, seho sarva-jiṣṇu
of the Mahā-Puruṣa avatāras the source He all-conquering

75 He whom I call a kalā is Mahā-Viṣṇu. He is the source of the Puruṣa-avatāras, ever victorious.

Anubhāṣya.
The words "Mahā-Viṣṇu" and "Mahāpuruṣāvatārī" (the source of the Puruṣa-avatāras) refer to Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī.

গর্ভোদ-ক্ষীরোদ-শায়ী দোঁহে 'পুরুষ' নাম ।
সেই দুই, যাঁর অংশ, — বিষ্ণু, বিশ্বধাম ॥ ৭৬ ॥

garbhoda-kṣīroda-śāyī doṁhe 'puruṣa' nāma
in the Garbha Kṣīra lying both Puruṣa named
sei dui, yāṁra aṁśa, — viṣṇu, viśvadhāma
those two whose parts Viṣṇu abode of the universes

76 The Lords who lie in the Garbha and Kṣīra oceans are both called Puruṣas, and He whose parts They are is Viṣṇu, the abode of all the universes.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Balarāma, the *vilāsa-mūrti* of Kṛṣṇa, is *mūla-Saṅkarṣaṇa*, the original Saṅkarṣaṇa. A portion of His *svarūpa* in Paravyoma is Saṅkarṣaṇa. His portion is Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu; He is a portion of a portion and is therefore called a "*kalā*." The two Puruṣas, Garbhodaśāyī and Kṣīrodaśāyī, are portions of Mahā-Viṣṇu.

Anubhāṣya.
The characteristic of the Puruṣa: the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, in describing the avatāras (section 4), paraphrases a verse of the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* (6.8.59) quoted there: "I always bow down to that imperishable Puruṣa. He is a portion of Kṛṣṇa, Puruṣottama, who is free from the six kinds of change. He has contact with the *guṇas*, that is, He glances at *prakṛti*, the *mahat* and the other material things. In truth He never gives up His one *svarūpa*, yet He divides into many portions of Himself and expands all living beings. He is pure, that is, free from contact with

māyā, and yet He appears impure, as if in contact with māyā. And He is eternally spiritual." Śrī Rūpa's *kārikā* on this verse: "That portion of the Supreme Lord who seems to partake of the *guṇas* of *pradhāna*, who casts His glance upon it and performs the other acts, and who has many avatāras, is known as the Puruṣa." That is, the portion of the Supreme Lord who, as if in contact with the *guṇas* of *pradhāna*, glances at *prakṛti*, the *mahat-tattva* and the rest, and who manifests the various avatāras — that portion the scriptures call the "Puruṣa."

(Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, Chapter 2, verse 9; words of the Sātvata-tantra)

বিষ্ণোস্তু ত্রীণি রূপাণি পুরুষাখ্যান্যথো বিদুঃ ।
একন্তুমহতঃ স্রষ্টৃ দ্বিতীয়ং ত্বণ্ডসংস্থিতম্ ।
তৃতীয়ং সর্ব্বভূতস্থং তানি জ্ঞাত্বা বিমুচ্যতে ॥ ৭৭ ॥

viṣṇos tu trīṇi rūpāṇi
of Viṣṇu but three forms
puruṣākhyāny atho viduḥ
called Puruṣas then they know
ekaṁ tu mahataḥ sraṣṭṛ
one but of the mahat the creator
dvitīyaṁ tv aṇḍa-saṁsthitam
the second but in the universe abiding
tṛtīyaṁ sarva-bhūta-sthaṁ
the third in all beings abiding
tāni jñātvā vimucyate
them knowing one is liberated

77 "Viṣṇu has three forms called Puruṣas: the first creates the mahat, the second abides within the universe, and the third dwells in all beings. Knowing Them, one is set free." (Sātvata-tantra; Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta, Pūrva-khaṇḍa, 2.9)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the eternal abode Viṣṇu has three forms. The first is Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu, the creator of the *mahat-tattva*. The second is Garbhodaśāyī, the Puruṣa within the aggregate universe. The third is Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Puruṣa within each in-

dividual universe; He is the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) and the Paramātmā of every jīva. Whoever can know the truth of these three is freed from material intelligence.

Anubhāṣya.

viṣṇoḥ tu puruṣākhyāni trīṇi rūpāṇi viduḥ (Viṣṇu is known to have three forms called Puruṣas). Of them, **ekam** (the first) **tu mahataḥ** (of the *mahat-tattva*) **sraṣṭṛ** (the creator — the indwelling Lord of *prakṛti*), **dvitīyaṁ tu aṇḍa-saṁsthitam** (the second, who dwells in the universe, its indwelling Lord), **tṛtīyaṁ sarva-bhūta-stham** (the third, who dwells in all beings, the indwelling Lord of the *jīvas*). **tāni rūpāṇi jñātvā vimucyate** (knowing these forms, the knower is freed from the bonds of *māyā*).

Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī is the source of all the avatāras, beginning with Matsya —

যদ্যপি কহিয়ে তাঁরে কৃষ্ণের ‘কলা’ করি ।
মৎস্যকূর্ম্মাদ্যবতারের তিঁহো অবতারী ॥ ৭৮ ॥

yadyapi kahiye tāṁre kṛṣṇera ‘kalā’ kari
although I call Him Kṛṣṇa’s kalā making
matsya-kūrmādy-avatārera tiṁho avatārī
of Matsya Kūrma and other avatāras He the source

78 Though I call Him a kalā of Kṛṣṇa, He is the source of Matsya, Kūrma and the other avatāras.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 1, Chapter 3, verse 28)

এতে চাংশকলাঃ পুংসঃ কৃষ্ণস্তু ভগবান্ স্বয়ম্ ।
ইন্দ্রারিব্যাকুলং লোকং মৃড়য়ন্তি যুগে যুগে ॥ ৭৯ ॥

ete cāṁśa-kalāḥ puṁsaḥ
these and portions and parts of the Puruṣa
kṛṣṇas tu bhagavān svayam
Kṛṣṇa but Bhagavān Himself
indrāri-vyākulaṁ lokaṁ
by the enemies of Indra troubled the world
mṛḍayanti yuge yuge
make happy in age after age

79 "All these (avatāras) are portions (*aṁśa*) and parts of portions (*kalā*) of the Puruṣa, but Kṛṣṇa is Bhagavān Himself. Age after age They bring happiness to the world when it is troubled by the enemies of Indra." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.28)[5]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.67.

The work of the three Puruṣa-avatāras —

সেই পুরুষ সৃষ্টি-স্থিতি-প্রলয়ের কর্ত্তা ।
নানা অবতার করে, জগতের ভর্ত্তা ॥ ৮০ ॥

sei puruṣa sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralayera kartā
that Puruṣa of creation maintenance dissolution the doer
nānā avatāra kare, jagatera bhartā
many avatāras makes of the world the sustainer

80 That Puruṣa creates, maintains and dissolves the world; He sends forth many avatāras and sustains the world.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
That Puruṣa-avatāra (as the protector of the world) is Kṣīrodaśāyī.

Anubhāṣya.
"He is the storehouse and the imperishable seed of the many avatāras; by portions of His portions the gods, animals, humans and others are created." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.5) As Kāraṇābdhiśāyī He is the cause of creation, maintenance and dissolution; as Garbhodaśāyī, the abode where the many avatāras are born; and as Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Lord of the earth.

The avatāras are only portions —

সৃষ্ট্যাদি-নিমিত্তে যেই অংশের অবধান ।
সেই ত' অংশেরে কহি 'অবতার' নাম ॥ ৮১ ॥

sṛṣṭy-ādi-nimitte yei aṁśera avadhāna
creation and the rest for the sake of which part's descent
sei ta' aṁśere kahi 'avatāra' nāma
that very part I call avatāra by name

81 The part that descends for creation and the rest I call by the name *avatāra*.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the characteristics of the avatāras (section 1), says: "When the forms mentioned before appear for the work of the universe, as if for the first time, either themselves or through another medium, they are then called avatāras. That medium is either a *tad-ekātma-rūpa* or His devotee — like Śeṣaśāyī and others, or like Vasudeva and others." That is, when the original form mentioned before, Śrī Kṛṣṇa, appears for the work of the universe either Himself or through a medium, He is called an "avatāra." The medium is of two kinds: a *tad-ekātma-rūpa* and a devotee. Śeṣaśāyī is a *tad-ekātma-rūpa*, while Vasudeva and others are devotees. Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "'Themselves' means without a medium; 'through another medium' — if they appear in the world in either way, they are then called avatāras. Descent from what lies beyond the world into the world is indeed avatāra. Through a medium: as Garbhodakaśāyī from Śeṣaśāyī Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī, Kṛṣṇa from Vasudeva, Rāma from Daśaratha. 'The work': agitating *prakṛti* and producing the *mahat* and the rest; increasing the happiness of the gods and others by crushing the wicked; distributing the bliss of prema to *sādhakas* who long for Him by appearing before them Himself; and spreading pure devotion — such is the meaning of 'for the work.'"

In the realm of māyā everything is fragmented by differences of place, time and person, and actions there are fragmented. In those actions, in their efficient or material portion, one sees the causality of Bhagavān's *svarūpa*. The Godhood in the form of Mahā-Viṣṇu, the cause of those actions, is a portion of Kṛṣṇa. It is this portion that is called an "avatāra." Ordinarily, by gross vision and on the maxim of the lame and the blind, inert *prakṛti* is called the "material" cause and the enjoyer, the *puruṣa-jīva* made of the three *guṇas*, the "efficient" cause. But *prakṛti* is neither

the "material" nor the "efficient" cause of the world; this the devotees (*bhāgavatas*) have subtly realised. By the power of His glance *prakṛti* is known as the "material" of the world, and māyā is famed as its "efficient agent"; both these potencies are given by Bhagavān Himself. Those manifestations of Bhagavān in which He displays the pastime of empowering māyā — to create the universe or for its welfare — those manifest forms are called "portions" or "avatāras." In truth the avatāras, who are likened to lamps, are Viṣṇu. But because they exercise authority over māyā, in the language of māyā they are merely called "portions" or "avatāras." See Madhya 20.263–264.

আদ্যাবতার, মহাপুরুষ, ভগবান্ ।
সর্ব্ব-অবতার-বীজ, সর্ব্বাশ্রয়-ধাম ॥ ৮২ ॥

ādyāvatāra, mahā-puruṣa, bhagavān
the first avatāra the Mahā-Puruṣa Bhagavān
sarva-avatāra-bīja, sarvāśraya-dhāma
of all avatāras the seed of all the shelter the abode

82 He is the first avatāra, the Mahā-Puruṣa, Bhagavān — the seed of all avatāras, the abode and shelter of all.

Anubhāṣya.
On Garbhodaśāyī, the seed of all avatāras, see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.5.

Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī Mahā-Viṣṇu —

আদ্যোঽবতারঃ পুরুষঃ পরস্য
কালঃ স্বভাবঃ সদসন্মনশ্চ ।
দ্রব্যং বিকারো গুণ ইন্দ্রিয়াণি
বিরাট্ স্বরাট্ স্থাস্নু চরিষ্ণু ভূম্নঃ ॥ ৮৩ ॥

ādyo 'vatāraḥ puruṣaḥ parasya
the first avatāra the Puruṣa of the Supreme
kālaḥ svabhāvaḥ sad-asan manaś ca
time nature cause and effect the mind and
dravyaṁ vikāro guṇa indriyāṇi
the elements false ego the guṇas the senses
virāṭ svarāṭ sthāsnu cariṣṇu bhūmnaḥ
the universal body the self-luminous the unmoving the moving of the Great One

83 "The Puruṣa is the first avatāra of the Supreme. Time, nature, prakṛti as cause and effect, the mind, the elements, false ego, the guṇas, the senses, the universal body (*virāṭ*) and the Vairāja (*svarāṭ*), and all beings, moving and unmoving — all these are the splendour of the Great One." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 2.6.42)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The Kāraṇābdhiśāyī Puruṣa is the first avatāra of Bhagavān. Time, nature (*svabhāva*), *prakṛti* as cause and effect, the *mahat-tattva* — the mind and the rest, *ahaṅkāra* — the great elements and the rest, the *guṇas* — *sattva* and the others, the senses, the Virāṭ, the Svarāṭ, the unmoving and the moving — all these are His opulence (*vibhūti*).

In another reading these verses are also found[13]: "I [Brahmā], Bhava, Yajña, these lords of progeny headed by Dakṣa, you [Nārada] and others; the guardians of the heavenly worlds, of the worlds of birds, of the human world and of the lower worlds; the lords of the Gandharvas, Vidyādharas and Cāraṇas; the masters of the Yakṣas, Rākṣasas, serpents and Nāgas; the best of the sages and of the Pitṛs; the kings of the Daityas, the lords of the Siddhas and the kings of the Dānavas; and the others — the rulers of the *pretas*, *piśācas*, *bhūtas* and *kūṣmāṇḍas*, of aquatic creatures, beasts and birds; whatever in the world has greatness, splendour, strength of the senses, endurance, bodily might, forbearance, beauty, modesty, wealth, intelligence or wondrous colour — whether it has form or is formless — [all this is] the supreme Truth."

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Brahmā describes to Nārada the opulence of Bhagavān Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī:

parasya bhūmnaḥ (of Bhagavān) **puruṣaḥ** (Kāraṇārṇavaśāyī) is **ādyaḥ avatāraḥ** (the first avatāra). **kālaḥ** (time, the agitator of the *guṇas*), **svabhāvaḥ** (its impres-

sion), **sad-asat** (*prakṛti*, effect and cause), **manaḥ** (the *mahat-tattva*), **dravyam** (the subtle elements, the five great elements), **vikāraḥ** (*ahaṅkāra*), **guṇaḥ** (*sattva* and the others), **indriyāṇi** (the eleven), **virāṭ** (the aggregate body), **svarāṭ** (the Vairāja), **sthāsnu** (the unmoving), **cariṣṇu** (the moving, the individual body) **ca** (all are forms of His opulence).

The creator of the mahat-tattva, the first Puruṣa-avatāra —

জগৃহে পৌরুষং রূপং ভগবান্মহদাদিভিঃ ।
সম্ভূতং ষোড়শকলমাদৌ লোকসিসৃক্ষয়া ॥ ৮৪ ॥

jagṛhe pauruṣaṁ rūpaṁ
accepted of the Puruṣa form
bhagavān mahad-ādibhiḥ
Bhagavān with the mahat and the rest
sambhūtaṁ ṣoḍaśa-kalam
composed of sixteen parts
ādau loka-sisṛkṣayā
in the beginning the worlds desiring to create

84 "In the beginning, desiring to create the worlds, Bhagavān accepted the form of the Puruṣa, joined with the mahat and the other principles and possessed of sixteen potencies (*kalā*)." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.3.1)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhagavān, wishing to create the worlds, assumed the form called the Puruṣa, composed of the *mahat-tattva* and the rest and endowed with sixteen *kalās*.

Anubhāṣya.
Answering the five questions of the sages headed by Śaunaka, Sūta describes the avatāras of Bhagavān:

ādau (at the beginning of creation) **bhagavān** (Mahā-Saṅkarṣaṇa) **loka-sisṛkṣayā** (wishing to create the worlds) **mahad-ādibhiḥ** (with the *mahat-tattva*, *ahaṅkāra*, the five great elements, the eleven senses and the five *tanmātras*) **sambhūtam** (composed) **ṣoḍaśa-kalam** (endowed with the full complement of potencies needed for that creation) **pauruṣaṁ rūpaṁ jagṛhe** (manifested the form of the Puruṣa).

Ṣoḍaśa-kalam (endowed with sixteen *kalās*): the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the Puruṣa (section 68), says: "Śrī, Bhū, Kīrti, Ilā, Līlā, Kānti and Vidyā — these seven — and the nine headed by Vimalā: these are the sixteen chief potencies." Śrī Baladeva comments on this: "Vimalā, Utkarṣiṇī, Jñānā, Kriyā, Yogā, and also Prahvī, Satyā, Īśānā and Anugrahā — these are known as the nine." In the *Bhagavat-sandarbha* (section 102): "He is served by Śrī, Puṣṭi, Gīr, Kānti, Kīrti, Tuṣṭi, Ilā, Ūrjā, Vidyā, Avidyā, Śakti and Māyā."[20] "One should also know Sandhinī, Saṁvit, Hlādinī, Bhakti, Ādhāra-śakti, Mūrti, Vimalā, Jayā, Yogā, Prahvī, Īśā, Anugraha and others. Therefore in the verse '*Śriyā*…' and the like one should everywhere understand two kinds of powers: some are functions of the *śakti*, others are functions of māyā. The varieties of the first are the opulence of Bhagavān; the varieties of the second are the opulence of the world. … Here Ilā indicates Bhū, and through her Līlā as well. Sandhinī is Satyā, Jayā is Utkarṣiṇī, Yogā is *yogamāyā*, and Saṁvit is the Jñānājñāna-śakti and *śuddha-sattva*; so it should be understood. The difference between Prahvī and Īśānā is this: Prahvī is the source of wondrous, unlimited capacity, and Īśānā the source of the power of sovereignty over all."

1) Śrī, 2) Bhū, 3) Līlā, 4) Kānti, 5) Kīrti, 6) Tuṣṭi, 7) Gīḥ, 8) Puṣṭi, 9) Satyā, 10) Jñānājñānā, 11) Jayā-Utkarṣiṇī, 12) Vimalā, 13) Yogamāyā, 14) Prahvī, 15) Īśānā and 16) Anugrahā — these sixteen potencies are present in Vaikuṇṭha. See the *Bhāgavata-tātparya* of Śrī Madhva, included in the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya* on *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and the *Tathya* section there.

The shelter of all and the indwelling Lord —

যদ্যপি সর্ব্বাশ্রয় তিঁহো, তাঁহাতে সংসার ।
অন্তরাত্মা-রূপে তিঁহো জগৎ-আধার ॥ ৮৫ ॥

yadyapi sarvāśraya tiṁho, tāṁhāte saṁsāra
although of all the shelter He in Him the world
antarātmā-rūpe tiṁho jagat-ādhāra
the Supersoul in the form of He of the world the support

85 He is the shelter of all, and the world rests in Him; as the Supersoul He is the support of the world.

Anubhāṣya.

See Madhya 20.282.

Though related to māyā in His glance and other acts, He is in truth beyond māyā —

প্রকৃতি-সহিতে তাঁর উভয় সম্বন্ধ ।
তথাপি প্রকৃতি-সহ নাহি স্পর্শগন্ধ ॥ ৮৬ ॥

prakṛti-sahite tāṁra ubhaya sambandha
with prakṛti His twofold relation
tathāpi prakṛti-saha nāhi sparśa-gandha
yet with prakṛti there is not of touch a scent

86 He has a twofold relation with prakṛti, and yet there is not even a trace of contact between Him and prakṛti.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

He is the shelter of all, and *saṁsāra* abides in Him; yet as the indwelling Self (*antarātmā*) He is the support of the world. Although He has these two kinds of relation with *prakṛti*, He accepts no fault from contact with *prakṛti*.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where Viṣṇu's freedom from the *guṇas* is described, Śrī Rūpa's *kārikā* is given: "Relation with the *guṇas* as their controller is called *yoga*. Therefore He who is the Supreme's own portion is not bound up with them." That is, Viṣṇu's relation with the *guṇas* as their controller is called *yoga*. That Puruṣa, therefore, is never bound by the *guṇas*. Still less is any of the Viṣṇus — His own portions, in truth nondifferent from the Supreme Person — ever in any way joined with the *guṇas*. Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "But how can the Supreme Person have a relation with the *guṇas*? That contradicts such statements as '*māyā*, abashed, withdraws from His sight' (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.7.47). To this the word *yoga* replies. The *guṇas* are the controlled, and the Puruṣa who appears in three ways is the controller: such is the relation, and here it is called *yoga*, not bondage. And He is not joined with them, for in the words of Drumila, lord of yogīs (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.4.5), no relation with the *guṇas* is mentioned."

"If you say: is not a relation of Mahā-Viṣṇu with the *guṇas* established? For then it would contradict the words '*māyā*, abashed, stands turned away from Bhagavān.' The answer is this: the word '*guṇa*' means 'the controlled.' The Puruṣa who ap-

pears in three forms — Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Śiva — is related to *prakṛti* as her controller. In the world this is called *yoga*; it is never denoted by the word 'bondage' by those three *guṇas*. That Viṣṇu is never joined with the *guṇas*, for in the words of Drumila, one of the nine Yogendras, no relation of the three *guṇas* with Viṣṇu is mentioned at all."

With both kinds of cause — material and efficient — He is related as the one who glances; yet māyā can in no way overpower Him. The world with all its transformations is a transformation of Bhagavān's potency of desire (*icchā-śakti*), but in Him no material transformation is possible. See Ādi 2.52, 54.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 1, Chapter 11, verse 38)

এতদীশনমীশস্য প্রকৃতিস্থোঽপি তদ্গুণৈঃ ।
ন যুজ্যতে সদাত্মস্থৈর্যথা বুদ্ধিস্তদাশ্রয়া ॥ ৮৭ ॥

etad īśanam īśasya
this the lordship of the Lord
prakṛti-stho 'pi tad-guṇaiḥ
in material nature abiding though by its qualities
na yujyate sadātma-sthair
not is affected ever abiding in Him
yathā buddhis tad-āśrayā
as the intelligence sheltered in Him

87 "This is the lordship of the Lord: though He abides within material nature, He is never affected by its qualities — just as the intelligence of those who have taken shelter of Him is not affected." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 1.11.38)[6]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
See Ādi 2.55.

The Lord (Īśvara) possesses inconceivable potency —

এইমত গীতাতেহো পুনঃ পুনঃ কয় ।
সর্ব্বদা ঈশ্বর-তত্ত্ব অচিন্ত্যশক্তি হয় ॥ ৮৮ ॥

ei mata gītāteho punaḥ punaḥ kaya
in this way in the Gītā also again again it says
sarvadā īśvara-tattva acintya-śakti haya
always of the Lord the truth of inconceivable potency is

88 So the Gītā too declares again and again that the truth of the Lord is always endowed with inconceivable potency:

The world's relation with the Lord — difference and nondifference —

আমি ত' জগতে বসি, জগৎ আমাতে ।
না আমি জগতে বসি, না আমা জগতে ॥ ৮৯ ॥

āmi ta' jagate vasi, jagat āmāte
I indeed in the world abide the world in Me
nā āmi jagate vasi, nā āmā jagate
not I in the world abide not in Me the world

89 "I abide in the world, and the world is in Me; and yet I do not abide in the world, nor is the world in Me.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I abide in the world, and the world abides in Me; and yet I am not in the world, and the world is not in Me. This is called the "inconceivable meaning."

Anubhāṣya.
Without Bhagavān's existence the visible world can have no foundation at all. The world rests in Bhagavān; but one must not therefore take the external perception — the vision of *acit*, full of enjoyment — to be Bhagavān, nor regard the world of enjoyment as Godhood. Enjoyment, that is, aversion to Bhagavān — in other words, māyā — does not rest in Bhagavān: in the Reality, Bhagavān, aversion to Bhagavān can have no place. Bhagavān Adhokṣaja descends into the world, into the phenomenal realm (*prapañca*), and yet He does not become, and cannot become, a fragmented and perishable thing of this world. In both His manifest and unmanifest pastimes He is eternally beyond māyā and eternally her master — that is, His nature as the *nirguṇa* Vaikuṇṭha is eternally present. Through various pastimes He descends into the world and remains the original presiding deity of everything that exists in the world.

Nor can the world exist as a second reality, with a being separate from Him. Viṣṇu Himself never comes into contact with the material world or with māyā. Neither His own *svarūpa* nor His opulence of the same nature (*tad-rūpa-vaibhava*) belongs in the least to the measurable world of enjoyment or to *prakṛti*, which is turned away from Him. This is the independent sovereignty and the Godhood of Bhagavān, who acts by His own will and is full of inconceivable majesty.

See the *Gauḍīya-bhāṣya*, with its various commentaries, on the verse "*yathā mahānti*" (34), one of the *catuḥ-ślokī* in the ninth chapter of the second canto of *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, and also *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.15.36.

অচিন্ত্য ঐশ্বর্য্য এই জানিহ আমার ।
এই ত' গীতার অর্থ কৈল পরচার ॥ ৯০ ॥

acintya aiśvarya ei jāniha āmāra
inconceivable opulence this know My
ei ta' gītāra artha kaila paracāra
this indeed of the Gītā the meaning is made proclaimed

90 Know this to be My inconceivable power." Such is the meaning the Gītā proclaims.

Anubhāṣya.
The *Gītā* (9.4–5) says: "By Me, in My unmanifest form, this whole world is pervaded. All beings rest in Me, but I do not rest in them. And yet beings do not rest in Me — behold My divine yoga! My Self sustains beings and brings them into being, yet does not abide in beings."

সেই ত' পুরুষ যাঁর 'অংশ' ধরে নাম ।
চৈতন্যের সঙ্গে সেই নিত্যানন্দ-রাম ॥ ৯১ ॥

sei ta' puruṣa yāṁra 'aṁśa' dhare nāma
that very Puruṣa whose part bears the name
caitanyera saṅge sei nityānanda-rāma
of Caitanya the companion that Nityānanda-Rāma

91 He of whom that Puruṣa is called a part is Nityānanda-Rāma, the companion of Caitanya.

এই ত’ নবম শ্লোকের অর্থ-বিবরণ ।
দশম শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন দিয়া মন ॥ ৯২ ॥

ei ta’ navama ślokera artha-vivaraṇa
this indeed of the ninth verse of the meaning the explanation
daśama ślokera artha śuna diyā mana
of the tenth verse the meaning hear giving the mind

92 Such is the explanation of the ninth verse. Now hear attentively the meaning of the tenth.

The meaning of the tenth of the fourteen opening verses —

যস্যাংশাংশঃ শ্রীল-গর্ভোদশায়ী
যন্নাভ্যব্জং লোকসঙ্ঘাতনালম্ ।
লোকস্রষ্টুঃ সূতিকাধামধাতু-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ৯৩ ॥

yasyāṁśāṁśaḥ śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī
whose part of a part the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī
yan-nābhy-abjaṁ loka-saṅghāta-nālam
whose navel-lotus of the worlds totality as its stem
loka-sraṣṭuḥ sūtikā-dhāma dhātus
of the creator of the worlds of birth the place of Brahmā
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

93 “I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of His part is the blessed Garbhodakaśāyī, whose navel-lotus, with all the worlds as its stem, is the birthplace of Brahmā, the creator of the worlds.” (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[7]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

I bow down to Nityānanda-Rāma, a portion of whose portion is Garbhodaśāyī. The stem of the lotus that grows from Garbhodaśāyī’s navel is the birthplace of Vidhātā, who beholds the worlds[14], and the resting place of all the worlds.

Anubhāṣya.

yan-nābhy-abjam (the lotus that grows from whose navel), **loka-saṅghāta-nālam** (whose stem, that is, support, is the host of worlds, the fourteen worlds), is **loka-sraṣṭuḥ** (Brahmā's) **sūtikā-dhāma** (birthplace); **śrīla-garbhoda-śāyī** (the second Puruṣa-avatāra) is **yasya** (Nityānanda-Rāma's) **aṁśāṁśaḥ** (portion of a portion, *kalā*); **taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmam ahaṁ prapadye** (to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender).

Description of Garbhodaśāyī —

সেই ত' পুরুষ অনন্তব্রহ্মাণ্ড সৃজিয়া ।
সব অণ্ডে প্রবেশিলা বহু-মূর্ত্তি হঞা ॥ ৯৪ ॥

sei ta' puruṣa ananta-brahmāṇḍa sṛjiyā
that very Puruṣa endless universes having created
saba aṇḍe praveśilā bahu-mūrti hañā
into all universes entered many forms becoming

94 Having created endless universes, that Puruṣa entered them all, becoming many forms.

ভিতরে প্রবেশি' দেখে সব অন্ধকার ।
রহিতে নাহিক স্থান করিল বিচার ॥ ৯৫ ॥

bhitare praveśi' dekhe saba andhakāra
within having entered sees all darkness
rahite nāhika sthāna karila vicāra
to stay there is no place made reflection

95 Entering, He saw only darkness everywhere, and finding no place to stay, He reflected.

নিজাঙ্গ-স্বেদজল করিল সৃজন ।
সেই জলে কৈল অর্দ্ধ-ব্রহ্মাণ্ড ভরণ ॥ ৯৬ ॥

nijāṅga-sveda-jala karila sṛjana
of His own body the sweat-water made creation
sei jale kaila ardha-brahmāṇḍa bharaṇa
with that water made half the universe filling

96 From the perspiration of His own body He created water and with it filled half the universe.

Anubhāṣya.
See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.10.10.

ব্রহ্মাণ্ড-প্রমাণ পঞ্চাশৎকোটি-যোজন ।
আয়াম, বিস্তার, দুই হয় এক সম ॥ ৯৭ ॥

brahmāṇḍa-pramāṇa pañcāśat-koṭi-yojana
of the universe the measure fifty crores of yojanas
āyāma, vistāra, dui haya eka sama
length breadth the two are one equal

97 The universe measures fifty crores of yojanas, equal in length and breadth.

The origin of the fourteen worlds —

জলে ভরি' অর্দ্ধ তাঁহা কৈল নিজ-বাস ।
আর অর্দ্ধে কৈল চৌদ্দভুবন প্রকাশ ॥ ৯৮ ॥

jale bhari' ardha tāṁhā kaila nija-vāsa
with water filling half there made His own dwelling
āra ardhe kaila caudda-bhuvana prakāśa
the other in the half made of the fourteen worlds manifestation

98 Filling half with water, He made His dwelling there; in the other half He manifested the fourteen worlds.

Anubhāṣya.
Caudda bhuvana (the fourteen worlds): Bhū, Bhuvaḥ, Svaḥ, Mahaḥ, Jana, Tapaḥ and Satya — these seven higher worlds; and Tala, Atala, Vitala, Nitala, Talātala,

Mahātala and Sutala — these seven *pātālas* (lower worlds). See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.5.38–42 and 11.4.3.

In the Garbha Ocean He manifests His own abode, Vaikuṇṭha —

তাঁহাই প্রকট কৈল বৈকুণ্ঠ নিজ-ধাম ।
শেষ-শয়ন-জলে করিল বিশ্রাম ॥ ৯৯ ॥

tāṁhāi prakaṭa kaila vaikuṇṭha nija-dhāma
there manifest made Vaikuṇṭha His own abode
śeṣa-śayana-jale karila viśrāma
Śeṣa as bed on the water made rest

99 There He manifested Vaikuṇṭha, His own abode, and rested on the water with Śeṣa as His bed.

He whom the hymn of the Ṛg-veda praises —

অনন্তশয়্যাতে তাঁহা করিল শয়ন ।
সহস্র মস্তক তাঁর সহস্র বদন ॥ ১০০ ॥

সহস্র-চরণ-হস্ত, সহস্র-নয়ন ।
সর্ব্ব-অবতার-বীজ, জগৎ-কারণ ॥ ১০১ ॥

ananta-śayyāte tāṁhā karila śayana
on Ananta the bed there made lying down
sahasra mastaka tāṁra sahasra vadana
a thousand heads His a thousand faces
sahasra-caraṇa-hasta, sahasra-nayana
a thousand feet hands a thousand eyes
sarva-avatāra-bīja, jagat-kāraṇa
of all avatāras the seed of the world the cause

100–101 There He lay on Ananta as His bed. He has a thousand heads and a thousand faces, a thousand hands and feet and a thousand eyes. He is the seed of all avatāras and the cause of the world.

Anubhāṣya.

See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.2, 4, 5.

Anubhāṣya.

(*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.3.4): "With flawless eyes the devotees behold His wondrous form with thousands of feet, thighs, arms and faces, with thousands of heads, ears, eyes and noses, shining with thousands of crowns, garments and earrings." (*Ṛg-veda-saṁhitā* 8.4.17; *Sāma-veda* 6.4.4.3; *Śukla Yajur-veda* 31.1; *Atharva-veda* 19.6.1): "The Puruṣa has a thousand heads, a thousand eyes, a thousand feet. Enveloping the earth on every side, He extends beyond it by ten fingers' breadth." See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.4.4–5 and *Brahma-saṁhitā* 5.10–11.

From Him come Viṣṇu, Brahmā and Rudra —

তাঁর নাভিপদ্ম হৈতে উঠিল এক পদ্ম ।
সেই পদ্মে হৈল ব্রহ্মার জন্ম-সদ্ম ॥ ১০২ ॥

tāṁra nābhi-padma haite uṭhila eka padma
His from the navel-lotus arose one lotus
sei padme haila brahmāra janma-sadma
that lotus became of Brahmā birth the abode

102 From His navel-lotus a lotus arose, and that lotus became the birthplace of Brahmā.

সেই পদ্মনালে হৈল চৌদ্দভুবন ।
তেঁহো ব্রহ্মা হঞা সৃষ্টি করিল সৃজন ॥ ১০৩ ॥

sei padma-nāle haila caudda-bhuvana
in that lotus stem came to be the fourteen worlds
teṁho brahmā hañā sṛṣṭi karila sṛjana
He Brahmā becoming creation made bringing forth

103 In the stem of that lotus the fourteen worlds came to be, and He, becoming Brahmā, brought forth the creation.

Anubhāṣya.

In the *Mahābhārata*, in the *Mokṣa-dharma*, in the narrative of Nārāyaṇa (*Śānti-parva*, Chapter 339, verses 70–72, and Chapter 340, verses 27–28), it is said: "He

who is Pradyumna is also Aniruddha; He is also the father of Brahmā." Here it must be understood that He who is Garbhodaśāyī is also Kṣīrodaśāyī. The two are nondifferent, and therefore in truth Pradyumna is the controller — that is, the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) — and the father of Hiraṇyagarbha, who was born from the lotus. See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.1.2.

বিষ্ণুরূপ হঞা করে জগৎ পালনে ।
গুণাতীত-বিষ্ণু স্পর্শ নাহি মায়া-গুণে ॥ ১০৪ ॥

viṣṇu-rūpa hañā kare jagat pālane
Viṣṇu's form taking makes of the world maintenance
guṇātīta-viṣṇu sparśa nāhi māyā-guṇe
beyond the guṇas Viṣṇu touch there is no of māyā with the guṇas

104 Taking the form of Viṣṇu, He maintains the world. Viṣṇu is beyond the guṇas; the guṇas of māyā never touch Him.

Anubhāṣya.

See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 3.8.16. The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the three Puruṣas (sections 137–139), says: "The four-armed *vilāsa* of this Garbhodaśāyī enters the lotus of the worlds and, called Viṣṇu, lies in the Ocean of Milk. He becomes the indwelling Lord in the hearts of all embodied beings, from the gods down to the unmoving, and abides as if in many forms. The form of Viṣṇu of whom the *Sātvata-tantra* says, 'The third abides in all beings,' is accepted as His *vilāsa*." The four-armed form, the *vilāsa* of Garbhodaśāyī, enters the lotus of the worlds, is called "Viṣṇu" and lies in the Ocean of Milk. As the indwelling Lord, this Viṣṇu abides in the hearts of all living beings, from the gods down to the unmoving, as if in many forms. The form of Viṣṇu called in the *Sātvata-tantra* "the third Puruṣa, who abides in all beings" is the *vilāsa-mūrti* of Garbhodaśāyī Viṣṇu.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the Puruṣa (section 12), gives Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "Viṣṇu is not joined even with *sattva*; by His will alone He merely controls it. That is why it is said: 'The highest good comes from Him.' So the *Vāmana Purāṇa* says: 'Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Īśa are the three forms of the great-souled Viṣṇu. In Brahmā He is in the form of Brahmā, in Śiva in the form of Śiva, but the god Janārdana, in the form of Viṣṇu, remains apart.'" Viṣṇu is the presiding deity of the *guṇa* of *sattva*, yet He is never bound by *sattva-guṇa*: by His will alone He merely controls it. That is why it is said, "From Him alone comes the

welfare of the jīva." So the *Vāmana Purāṇa* says that one and the same Viṣṇu exists in the forms of Brahmā, Viṣṇu and Śiva: in Brahmā He is in the form of Brahmā, in Śiva in the form of Śiva, and Janārdana in the form of Viṣṇu remains separate from them both.

And where Viṣṇu is described (sections 29–30): "Viṣṇu extends (*tanoti*) *sattva*, and so in the scriptures He is known as *sattva-tanu*. His avatāras, likewise, are *sattva-tanu*. Or else *sattva* is His 'body' (*tanu*) in the sense of an external seat. That He is *nirguṇa*, beyond the *guṇas*, is therefore fully established in all the scriptures. So it is said (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.88.5): 'Hari is indeed *nirguṇa*, the Puruṣa Himself, beyond *prakṛti*.'"

He extends *sattva-guṇa*, and so in the scriptures Viṣṇu has received the name *sattva-tanu*. The avatāras of Kṣīrābdhiśāyī Viṣṇu are likewise called *sattva-tanu*; or He is called *sattva-tanu* because that body, *sattva*, is merely His external seat. That is why all the scriptures call Viṣṇu *nirguṇa*. So too in the tenth canto: "Hari is *nirguṇa*, the Supreme Lord Himself, beyond *prakṛti*, the giver of knowledge to Brahmā and the other gods, the witness of all; whoever worships Him attains freedom from the *guṇas*." This is why the verse of the *Bhāgavatam* says: "From this *sattva-tanu* comes every kind of good."

রুদ্ররূপ ধরি' করে জগৎ সংহার ।
সৃষ্টি-স্থিতি-প্রলয় — ইচ্ছায় যাঁহার ॥ ১০৫ ॥

rudra-rūpa dhari' kare jagat saṁhāra
Rudra's form assuming makes of the world destruction
sṛṣṭi-sthiti-pralaya — icchāya yāṁhāra
creation maintenance dissolution by the will of whom

105 Assuming the form of Rudra, He destroys the world. Creation, maintenance and dissolution all take place by His will.

Anubhāṣya.
The Puruṣa of the verse *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.2.23 is this very Garbhodaśāyī!

হিরণ্যগর্ভ, অন্তর্য্যামী, জগৎ-কারণ ।
যাঁর অংশে করি' করে বিরাট-কল্পন ॥ ১০৬ ॥

hiraṇya-garbha, antaryāmī, jagat-kāraṇa
Hiraṇyagarbha the Indweller of the world the cause
yāṁra aṁśe kari' kare virāṭa-kalpana
whom as a part considering make of the universal form the conception

106 He is Hiraṇyagarbha, the Indweller, the cause of the world; and it is a part of Him that is conceived as the universal form (*virāṭ*).

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Garbhodaśāyī Viṣṇu Himself is Hiraṇyagarbha, the indwelling Lord (*antaryāmī*) and the cause of the world. His portion is conceived of as the "Virāṭ."

হেন নারায়ণ, — যাঁর অংশের অংশ ।
সেই প্রভু নিত্যানন্দ — সর্ব্ব-অবতংস ॥ ১০৭ ॥

hena nārāyaṇa, — yāṁra aṁśera aṁśa
such Nārāyaṇa of whose part a part
sei prabhu nityānanda — sarva-avataṁsa
that Lord Nityānanda of all the crown

107 Great as Nārāyaṇa is, He is only a part of a part of Lord Nityānanda, the crown of all avatāras.

Anubhāṣya.
Brahma-saṁhitā (5.14): "Thus by a single portion He Himself enters each one." Madhya 20.283–293.

দশম শ্লোকের অর্থ কৈল বিবরণ ।
একাদশ শ্লোকের অর্থ শুন দিয়া মন ॥ ১০৮ ॥

daśama ślokera artha kaila vivaraṇa
of the tenth verse the meaning I made explanation
ekādaśa ślokera artha śuna diyā mana
of the eleventh verse the meaning hear giving the mind

108 I have explained the meaning of the tenth verse; now hear attentively the meaning of the eleventh.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

"The meaning of the tenth verse": the tenth verse and the verses that follow it describe Garbhodaśāyī Viṣṇu.

Explanation of the eleventh of the fourteen opening verses —

যস্যাংশাংশাংশঃ পরাত্মাখিলানাং
পোষ্টা বিষ্ণুর্ভাতি দুগ্ধাব্ধিশায়ী ।
ক্ষৌণীভর্ত্তা যৎকলা সোঽপ্যনন্ত-
স্তং শ্রীনিত্যানন্দরামং প্রপদ্যে ॥ ১০৯ ॥

yasyāṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ parātmākhilānāṁ
whose part of a part of a part the Supersoul of all
poṣṭā viṣṇur bhāti dugdhābdhi-śāyī
the maintainer Viṣṇu appears lying on the Ocean of Milk
kṣauṇī-bhartā yat-kalā so 'py anantas
of the earth the upholder whose part He also Ananta
taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmaṁ prapadye
to Him Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender

109 "I take refuge in Śrī Nityānanda Rāma. A part of a part of His part is Viṣṇu who lies on the Ocean of Milk, the Supersoul and maintainer of all beings; and Ananta, who upholds the earth, is a portion of that Viṣṇu." (diary of Svarūpa Dāmodara)[8]

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
I bow down to Nityānanda-Rāma. A portion of a portion of His portion is Kṣīrodaśāyī, the Paramātmā of all, Viṣṇu the maintainer; and His *kalā* is "Ananta," who holds up the earth.

Anubhāṣya.
akhilānām (of the *jīvas*) **parātmā** (the Paramātmā), **poṣṭā** (the maintainer), **dugdhābdhi-śāyī** (the third Puruṣa-avatāra, Kṣīrodaśāyī) **viṣṇuḥ bhāti** (Viṣṇu shines); **saḥ api** (He too) is **yasya aṁśāṁśāṁśaḥ** (a portion of a portion of the portion of Nityānanda-Rāma: a portion of a portion is a *kalā*, and its portion a *vikalā*); **kṣauṇī-bhartā** (the maintainer of the world) **anantaḥ** (Ananta) is **yat** (Kṣīrodaśāyī's) **kalā** (portion of a portion); **taṁ śrī-nityānanda-rāmam ahaṁ prapadye** (to that Śrī Nityānanda-Rāma I surrender).

Description of the abode of Kṣīrodaśāyī Viṣṇu —

নারায়ণের নাভিনাল-মধ্যেতে ধরণী ।
ধরণীর মধ্যে সপ্ত সমুদ্র যে গণি ॥ ১১০ ॥

nārāyaṇera nābhi-nāla-madhyete dharaṇī
of Nārāyaṇa navel stem within the earth
dharaṇīra madhye sapta samudra ye gaṇi
of the earth within seven oceans which are counted

110 Within the stem of Nārāyaṇa's navel-lotus is the earth, and within the earth are counted seven oceans.

"Śvetadvīpa" —

তাঁহা ক্ষীরোদধি-মধ্যে 'শ্বেতদ্বীপ' নাম ।
পালয়িতা বিষ্ণু, — তাঁর সেই নিজ ধাম ॥ ১১১ ॥

tāṁhā kṣīrodadhi-madhye 'śvetadvīpa' nāma
there of the Milk Ocean in the midst Śvetadvīpa named
pālayitā viṣṇu, — tāṁra sei nija dhāma
the maintainer Viṣṇu His that own abode

111 There, in the midst of the Ocean of Milk, is the island called Śvetadvīpa, the abode of Viṣṇu the maintainer.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Siddhānta-śiromaṇi* says: "The best of teachers say that the half of the earth lying north of the Salt Ocean is Jambudvīpa. In the other, southern half lie the six other *dvīpas* and the oceans of salt, milk and the rest. First comes the ocean of salt water, then the ocean of milk, from which nectar, the moon and Śrī appeared; there dwells Vāsudeva, the shelter of all, whose lotus feet are honoured by lotus-born Brahmā and the other gods. Then come the oceans of yogurt, of ghee and of sugarcane juice, then of wine, and the last is of fresh water. Within the ocean of fresh water is the submarine fire, Vaḍavānala, and the *pātāla* worlds are layers within the earth." That is: 1) the Salt Ocean, 2) the Milk Ocean, 3) the ocean of yogurt, 4) the ocean of ghee, 5) the ocean of sugarcane juice, 6) the ocean of wine, 7) the ocean of fresh water. South of the Salt Ocean is the Kṣīroda, the Milk Ocean; there

Vāsudeva, the shelter of all, dwells, and Brahmā and the other gods worship His feet.

The indwelling Lord of each individual jīva —

সকল জীবের তিঁহো হয়ে অন্তর্য্যামী ।
জগৎ-পালক তিঁহো জগতের স্বামী ॥ ১১২ ॥

sakala jīvera tiṁho haye antaryāmī
of all beings He is the Indweller
jagat-pālaka tiṁho jagatera svāmī
of the world the maintainer He of the world the master

112 He is the Indweller of all beings, the maintainer of the world and its master.

Anubhāṣya.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing Śrī Viṣṇu — the gist of verses 26–28: "I shall briefly point out all the abodes mentioned in the *Viṣṇu-dharmottara* and other books among the manifestations of Viṣṇu within the universe. Namely: 'Above Rudraloka there is another world, "Viṣṇuloka," fifty thousand *yojanas* in size and inaccessible to every other world. Above it, east of Sumeru, in the middle of the Salt Ocean, within the waters, there is said to be a huge golden "Mahā-Viṣṇuloka"; Brahmā goes there from time to time to see it. In that world Janārdana Viṣṇu sleeps with Lakṣmī on the couch of Śeṣa during the four months of the rainy season. East of Meru, in the middle of the Milk Ocean, amid its waters, there is another abode, "Śubhravarṇā" (the white); in it Lord Viṣṇu sits with Lakṣmī on the throne of Śeṣa. There too the Lord enjoys the bliss of sleep during the four months of the rains. South of it, in the Milk Ocean, is a most beautiful island, twenty-five thousand *yojanas* in size, known as "Śvetadvīpa."'"

The *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa* also says: "The island surrounded by the Milk Ocean, a hundred thousand *yojanas* in extent, … — that very great, beautiful golden island is called 'Śvetadvīpa.'" Further, the *Viṣṇu Purāṇa* and other books, and the *Mokṣa-dharma* of the *Mahābhārata* as well, describe it: "Śvetadvīpa lies on the northern shore of the Milk Ocean," and so on. The *Padma Purāṇa* says that Śvetadvīpa shines on the northern shore of the Ocean of Water. On Śvetadvīpa see *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 11.15.18.

The *Śrī Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the Puruṣa (section 10), says: "The third form, too, is seen from the verse of the second canto (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.2.8): 'Some [meditate on Him] in the space of the heart within their own body.'" Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "So too Aniruddha, the lord of the Milk Ocean, the third Puruṣa, in a form the size of a span, dwelling in the hearts of all jīvas, is the object of meditation." That is, the third Puruṣa, Kṣīraśāyī, in a form the size of a span, is to be meditated upon as the indwelling Lord of all jīvas. Where Viṣṇu is described (section 25): "He who is called 'Viṣṇu' is considered to be Kṣīrāmbudhiśaya. He is the *vilāsa* of Garbhodaśāyī, and so the lords of the sages call Him Nārāyaṇa and the indwelling Lord of the Virāṭ." That is, He who is called "Viṣṇu" is Kṣīrodaśāyī. He is the *vilāsa* of Garbhodaśāyī, and so the sages call Viṣṇu "Nārāyaṇa" and also the indwelling Lord of the Virāṭ.

The avatāras of the yugas and manvantaras come from Kṣīrodakaśāyī —

যুগ-মন্বন্তরে ধরি' নানা অবতার ।
ধর্ম্ম সংস্থাপন করে, অধর্ম্ম সংহার ॥ ১১৩ ॥

yuga-manvantare dhari' nānā avatāra
in the yugas manvantaras taking many avatāras
dharma saṁsthāpana kare, adharma saṁhāra
of dharma establishing makes of adharma destruction

113 In each yuga and manvantara He takes many avatāras, establishing dharma and destroying adharma.

দেবগণে না পায় যাঁহার দরশন ।
ক্ষীরোদকতীরে যাই' করেন স্তবন ॥ ১১৪ ॥

deva-gaṇe nā pāya yāṁhāra daraśana
the gods not obtain whose sight
kṣīrodaka-tīre yāi' karena stavana
of the Milk Ocean to the shore going make praise

114 Even the gods cannot see Him; they go to the shore of the Ocean of Milk and offer Him prayers.

Kṣīrodaśāyī Viṣṇu is the maintainer of the world —

তবে অবতরি' করে জগৎ পালন ।
অনন্ত বৈভব তাঁর নাহিক গণন ॥ ১১৫ ॥

tabe avatari' kare jagat pālana
then descending makes of the world protection
ananta vaibhava tāṁra nāhika gaṇana
endless splendour His there is no counting

115 Then He descends and protects the world. His splendour is endless, beyond all counting.

সেই বিষ্ণু হয় যাঁর অংশাংশের অংশ ।
সেই প্রভু নিত্যানন্দ — সর্ব্ব-অবতংস ॥ ১১৬ ॥

sei viṣṇu haya yāṁra aṁśāṁśera aṁśa
that Viṣṇu is of whose part of a part a part
sei prabhu nityānanda — sarva-avataṁsa
that Lord Nityānanda of all the crown

116 And that Viṣṇu is a part of a part of a part of Lord Nityānanda, the crown of all avatāras.

His form as the great serpent called "Śeṣa" —

সেই বিষ্ণু 'শেষ' রূপে ধরেন ধরণী ।
কাঁহা আছে মহী, শিরে, হেন নাহি জানি ॥ ১১৭ ॥

sei viṣṇu 'śeṣa' rūpe dharena dharaṇī
that Viṣṇu Śeṣa in the form holds the earth
kāṁhā āche mahī, śire, hena nāhi jāni
where is the earth on the head this not knows

117 That Viṣṇu, in the form of Śeṣa, holds the earth, and does not even know where on His heads it lies.

সহস্র বিস্তীর্ণ যাঁর ফণার মণ্ডল ।
সূর্য্য জিনি' মণিগণ করে ঝলমল ॥ ১১৮ ॥

sahasra vistīrṇa yāṁra phaṇāra maṇḍala
a thousand broad whose of hoods the circle
sūrya jini' maṇi-gaṇa kare jhala-mala
the sun surpassing gems multitude make glittering

118 On the circle of His thousand broad hoods hosts of gems glitter, outshining the sun.

পঞ্চাশৎকোটি-যোজন পৃথিবী বিস্তার ।
যাঁর একফণে রহে সর্ষপ-আকার ॥ ১১৯ ॥

pañcāśat-koṭi-yojana pṛthivī vistāra
fifty crores of yojanas the earth's extent
yāṁra eka-phaṇe rahe sarṣapa-ākāra
whose on one hood remains of a mustard seed the size

119 The earth, fifty crores of yojanas wide, rests on one of His hoods like a mustard seed.

Anubhāṣya.
See *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 5.17.21 and 5.25.2.

Viṣṇu in the form of Śeṣa, the devotee of Kṛṣṇa —

সেই ত' 'অনন্ত' 'শেষ' — ভক্ত-অবতার ।
ঈশ্বরের সেবা বিনা নাহি জানে আর ॥ ১২০ ॥

sei ta' 'ananta' 'śeṣa' — bhakta-avatāra
that very Ananta Śeṣa devotee avatāra
īśvarera sevā vinā nāhi jāne āra
of the Lord service except not knows other

120 That Ananta Śeṣa is an avatāra in the form of a devotee; He knows nothing but service to the Lord.

Anubhāṣya.

Śrī Jīva Prabhu writes in the *Śrī Kṛṣṇa-sandarbha* (section 86): "'Ananta, the *kalā* of Vāsudeva, thousand-mouthed, self-effulgent (*svarāṭ*), the god, will appear first, wishing to please Hari.'[21] The *kalā* of Vāsudeva, the son of Śrī Vasudeva, is His first portion, Śrī Saṅkarṣaṇa. *Svarāṭ*: He who shines by His own [glory] alone. Therefore He is Ananta, unlimited by time or place; He, called Śeṣa, is also the thousand-mouthed one. By one portion of Himself He is the one called Śeṣa. In the *Skanda Purāṇa*, in the *Ayodhyā-māhātmya*: 'Then, as all looked on, Śakra spoke sweetly to Lakṣmaṇa, true to his word, who had become Śeṣa: "Attain Your own eternal supreme abode of Viṣṇu. Your form has come too — Śeṣa with his shining hoods." Having said this to Lakṣmaṇa, the king of the gods, together with the gods, sent Śeṣa, who is able to bear the burden of the earth, to Pātāla.' Therefore both in the words 'My abode called Śeṣa' (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.2.8) and here, in the words 'remains, called Śeṣa' (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.3.25), He is called an unfailing portion. Or else [Śeṣa is He] from whom the name and fame of Śeṣa come."

The *kalā* of Bhagavān (the portion of His portion) is Śrī Anantadeva, thousand-mouthed and *svarāṭ*. Wishing to do what pleases Śrī Hari, He is always present before Him. The first portion of Vāsudeva, the son of Vasudeva, is Saṅkarṣaṇa. He is self-manifest and is therefore *svarāṭ*; and so He is Ananta, that is, free from the limits of time and place. He is present also in the form of the thousand-mouthed "Śeṣa." "By one portion" means in the form of the avatāra called Śeṣa. In the *Skanda Purāṇa*, in the *Ayodhyā-māhātmya*: "As all looked on, Indra, the king of the gods, began to speak to Lakṣmaṇa, true to his vow, who bore the form of Śeṣa: 'Go to Your own eternal abode of Viṣṇu — Your form, Śeṣa adorned with hoods, has come as well.' Having said this, the king of the gods sent Lakṣmaṇa in the form of Śeṣa, able to bear the burden of the earth, to Pātāla and went to the abode of the gods." (That is, when Lakṣmaṇa, the *vyūha* Saṅkarṣaṇa, descended with Śrī Rāma, Śeṣa, the bearer of the earth who lives in Pātāla, came and merged with him. Later, when the time of disappearance came (*aprakaṭa*: the Lord and His eternal associates do not die as ordinary beings do, but only become invisible to this world), "Śeṣa" separated from Lakṣmaṇa and went to his own abode, Pātāla, and Lakṣmaṇa went to Vaikuṇṭha, the abode of Viṣṇu.) Therefore in the words "My abode called Śeṣa" too, "Śeṣa" means that by which the end (*śeṣa*) is reached — that which remains at the very end. Just as the remainder is nondifferent from the original thing, so Śeṣa is spoken of as a nondifferent portion of Vāsudeva. Or else "Śeṣa" is He from whom comes His fame by the name of Śeṣa.

The *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, describing the truth of Rudra (section 19), gives Śrī Baladeva's commentary: "'Like Śeṣa': Śeṣa who is the bed of Śārṅgī (Viṣṇu), His supporting potency, belongs to the category of the Lord; but the Śeṣa who bears the earth is a jīva whom He has entered." That is, Śeṣa in the form of the bed of Viṣṇu, the wielder of the bow Śārṅga — the supporting potency — belongs to the category of the Lord, while the earth-bearing "Śeṣa" belongs to the category of empowered (*śaktyāviṣṭa*) jīvas. And again, where the truth of Śrī Rāma is described (section 28): "Saṅkarṣaṇa, the second *vyūha*, is Rāma Himself. Uniting with Śeṣa, the bearer of the earth, He became manifest. Śeṣa is twofold: one bears the earth, the other is the bed of Śārṅgī. Of them, the one who bears the earth is considered Saṅkarṣaṇa, because Saṅkarṣaṇa has entered him. But the one who is the bed thinks of Himself as His friend and servant." That is, Saṅkarṣaṇa of the second *catur-vyūha*, uniting with the earth-bearing "Śeṣa," descended in the form of Rāma. "Śeṣa" is twofold: the bearer of the earth and Bhagavān's bed. The earth-bearing "Śeṣa" is an *āveśa-avatāra* of Saṅkarṣaṇa; that is why he too is called "Saṅkarṣaṇa." The one who is the bed thinks of Himself as the servant and friend of the wielder of Śārṅga.

He is always absorbed in glorifying Kṛṣṇa and instructs the four Sanas —

সহস্র-বদনে করে কৃষ্ণগুণ গান ।
নিরবধি গুণ গান, অন্ত নাহি পা'ন ॥ ১২১ ॥

sahasra-vadane kare kṛṣṇa-guṇa gāna
with a thousand mouths makes of Kṛṣṇa's qualities singing
niravadhi guṇa gāna, anta nāhi pā'na
without end qualities He sings end not finds

121 With His thousand mouths He sings of Kṛṣṇa's qualities; He sings without cease and never reaches their end.

সনকাদি ভাগবত শুনে যার মুখে ।
ভগবানের গুণ কহে, ভাসে প্রেমসুখে ॥ ১২২ ॥

sanakādi bhāgavata śune yāra mukhe
Sanaka and the others the Bhāgavata hear from whose mouth
bhagavānera guṇa kahe, bhāse prema-sukhe
of Bhagavān the qualities He tells He floats in the joy of love

122 From His mouth Sanaka and the other Kumāras hear the *Bhāgavatam*, while He, awash in the joy of love, tells of the qualities of Bhagavān.

Serving Kṛṣṇa in ten forms —

ছত্র, পাদুকা, শয্যা, উপাধান, বসন ।
আরাম, আবাস, যজ্ঞসূত্র, সিংহাসন ॥ ১২৩ ॥

chatra, pādukā, śayyā, upādhāna, vasana
umbrella sandals bed pillow garments
ārāma, āvāsa, yajña-sūtra, siṁhāsana
resting place dwelling sacred thread throne

123 He becomes umbrella, sandals, bed, pillow, garments, resting place, dwelling, sacred thread and throne.

Why He is called Śeṣa —

এত মূর্ত্তি-ভেদ করি' কৃষ্ণসেবা করে ।
কৃষ্ণের শেষতা পাঞা 'শেষ' নাম ধরে ॥ ১২৪ ॥

eta mūrti-bheda kari' kṛṣṇa-sevā kare
so many forms different assuming Kṛṣṇa's service He does
kṛṣṇera śeṣatā pāñā 'śeṣa' nāma dhare
of Kṛṣṇa's service the utmost limit reaching Śeṣa the name He bears

124 Assuming all these different forms He serves Kṛṣṇa; and because He has reached the utmost limit of service to Kṛṣṇa, He bears the name Śeṣa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Śeṣatā means ultimate servitude (*dāsya*).

Anubhāṣya.
"You alone remain, and so You are called Śeṣa." (*Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.3.25)

সেই ত' অনন্ত, যাঁর কহি এক কলা ।
হেন প্রভু নিত্যানন্দ, কে জানে তাঁর খেলা ॥ ১২৫ ॥

sei ta' ananta, yāṁra kahi eka kalā
that very Ananta of whom I call one kalā
hena prabhu nityānanda, ke jāne tāṁra khelā
such Lord Nityānanda who knows His play

125 That Ananta I call but one kalā of Him. Such is Lord Nityānanda — who can know His play?

All the avatāras of Viṣṇu are parts of Kṛṣṇa and in truth nondifferent from Him; therefore calling Kṛṣṇa by the name of Viṣṇu is no fault —

এসব প্রমাণে জানি নিত্যানন্দতত্ত্বসীমা ।
তাঁহাকে 'অনন্ত' কহি, কি তাঁর মহিমা ॥ ১২৬ ॥

esaba pramāṇe jāni nityānanda-tattva-sīmā
by all these proofs I know of Nityānanda's truth the full extent
tāṁhāke 'ananta' kahi, ki tāṁra mahimā
Him Ananta I call what His glory

126 By all these proofs I know the full truth of Nityānanda. If I call Him Ananta, what glory is that to Him?

অথবা ভক্তের বাক্য মানি সত্য করি' ।
সকল সম্ভবে তাঁতে, যাতে অবতারী ॥ ১২৭ ॥

athavā bhaktera vākya māni satya kari'
or else of the devotees the words accept true considering
sakala sambhave tāṁte, yāte avatārī
all is possible in Him since the source of avatāras

127 Or else, accepting the words of the devotees as true, I say: everything is possible in Him, for He is the source of the avatāras.

অবতার-অবতারী — অভেদ, যে জানে ।
পূর্ব্বে যৈছে কৃষ্ণকে কেহো কাহো করি' মানে ॥ ১২৮ ॥

avatāra-avatārī — abheda, ye jāne
avatāra the source of avatāras non-different who knows
pūrve yaiche kṛṣṇake keho kāho kari' māne
before as Kṛṣṇa someone as someone considering accepted

128 One who knows that the avatāras and their source are non-different speaks in this way — just as in the past people saw in Kṛṣṇa this or that avatāra:

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
One who does not know how an avatāra differs from the source of the avatāras once equated Kṛṣṇa with Vāmana and the other avatāras. In the same way, a person who sees no difference calls Nityānanda "Ananta" and so on. But since devotees have said so, it is not false: in the highest Truth everything is possible.[15]

The source of the avatāras is called by the names of various avatāras —

কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ সাক্ষাৎ নরনারায়ণ ।
কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ হয় সাক্ষাৎ বামন ॥ ১২৯ ॥

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa sākṣāt nara-nārāyaṇa
someone says Kṛṣṇa directly Nara-Nārāyaṇa
keho kahe, kṛṣṇa haya sākṣāt vāmana
someone says Kṛṣṇa is directly Vāmana

129 some said that Kṛṣṇa was Nara-Nārāyaṇa Himself, others that He was Vāmana Himself,

কেহো কহে, কৃষ্ণ ক্ষীরোদশায়ী-অবতার ।
অসম্ভব নহে, সত্য বচন সবার ॥ ১৩০ ॥

keho kahe, kṛṣṇa kṣīroda-śāyī-avatāra
someone says Kṛṣṇa of Kṣīrodaśāyī an avatāra
asambhava nahe, satya vacana sabāra
impossible it is not true the words of all

130 and still others that He was an avatāra of Kṣīrodaśāyī. None of this is impossible: the words of all are true.

কৃষ্ণ যবে অবতরে সর্ব্বাংশ-আশ্রয় ।
সর্ব্বাংশ আসি' তবে কৃষ্ণেতে মিলয় ॥ ১৩১ ॥

kṛṣṇa yabe avatare sarvāṁśa-āśraya
Kṛṣṇa when descends of all portions the shelter
sarvāṁśa āsi' tabe kṛṣṇete milaya
all portions coming then in Kṛṣṇa unite

131 When Kṛṣṇa, the shelter of all portions, descends, all His portions come and unite in Him.

যেই যেই রূপে জানে, সেই তাহা কহে ।
সকল সম্ভবে কৃষ্ণে, কিছু মিথ্যা নহে ॥ ১৩২ ॥

yei yei rūpe jāne, sei tāhā kahe
in whatever whatever form knows he that says
sakala sambhave kṛṣṇe, kichu mithyā nahe
all is possible in Kṛṣṇa nothing false is

132 So each speaks of Him in the form in which he knows Him. Everything is possible in Kṛṣṇa; none of it is false.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, Śrī Rūpa Prabhu first refutes the opponent's views (*pūrvapakṣa*): "Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Kṣīraśāyī," "Kṛṣṇa is an avatāra of Vāsudeva, the first *vyūha* of Nārāyaṇa, the Lord of Paravyoma," "Kṛṣṇa is a *vilāsa* of Nārāyaṇa," and so on. Then (in sections 136, 137, and 139) he quotes *Bhāgavatam* 3.2.15 and says: "When His own peaceful forms — Vasudeva and the other devotees — were being oppressed by distorted forms, that is, by fearsome-looking demons led by Kaṁsa, then Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Lord of spirit and matter, supremely merciful and though unborn, joined and merged with His *vilāsas* — the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha and others — and descended from Kṛṣṇaloka into the material world, just as fire appears from the wooden *araṇi* when it is churned." The *vyūha* of Śrī Kṛṣṇa became one with His own *vilāsa*, the *vyūha* of the Lord of Paravyoma,

came into the material world, and appeared there. He always remains united with His famous avatāras: the Puruṣas and others, Śrī Rāma, Nṛsiṁha, Varāha, Vāmana, Nara-Nārāyaṇa, Hayagrīva, Ajita, and the rest. That is why in Vṛndāvana too the pastimes of all these avatāras are seen in Śrī Kṛṣṇa. And so the *Brahmāṇḍa Purāṇa* says: "He who is four-armed in Vaikuṇṭha, who is the Lord of Śvetadvīpa, who is Nārāyaṇa, the friend of Nara — He is Puruṣottama, the son of Nanda. As hundreds and thousands of sparks fly out of a great fire and vanish back into it, so all the other countless charming avatāras of this Kṛṣṇa become one with Him again." Therefore, in the Purāṇas and other scriptures, some have glorified Śrī Kṛṣṇa as Nārāyaṇa, the friend of Nara, some as Upendra, that is, Vāmana, some as Kṣīrodaśāyī, some as the thousand-headed Garbhodaśāyī, and some as the Lord of Vaikuṇṭha. For the original Saṅkarṣaṇa abides in Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and from Him Badarīnātha and other forms are manifested (that is, they appear by His mere wish). The sages saw only the pastimes of one or another of these forms. They followed the accounts of Viṣṇu with those different pastimes, and so they called Śrī Kṛṣṇa by the names of those forms of Viṣṇu. Therefore, even if the original source of the avatāras is called an "avatāra," in truth there is no fault in it. See Ādi 2.110–115.

Through Nityānanda, Gaurasundara manifests all the avatāras —

অতএব শ্রীকৃষ্ণচৈতন্য গোসাঞি ।
সর্ব্ব-অবতার-লীলা করি' সবারে দেখাই ॥ ১৩৩ ॥

ataeva śrī-kṛṣṇa-caitanya gosāñi
therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi
sarva-avatāra-līlā kari' sabāre dekhāi
of all avatāras the pastimes performing to all showed

133 Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gosāñi performed the pastimes of all the avatāras and showed them to everyone.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Therefore Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the highest Truth, showed everyone the pastimes of Varāha, Nṛsiṁha, and the other avatāras.

এইরূপে নিত্যানন্দ ‘অনন্ত’ প্রকাশ ।
সেইভাবে — কহে মুঞি চৈতন্যের দাস ॥ ১৩৪ ॥

ei-rūpe nityānanda ‘ananta’ prakāśa
in this way Nityānanda’s Ananta manifestation
sei-bhāve — kahe muñi caitanyera dāsa
in that mood says I of Caitanya servant

134 In this way Nityānanda is manifest as Ananta, and in that same mood He says, “I am Caitanya’s servant.”

Nityānanda-Rāma serves Gaura-Kṛṣṇa in different forms and different moods
—

কভু গুরু, কভু সখা, কভু ভৃত্য-লীলা ।
পূর্ব্বে যেন তিনভাবে ব্রজে কৈল খেলা ॥ ১৩৫ ॥

kabhu guru, kabhu sakhā, kabhu bhṛtya-līlā
sometimes guru sometimes friend sometimes servant’s pastime
pūrve yena tina-bhāve vraje kaila khelā
before as in three moods in Vraja made play

135 Sometimes He plays the guru, sometimes the friend, sometimes the servant — just as He once played in Vraja in these three moods.

বৃষ হঞা কৃষ্ণসনে মাথামাথি রণ ।
কভু কৃষ্ণ করে তাঁর পাদ সম্বাহন ॥ ১৩৬ ॥

vṛṣa hañā kṛṣṇa-sane māthā-māthi raṇa
a bull becoming with Kṛṣṇa head to head fight
kabhu kṛṣṇa kare tāṁra pāda samvāhana
sometimes Kṛṣṇa makes His feet massaging

136 Becoming a bull, He would fight with Kṛṣṇa head to head; and sometimes Kṛṣṇa would massage His feet.

Nityānanda-Rāma always considers Himself the servant of Gaura-Kṛṣṇa —

আপনাকে ভৃত্য করি’ কৃষ্ণে প্রভু জানে ।
কৃষ্ণের কলার কলা আপনাকে মানে ॥ ১৩৭ ॥

āpanāke bhṛtya kari’ kṛṣṇe prabhu jāne
Himself a servant considering Kṛṣṇa as Master knows
kṛṣṇera kalāra kalā āpanāke māne
of Kṛṣṇa’s kalā a kalā Himself He considers

137 He thinks of Himself as a servant and knows Kṛṣṇa as His Master; He considers Himself but a kalā of Kṛṣṇa’s kalā.

The play of Rāma and Kṛṣṇa —

বৃষায়মাণৌ নর্দ্দন্তৌ যুযুধাতে পরস্পরম্ ।
অনুকৃত্য রুতৈর্জন্তূংশ্চেরতুঃ প্রাকৃতৌ যথা ॥ ১৩৮ ॥

vṛṣāyamāṇau nardantau
behaving as bulls bellowing
yuyudhāte parasparam
they fought with each other
anukṛtya rutair jantūṁś
imitating with cries animals
ceratuḥ prākṛtau yathā
they roamed ordinary (children) like

138 “Pretending to be bulls, the two would bellow and fight with each other; imitating the cries of animals, They roamed about like ordinary children.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.11.40)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sometimes, like ordinary people, the two brothers become bulls and butt each other, bellowing. And sometimes they imitate swans, peacocks, and other creatures and make their sounds.

Anubhāṣya.
These two verses are spoken where the childhood play of Kṛṣṇa and Rāma is described.

vṛṣāyamāṇau (acting like bulls) **nardantau** (making their sounds, bellowing) **kṛṣṇa-baladevau** (Kṛṣṇa and Baladeva) **parasparam yuyudhāte** (butted each other). **rutaiḥ** (with imitative sounds) **jantūn anukṛtya** (imitating the animals), **prākṛtau** (ordinary) **bālakau yathā** (like boys), **tathā ceratuḥ** (so They played).

Kṛṣṇa serves Rāma, massaging His feet and so on —

ক্বচিৎ ক্রীড়া-পরিশ্রান্তং গোপোৎসঙ্গোপবর্হণম্ ।
স্বয়ং বিশ্রাময়ত্যার্য্যং পাদসম্বাহনাদিভিঃ ॥ ১৩৯ ॥

kvacit krīḍā-pariśrāntaṁ
sometimes by play wearied
gopotsaṅgopabarhaṇam
of a cowherd boy the lap as His pillow
svayaṁ viśrāmayaty āryaṁ
Himself gives rest to the elder
pāda-saṁvāhanādibhiḥ
of the feet by massaging and so on

139 "Sometimes, when His elder brother lay tired from play with His head on a cowherd boy's lap, Kṛṣṇa Himself would give Him rest by massaging His feet and serving Him in other ways." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.15.14)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Sometimes, tired from play, Kṛṣṇa Himself lies down with His head on the lap of the cowherd boys, and He has Baladeva lie down and massages His feet.

Anubhāṣya.
kvacit (sometimes) **krīḍā-pariśrāntam** (tired from play) **gopotsaṅgopabarhaṇam** (Him whose pillow was the lap of a cowherd boy) **āryam** (the elder brother, Baladeva) **pāda-saṁvāhanādibhiḥ** (by massaging His feet and other service) **svayam** (Kṛṣṇa Himself) **viśrāmayati** (relieved of fatigue).

Baladeva's amazement at seeing Kṛṣṇa's yogamāyā —

কেয়ং বা কুত আয়াতা দৈবী বা নার্য্যুতাসুরী ।
প্রায়ো মায়াস্তু মে ভর্ত্তুর্নান্যা মেঽপি বিমোহিনী ॥ ১৪০ ॥

keyaṁ vā kuta āyātā
who is she or from where has come
daivī vā nāry utāsurī
divine or human or demonic
prāyo māyāstu me bhartur
most likely māyā it must be of My Master
nānyā me 'pi vimohinī
no other Me even bewilders

140 (Baladeva said in wonder:) "Who is she, and where has she come from? Is she divine, human or demonic? Most likely she is the māyā of My Master, for no other can bewilder even Me." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.13.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
"Who is this māyā? Where has she come from? Is she divine, human, or demoniac? No māyā can bewilder me except the māyā of my Lord Kṛṣṇa."

Anubhāṣya.
When Brahmā stole the calves, Śrī Kṛṣṇa created the calves and the rest anew and went on with His pastimes as usual. One day Śrī Baladeva saw how the cows were behaving, understood what had happened, and was amazed:

iyam (this [māyā]) **kā** (who)? **kutaḥ vā āyātā** (where has she come from)? **kim daivī** (is she related to the gods), **nārī** (to humans), **vā** (or — *uta*) **āsurī** (to the demons)? **prāyaḥ** (most likely) **māyā me bhartuḥ** (it is the māyā of my Master, Bhagavān Himself) **astu** (it must be); **anyā** (another [māyā]) **na** (it cannot be), ([for]) **iyam me api** (even me) **vimohinī** (she bewilders).

The six opulences eternally abide in Kṛṣṇa's lotus feet —

যস্যাঙ্ঘ্রিপঙ্কজরজোঽখিললোক-পালৈ-
র্মৌল্যুত্তমৈর্ধৃতমুপাসিত-তীর্থতীর্থম্ ।
ব্রহ্মা ভবোঽহমপি যস্য কলাঃ কলায়াঃ
শ্রীশ্চোদ্বহেম চিরমস্য নৃপাসনং ক্ব ॥ ১৪১ ॥

yasyāṅghri-paṅkaja-rajo 'khila-loka-pālair
whose feet lotus the dust of all the worlds by the guardians
mauly-uttamair dhṛtam upāsita-tīrtha-tīrtham
on heads best borne the worshipped of holy places the holy place
brahmā bhavo 'ham api yasya kalāḥ kalāyāḥ
Brahmā Śiva I also whose parts of a part
śrīś codvahema ciram asya nṛpāsanaṁ kva
Śrī and we bear ever His royal throne what

141 (Baladeva said:) "The guardians of all the worlds bear on their crowned heads the dust of His lotus feet, the holiest of holy places; and Brahmā, Śiva, Lakṣmī and I Myself, mere parts of His part, carry it on our heads forever. What then is a king's throne to Him?" (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.68.37)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

The dust of His feet is the holy place of all holy places. The guardians of the worlds carry it on their heads. Brahmā, Śiva, I, Baladeva, and Lakṣmī — some of us are His parts, others parts of parts — forever carry the dust of His feet. What does an ordinary royal throne mean to Him?

Anubhāṣya.

The Kauravas spoke ill of Śrī Kṛṣṇa and tried to win Baladeva over to their side. Then Baladeva grew angry and said to them:

yasya (Kṛṣṇa's) **aṅghri-paṅkaja-rajaḥ** (the dust of the lotus feet) **akhila-loka-pālaiḥ** (by the rulers of all the worlds) **mauly-uttamaiḥ** (on their heads adorned with crowns) **dhṛtam** (borne, held in the mind by concentration), **upāsita-tīrtha-tīrtham** (the holy place even for the yogīs who honour holy places); **yasya kalāyāḥ kalāḥ** (parts [*vikalās*] of whose part) — **brahmā**, **bhavaḥ** (Śiva), **aham** (I, Baladeva), **śrīḥ ca** (and Lakṣmī) — **api ciram** (forever) **udvahema** (we pray to carry it on our heads), — **asya** (for Him, Bhagavān Kṛṣṇa) **nṛpāsanam** (a royal throne) **kva** (where; what does it mean)?

Kṛṣṇa alone, the original form (svayaṁ-rūpa), is the Lord of all —

একলা ঈশ্বর কৃষ্ণ, আর সব ভৃত্য ।
যারে যৈছে নাচায়, সে তৈছে করে নৃত্য ॥ ১৪২ ॥

ekalā īśvara kṛṣṇa, āra saba bhṛtya
alone the Lord Kṛṣṇa the rest all servants
yāre yaiche nācāya, se taiche kare nṛtya
whom as He makes dance he so makes dance

142 Kṛṣṇa alone is the Lord; all others are His servants. As He makes each one dance, so each one dances.

Gaurasundara is the Supreme Lord, and His associates are His servants —

এই মত চৈতন্যগোসাঞি একলা ঈশ্বর ।
আর সব পারিষদ, কেহ বা কিঙ্কর ॥ ১৪৩ ॥

ei mata caitanyagosāñi ekalā īśvara
in this way Caitanya Gosāñi alone the Lord
āra saba pāriṣada, keha vā kiṅkara
the rest all associates some or servants

143 In the same way Caitanya Gosāñi alone is the Lord; all the rest are His associates or His servants.

গুরুবর্গ, — নিত্যানন্দ, অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য ।
শ্রীবাসাদি, আর যত — লঘু, সম, আর্য্য ॥ ১৪৪ ॥

সবে পারিষদ, সবে লীলার সহায় ।
সবা লঞা নিজ-কার্য্য সাধে গৌর-রায় ॥ ১৪৫ ॥

guru-varga, — nityānanda, advaita ācārya
the elders Nityānanda Advaita Ācārya
śrīvāsādi, āra yata — laghu, sama, ārya
Śrīvāsa and others and all junior equal senior
sabe pāriṣada, sabe līlāra sahāya
all associates all of the pastimes helpers
sabā lañā nija-kārya sādhe gaura-rāya
all taking His own work accomplishes Gaura-rāya

144–145 Nityānanda, Advaita Ācārya, Śrīvāsa and others play the part of His elders and gurus, and all the rest are His juniors, equals and seniors. All

are His associates and helpers in His pastimes, and with them all Gaura-rāya accomplishes His purpose.

Gaura's two limbs (aṅgas): Nitāi and Advaita —

অদ্বৈত আচার্য্য, নিত্যানন্দ, — দুই অঙ্গ ।
দুইজন লঞা প্রভুর যত কিছু রঙ্গ ॥ ১৪৬ ॥

advaita ācārya, nityānanda, — dui aṅga
Advaita Ācārya Nityānanda two limbs
dui-jana lañā prabhura yata kichu raṅga
the two taking of the Lord all whatever pastimes

146 Advaita Ācārya and Nityānanda are His two limbs (*aṅga*); with these two the Lord performs all His pastimes.

Anubhāṣya.
See Ādi 3.71.

Though Advaita Prabhu is an avatāra of Mahā-Viṣṇu, He considers Himself a servant of Gaura —

অদ্বৈত-আচার্য্য-গোসাঞি সাক্ষাৎ ঈশ্বর ।
প্রভু, গুরু করি' মানে, তিঁহো ত' কিঙ্কর ॥ ১৪৭ ॥

advaita-ācārya-gosāñi sākṣāt īśvara
Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi directly the Lord
prabhu, guru kari' māne, tiṁho ta' kiṅkara
the Lord as guru considering honours He indeed a servant

147 Advaita Ācārya Gosāñi is the Lord Himself. The Lord honours Him as a guru, yet He is His servant.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Mahāprabhu honoured Advaita Ācārya, regarding Him as one of His elders (*guru-varga*). Yet Śrī Advaita Prabhu considered Himself a servant of Śrī Caitanya. He was a contemporary and friend of Śrī Mahāprabhu's father. Śrī Īśvara Purī and Śrī Advaita Prabhu were disciples of Śrī Mādhavendra Purī. Mahāprabhu accepted

Śrī Īśvara Purī as His *dīkṣā-guru*, and so Advaita Prabhu was a godbrother of Mahāprabhu's guru and worthy of respect.

Proof of the Ācārya's mercy to the jīvas —

আচার্য্য-গোসাঞির তত্ত্ব না যায় কথন ।
কৃষ্ণ অবতারিয়া যেঁহো তারিল ভুবন ॥ ১৪৮ ॥

ācārya-gosāñira tattva nā yāya kathana
of the Ācārya Gosāñi the truth not can be told
kṛṣṇa avatāriyā yeṁho tārila bhuvana
Kṛṣṇa making descend who delivered the world

148 The truth of Ācārya Gosāñi cannot be told: it was He who brought Kṛṣṇa down and delivered the world.

Because Lakṣmaṇa, the younger brother, served the elder, Rāmacandra, in the avatāra of Kṛṣṇa Balarāma is the elder brother and Kṛṣṇa the younger —

নিত্যানন্দস্বরূপ পূর্ব্বে হইয়া লক্ষ্মণ ।
লঘুভ্রাতা হৈয়া করে রামের সেবন ॥ ১৪৯ ॥

nityānanda-svarūpa pūrve haiyā lakṣmaṇa
Nityānanda-svarūpa before becoming Lakṣmaṇa
laghu-bhrātā haiyā kare rāmera sevana
younger brother becoming makes Rāma's service

149 Nityānanda Svarūpa, appearing before as Lakṣmaṇa, served Rāma as His younger brother.

Anubhāṣya.

Among the *daṇḍī-sannyāsīs* of the ten names, a *brahmacārī* bears one of four titles: "Svarūpa," "Ānanda," "Prakāśa," and "Caitanya." While travelling to the holy places, Nityānanda Prabhu stayed with a sannyāsī whose title was "Tīrtha" or "Āśrama." Therefore His *brahmacārī* name became "Nityānanda-svarūpa."

রামের চরিত্র সব, — দুঃখের কারণ ।
স্বতন্ত্র লীলায় দুঃখ সহেন লক্ষ্মণ ॥ ১৫০ ॥

rāmera caritra saba, — duḥkhera kāraṇa
of Rāma the deeds all of suffering the cause
svatantra līlāya duḥkha sahena lakṣmaṇa
independent in pastime suffering endures Lakṣmaṇa

150 Everything Rāma did brought Him suffering, and Lakṣmaṇa, of His own free will, bore that suffering with Him.

নিষেধ করিতে নারে, যাতে ছোট ভাই ।
মৌন ধরি' রহে লক্ষ্মণ মনে দুঃখ পাই' ॥ ১৫১ ॥

niṣedha karite nāre, yāte choṭa bhāi
objection to make cannot since younger brother
mauna dhari' rahe lakṣmaṇa mane duḥkha pāi'
silence keeping remains Lakṣmaṇa in the mind sorrow feeling

151 Being the younger brother, He could not object; so Lakṣmaṇa kept silent and grieved within.

কৃষ্ণ-অবতারে জ্যেষ্ঠ হৈলা সেবার কারণ ।
কৃষ্ণকে করাইল নানা সুখ আস্বাদন ॥ ১৫২ ॥

kṛṣṇa-avatāre jyeṣṭha hailā sevāra kāraṇa
in Kṛṣṇa's descent the elder He became of service for the sake
kṛṣṇake karāila nānā sukha āsvādana
to Kṛṣṇa He gave many joys to taste

152 In Kṛṣṇa's descent He became the elder brother for the sake of service, and He gave Kṛṣṇa many joys to taste.

রাম-লক্ষ্মণ — কৃষ্ণ-রামের অংশবিশেষ ।
অবতার-কালে দোঁহে দোঁহাতে প্রবেশ ॥ ১৫৩ ॥

rāma-lakṣmaṇa — kṛṣṇa-rāmera aṁśa-viśeṣa
Rāma Lakṣmaṇa of Kṛṣṇa and Rāma particular portions
avatāra-kāle doṁhe doṁhāte praveśa
of descent at the time the two into the two entering

153 Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa are particular portions of Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma, and when Kṛṣṇa and Balarāma descend, Rāma and Lakṣmaṇa enter into Them.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where the truth of Śrī Rāghavendra is described, section 20 says (in substance): "The *Viṣṇu-dharmottara* glorifies Rāma, Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata, and Śatrughna as avatāras of Vāsudeva, Saṅkarṣaṇa, Pradyumna, and Aniruddha respectively. And the *Padma Purāṇa* glorifies Rāmacandra as Nārāyaṇa, and Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata, and Śatrughna respectively as Śeṣa, the Cakra, and the Śaṅkha (conch)."

সেই অংশ লঞা জ্যেষ্ঠ-কনিষ্ঠাভিমান ।
অংশাংশী রূপে শাস্ত্রে করয়ে ব্যাখ্যান ॥ ১৫৪ ॥

sei aṁśa lañā jyeṣṭha-kaniṣṭhābhimāna
those portions taking of elder and younger the sense
aṁśāṁśī rūpe śāstre karaye vyākhyāna
part and whole in the form in the scriptures is made explanation

154 Together with those portions They take the roles of elder and younger brother, and the scriptures describe Them as the whole and His portion.

Anubhāṣya.
In the *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where the *līlā-avatāras* are described, section 79 says (in translation): "The *Rāma-gītā* of the *Skanda Purāṇa* says that Lakṣmaṇa, Bharata, and Śatrughna are the three *vyūhas* of Śrī Rāma."

Kṛṣṇa alone is the original form (svayaṁ-rūpa); all the other avatāras are His

parts (aṁśas) or kalās —

রামাদিমূর্ত্তিষু কলানিয়মেন তিষ্ঠন্
নানাবতারমকরোদ্ভুবনেষু কিন্তু ।
কৃষ্ণঃ স্বয়ং সমভবৎ পরমঃ পুমান্ যো
গোবিন্দমাদিপুরুষং তমহং ভজামি ॥ ১৫৫ ॥

rāmādi-mūrtiṣu kalā-niyamena tiṣṭhan
in Rāma and others forms by kalās in order abiding
nānāvatāram akarod bhuvaneṣu kintu
many avatāras made in the worlds but
kṛṣṇaḥ svayaṁ samabhavat paramaḥ pumān yo
as Kṛṣṇa Himself appeared the Supreme Person who
govindam ādi-puruṣaṁ tam ahaṁ bhajāmi
Govinda the original Person Him I worship

155 "I worship Govinda, the original Person, who, abiding through His kalās in Rāma and other forms, manifested many avatāras in the worlds, but who Himself, the Supreme Person, appeared as Kṛṣṇa." (Brahma-saṁhitā, 5.39)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Dividing Himself into parts (*kalās*), Bhagavān manifested various avatāras in the world in the forms of Rāma and others. But I worship Govinda, the original Person: this Supreme Person Himself appears in the form of Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.
yaḥ (He who), **paramaḥ pumān** (the Supreme Person) **kṛṣṇaḥ** (Kṛṣṇa), **kalā-niyamena** (as parts, parts of parts, and so on) **rāmādi-mūrtiṣu tiṣṭhan** (abiding in the forms of Rāma and others — manifesting the forms of the various *naimittika* avatāras, who descend for a particular occasion) **nānāvatāram akarot** (manifested many avatāras), **kintu svayam samabhavat** (but appeared Himself [as Kṛṣṇa]) — **tam govindam ādi-puruṣam** (that Govinda, the original Person) **ahaṁ bhajāmi** (I worship).

Gaura's desire — to spread the holy name and prema — is fulfilled through

Nityānanda alone —

শ্রীচৈতন্য — সেই কৃষ্ণ, নিত্যানন্দ — রাম ।
নিত্যানন্দ পূর্ণ করে চৈতন্যের কাম ॥ ১৫৬ ॥

śrī-caitanya — sei kṛṣṇa, nityānanda — rāma
Śrī Caitanya that Kṛṣṇa Nityānanda Rāma
nityānanda pūrṇa kare caitanyera kāma
Nityānanda fulfilment makes of Caitanya's desire

156 Śrī Caitanya is that Kṛṣṇa, and Nityānanda is Rāma. Nityānanda fulfils all of Caitanya's desires.

Nityānanda's glory is boundless —

নিত্যানন্দ-মহিমা-সিন্ধু অনন্ত, অপার ।
এক কণা স্পর্শি মাত্র, — সে কৃপা তাঁহার ॥ ১৫৭ ॥

nityānanda-mahimā-sindhu ananta, apāra
of Nityānanda's glory the ocean endless shoreless
eka kaṇā sparśi mātra, — se kṛpā tāṁhāra
one drop I touch only that mercy His

157 The ocean of Nityānanda's glory is endless and shoreless. I touch but a single drop of it — and that only by His mercy.

From his own experience, the author describes the greatness of Nityānanda's mercy —

আর এক শুন তাঁর কৃপার মহিমা ।
অধম জীবেরে চড়াইল ঊর্দ্ধ সীমা ॥ ১৫৮ ॥

āra eka śuna tāṁra kṛpāra mahimā
one more hear His of mercy the greatness
adhama jīvere caḍāila ūrddhva sīmā
a fallen soul He raised to the highest limit

158 Hear one more glory of His mercy: He raised a fallen soul to the very highest.[9]

বেদগুহ্য কথা এই অয়োগ্য কহিতে ।
তথাপি কহিয়ে তাঁর কৃপা প্রকাশিতে ॥ ১৫৯ ॥

veda-guhya kathā ei ayogya kahite
like the Vedas secret story this unfit to tell
tathāpi kahiye tāṁra kṛpā prakāśite
still I tell His mercy to reveal

159 This story is as secret as the Vedas and not fit to be told; still I tell it to reveal His mercy.

উল্লাস-উপরি লেখোঁ তোমার প্রসাদ ।
নিত্যানন্দ প্রভু, মোর ক্ষম অপরাধ ॥ ১৬০ ॥

ullāsa-upari lekhoṁ tomāra prasāda
in overflowing joy I write of Your grace
nityānanda prabhu, mora kṣama aparādha
Nityānanda Prabhu my forgive offence

160 In overflowing joy I write of Your grace. O Nityānanda Prabhu, forgive my offence!

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ullāsa-upari means: "I rejoice so much that I cannot keep it hidden, and so I am writing the account of Your favour."

The greatness of a servant: Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa —

অবধূত গোসাঞির এক ভৃত্য প্রেমধাম ।
মীনকেতন রামদাস হয় তাঁর নাম ॥ ১৬১ ॥

avadhūta gosāñira eka bhṛtya prema-dhāma
of the Avadhūta Gosāñi one servant abode of love
mīnaketana rāmadāsa haya tāṁra nāma
Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa is his name

161 Avadhūta Gosāñi had a servant who was an abode of love; his name was Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Avadhūta Gosāñi is Nityānanda Prabhu. *Prema-dhāma* means the abode of prema.

Anubhāṣya.

In his commentary on *Bhāgavatam* 3.1.19, Śrīdhara Svāmipāda explains the word *avadhūta* as *asaṁskṛta-deha*, one who does not care for his body. The disciple of the *avadhūta* Śrī Nityānanda was also a *mahā-bhāgavata*, a *paramahaṁsa*, eternally perfect and beyond *varṇāśrama*. Therefore his body bore no marks of *varṇāśrama*, and, careless of his body, he remained intoxicated with the moods of Vraja.

Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa: see the *Anubhāṣya* on Ādi 11.53.

আমার আলয়ে অহোরাত্র-সঙ্কীর্ত্তন ।
তাহাতে আইলা তিঁহো পাঞা নিমন্ত্রণ ॥ ১৬২ ॥

āmāra ālaye aho-rātra-saṅkīrtana
in my house day and night saṅkīrtana
tāhāte āilā tiṁho pāñā nimantraṇa
there came he receiving an invitation

162 In my house there was saṅkīrtana day and night, and he came there by invitation.

Anubhāṣya.

Ahorātra means eight *praharas*, that is, the whole day and night. In those days pure devotees had the custom of sending one another letters of invitation to kīrtana festivals.

The state of a mahā-bhāgavata, or paramahaṁsa —

মহাপ্রেমময় তিঁহো বসিলা অঙ্গনে ।
সকল বৈষ্ণব তাঁর বন্দিলা চরণে ॥ ১৬৩ ॥

mahā-prema-maya tiṁho vasilā aṅgane
with great love filled he sat in the courtyard
sakala vaiṣṇava tāṁra vandilā caraṇe
all Vaiṣṇavas his bowed down at the feet

163 Full of great love, he sat down in the courtyard, and all the Vaiṣṇavas bowed at his feet.

নমস্কার করিতে, কা'র উপরেতে চড়ে ।
প্রেমে কা'রে বংশী মারে, কাহাকে চাপড়ে ॥ ১৬৪ ॥

namaskāra karite, kā'ra uparete caḍe
as they bowed on whom upon he climbs
preme kā're vaṁśī māre, kāhāke cāpaḍe
in love whom with the flute he strikes whom he slaps

164 As they bowed, he would climb on the back of one, and in his love strike another with his flute or slap yet another.

যে নয়ন দেখিতে অশ্রু হয় মনে যার ।
সেই নেত্রে অবিচ্ছিন্ন বহে অশ্রুধার ॥ ১৬৫ ॥

ye nayana dekhite aśru haya mane yāra
which eyes on seeing tears come in the mind of whom
sei netre avicchinna vahe aśru-dhāra
from those eyes unbroken flows of tears a stream

165 From those eyes, the very sight of which brings tears to one's heart, flowed an unbroken stream of tears.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Whenever anyone looked into the eyes of Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa, tears welled up from the depths of his heart into his own eyes. And from the eyes of Rāmadāsa himself streams of tears flowed without pause. By another reading, *ye nayane dekhite*, the sense is this: in whatever eyes a person wished to see tears, from those eyes the tears flowed.

কভু কোন অঙ্গে দেখি পুলক-কদম্ব ।
এক অঙ্গে জাড্য তাঁর, আর অঙ্গে কম্প ॥ ১৬৬ ॥

kabhu kona aṅge dekhi pulaka-kadamba
sometimes on some limb I see hairs on end like kadamba
eka aṅge jāḍya tāṁra, āra aṅge kampa
on one limb stiffness his on another limb trembling

166 At times I saw the hair on some limb stand on end like kadamba blossoms; one limb would stiffen while another trembled.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kadamba means a multitude. *Jāḍya* means stupor (*stambha*).[16]

নিত্যানন্দ বলি' যবে করেন হুঙ্কার ।
তাহা দেখি' লোকের হয় মহা-চমৎকার ॥ ১৬৭ ॥

nityānanda bali' yabe karena huṅkāra
Nityānanda saying when makes a loud cry
tāhā dekhi' lokera haya mahā-camatkāra
that seeing of the people is great wonder

167 When he roared out "Nityānanda!", all who saw it were filled with wonder.

A worldly devotee of the lowest level (kaniṣṭha), lacking faith, offends the feet of a Vaiṣṇava —

গুণার্ণব মিশ্র নামে এক বিপ্র আর্য্য ।
শ্রীমূর্ত্তি-নিকটে তেঁহো করে সেবা-কার্য্য ॥ ১৬৮ ॥

guṇārṇava miśra nāme eka vipra ārya
Guṇārṇava Miśra by name a brāhmaṇa respectable
śrī-mūrti-nikaṭe teṁho kare sevā-kārya
the Deity near he does of service the work

168 A respectable brāhmaṇa named Guṇārṇava Miśra was serving the Deity there.

অঙ্গনে বসিয়া তেঁহো না কৈল সম্ভাষ ।
তাহা দেখি' ক্রুদ্ধ হঞা বলে রামদাস ॥ ১৬৯ ॥

aṅgane vasiyā teṁho nā kaila sambhāṣa
in the courtyard sitting (to him) he not made greeting
tāhā dekhi' kruddha hañā bale rāmadāsa
that seeing angry becoming says Rāmadāsa

169 Rāmadāsa sat in the courtyard, but the brāhmaṇa did not greet him; seeing this, Mīnaketana said angrily:[10]

এই ত' দ্বিতীয় সূত রোমহরষণ ।
বলদেব দেখি' যে না কৈল প্রত্যুদ্গম ॥ ১৭০ ॥

ei ta' dvitīya sūta romaharaṣaṇa
this indeed a second Sūta Romaharṣaṇa
baladeva dekhi' ye nā kaila pratyudgama
Baladeva seeing who not made rising to greet

170 "Here is a second Romaharṣaṇa Sūta, who did not rise to greet Baladeva when he saw Him!"

Anubhāṣya.

Bhāgavatam 10.78.22–28 tells how, in Naimiṣāraṇya, Baladeva killed Romaharṣaṇa, the disciple of Vyāsa.

Even when insulted, a Vaiṣṇava does not look for faults in others —

এত বলি' নাচে গায়, করয়ে সন্তোষ ।
কৃষ্ণকার্য্য করে বিপ্র — না করিল রোষ ॥ ১৭১ ॥

eta bali' nāce gāya, karaye santoṣa
so saying he dances sings makes rejoicing
kṛṣṇa-kārya kare vipra — nā karila roṣa
Kṛṣṇa's work does the brāhmaṇa not showed anger

171 Having said this, he danced and sang and rejoiced; but the brāhmaṇa went on with his service to Kṛṣṇa and showed no anger.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Guṇārṇava Miśra, the servant of the Deity, sat in the courtyard and did not greet the servant of Śrī Nityānanda. So Mīnaketana Rāmadāsa grew angry and said, "This Guṇārṇava Miśra is a second Romaharṣaṇa Sūta." The meaning is this. In Naimiṣāraṇya, Romaharṣaṇa Sūta saw Baladeva but did not leave the seat of Vyāsa and did not greet Him. Guṇārṇava Miśra behaved just as improperly. In Guṇārṇava Miśra's heart there was no special faith in Śrī Nityānanda. Śrī Mīnaketana understood this and lost respect for him. The devotees do not fault Śrī Mīnaketana for this act or call him proud.

উৎসবান্তে গেলা তিঁহো করিয়া প্রসাদ ।
মোর ভ্রাতা-সনে তাঁর কিছু হৈল বাদ ॥ ১৭২ ॥

utsavānte gelā tiṁho kariyā prasāda
at the festival's end went he having given blessings
mora bhrātā-sane tāṁra kichu haila vāda
my brother with his some arose dispute

172 At the end of the festival he was leaving, having given his blessings, when a dispute arose between him and my brother.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī's brother is devoted to Gaura but does not honour Nityānanda and the Vaiṣṇavas —

চৈতন্য-প্রভুতে তাঁর সুদৃঢ় বিশ্বাস ।
নিত্যানন্দ-প্রতি তাঁর বিশ্বাস-আভাস ॥ ১৭৩ ॥

caitanya-prabhute tāṁra sudṛḍha viśvāsa
in Caitanya Prabhu his firm faith
nityānanda-prati tāṁra viśvāsa-ābhāsa
towards Nityānanda his of faith a semblance

173 My brother had firm faith in Caitanya Prabhu, but towards Nityānanda only a semblance of faith.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Seeing this behaviour, my brother got into an argument with Mīnaketana. My brother had firm faith in Śrī Caitanya Prabhu, but he did not have the same faith in

Nityānanda Prabhu.

Anubhāṣya.
Viśvāsa-ābhāsa means very slight faith.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī rebukes his brother —

ইহা জানি' রামদাসের দুঃখ হৈল মনে ।
তবে ত' ভ্রাতারে আমি করিনু ভর্ৎসনে ॥ ১৭৪ ॥

ihā jāni' rāmadāsera duḥkha haila mane
this knowing Rāmadāsa's sorrow was in the mind
tabe ta' bhrātāre āmi karinu bhartsane
then indeed the brother I made rebuke

174 Knowing this, Rāmadāsa was grieved at heart, and so I rebuked my brother:

Disrespect that comes from taking the undivided Truth as divided is nothing but godlessness —

দুই ভাই একতনু — সমান-প্রকাশ ।
নিত্যানন্দ না মান', তোমার হবে সর্ব্বনাশ ॥ ১৭৫ ॥

dui bhāi eka-tanu — samāna-prakāśa
two brothers one body equal manifestation
nityānanda nā māna', tomāra habe sarva-nāśa
Nityānanda not you accept your will be total ruin

175 "The two brothers are one body, equally manifest. If you do not accept Nityānanda, you will be utterly ruined.

একেতে বিশ্বাস, অন্যে না কর সম্মান ।
'অর্ধকুক্কুটী-ন্যায়' তোমার প্রমাণ ॥ ১৭৬ ॥

ekete viśvāsa, anye nā kara sammāna
in one faith to the other not you give respect
'ardha-kukkuṭī-nyāya' tomāra pramāṇa
of half a hen the logic your standard

176 You have faith in one but show the other no respect: your standard is the logic of half a hen.

Faith in Nitāi without Gaura, or in Gaura without Nitāi, is also nothing but opposition to bhakti —

কিংবা, দোঁহা না মানিঞা হও ত' পাষণ্ড ।
একে মানি' আরে না মানি, — এইমত ভণ্ড ॥ ১৭৭ ॥

kiṁvā, doṁhā nā māniñā hao ta' pāṣaṇḍa
or else both not accepting be then an atheist
eke māni' āre nā māni, — ei-mata bhaṇḍa
one accepting the other not accepting this kind of hypocrite

177 If you accept neither, you are an atheist; and to accept one and not the other is hypocrisy."

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Ardha-kukkuṭī-nyāya, "the logic of half a hen," is the same as *ardha-jaratīya-nyāya*: as if half of a hen were old and half young. As an argument this is utterly unacceptable. In the same way, holding to the logic of half a hen, you accept one of Caitanya and Nityānanda, the one undivided Lord, and reject the other. This is your godlessness and hypocrisy.

For insulting a devotee, the brother devoted to Gaura is ruined and falls —

ক্রুদ্ধ হৈয়া বংশী ভাঙ্গি' চলে রামদাস ।
তৎকালে আমার ভ্রাতার হৈল সর্ব্বনাশ ॥ ১৭৮ ॥

kruddha haiyā vaṁśī bhāṅgi' cale rāmadāsa
angry becoming the flute breaking goes away Rāmadāsa
tat-kāle āmāra bhrātāra haila sarva-nāśa
at that moment my brother's came about total ruin

178 In anger Rāmadāsa broke his flute and went away, and at that very moment my brother was ruined.

এই ত' কহিল তাঁর সেবক-প্রভাব ।
আর এক কহি তাঁর দয়ার স্বভাব ॥ ১৭৯ ॥

ei ta' kahila tāṁra sevaka-prabhāva
thus indeed I have told His servant's power
āra eka kahi tāṁra dayāra svabhāva
one more I tell His mercy's nature

179 Thus I have told of the power of His servant. Now I tell of something more — the nature of His mercy.

Proof of Nityānanda's mercy —

ভাইকে ভর্ৎসিনু মুঞি, লঞা এই গুণ ।
সেই রাত্রে প্রভু মোরে দিলা দরশন ॥ ১৮০ ॥

bhāike bhartsinu muñi, lañā ei guṇa
the brother I rebuked I taking this as a virtue
sei rātre prabhu more dilā daraśana
that night the Lord to me gave sight

180 Because I had rebuked my brother — and He counted this as a virtue — that night the Lord appeared to me.

The author sees Nityānanda in a dream —

নৈহাটি-নিকটে 'ঝামটপুর' নামে গ্রাম ।
তাঁহা স্বপ্নে দেখা দিলা নিত্যানন্দ-রাম ॥ ১৮১ ॥

naihāṭi-nikaṭe 'jhāmaṭapura' nāme grāma
Naihāṭi near Jhāmaṭapura named a village
tāṁhā svapne dekhā dilā nityānanda-rāma
there in a dream showed Himself Nityānanda-Rāma

181 In a village called Jhāmaṭapura, near Naihāṭi, Nityānanda-Rāma appeared to me in a dream.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī lived in the village of Jhāmaṭapura, near the village of Naihāṭī, two *krośas* north of Kāṭoyā. Now a Deity of Śrī Mahāprabhu is there.

Anubhāṣya.

To reach Jhāmaṭapura, one takes the small train on the Kāṭoyā line and gets off at Sālār station.

The author attains the lotus feet of Nityānanda Himself —

দণ্ডবৎ হৈয়া আমি পড়িনু পায়েতে ।
নিজপাদপদ্ম প্রভু দিলা মোর মাথে ॥ ১৮২ ॥

daṇḍavat haiyā āmi paḍinu pāyete
like a rod becoming I fell at the feet
nija-pāda-padma prabhu dilā mora māthe
His own lotus foot the Lord placed my on the head

182 I fell flat like a rod at His feet, and the Lord placed His lotus foot upon my head.

'উঠ', 'উঠ' বলি' মোরে বলে বার বার ।
উঠি' তাঁর রূপ দেখি' হৈনু চমৎকার ॥ ১৮৩ ॥

'uṭha', 'uṭha' bali' more bale bāra bāra
rise rise saying to me He says again again
uṭhi' tāṁra rūpa dekhi' hainu camatkāra
rising His form seeing I became astonished

183 Again and again He said to me, "Rise, rise!" I rose, and seeing His form I was struck with wonder.

Nityānanda's form, and the expert service rendered to Him by His associates

dressed as cowherd boys —

শ্যাম-চিক্কণ কান্তি, প্রকাণ্ড শরীর ।
সাক্ষাৎ কন্দর্প, যৈছে মহামল্ল-বীর ॥ ১৮৪ ॥

śyāma-cikkaṇa kānti, prakāṇḍa śarīra
dark glossy lustre huge body
sākṣāt kandarpa, yaiche mahā-malla-vīra
very Kandarpa like a great wrestler hero

184 His huge body had a glossy dark lustre. He was as beautiful as Kandarpa, the god of love, in person, and had the bearing of a great champion wrestler.

সুবলিত হস্ত, পদ, কমল-লোচন ।
পট্টবস্ত্র শিরে, পট্টবস্ত্র পরিধান ॥ ১৮৫ ॥

suvalita hasta, pada, kamala-locana
shapely hands feet lotus eyes
paṭṭa-vastra śire, paṭṭa-vastra paridhāna
silk cloth on the head silk cloth garment

185 His hands and feet were finely shaped, His eyes like lotuses; He wore silk on His head and silk as His garment.

সুবর্ণ-কুণ্ডল কর্ণে, স্বর্ণাঙ্গদ-বালা ।
পায়েতে নূপুর বাজে, কণ্ঠে পুষ্পমালা ॥ ১৮৬ ॥

suvarṇa-kuṇḍala karṇe, svarṇāṅgada-vālā
golden earrings in the ears golden armlets bracelets
pāyete nūpura bāje, kaṇṭhe puṣpa-mālā
on the feet ankle-bells ring on the neck a flower garland

186 Golden earrings hung in His ears, golden armlets and bracelets adorned His arms; ankle-bells rang on His feet, and a garland of flowers lay on His neck.

চন্দন লেপিত অঙ্গ, তিলক সুঠাম ।
মত্ত-গজ জিনি' মদ-মন্থর পয়ান ॥ ১৮৭ ॥

candana lepita aṅga, tilaka suṭhāma
with sandal anointed the body tilaka graceful
matta-gaja jini' mada-manthara payāna
a mad elephant surpassing with intoxication slow gait

187 His body was anointed with sandal and graced with a lovely tilaka; His slow, intoxicated gait surpassed that of a maddened elephant.

কোটিচন্দ্র-জিনি' মুখ উজ্জ্বল-বরণ ।
দাড়িম্ব-বীজ-সম দন্তে তাম্বূল-চর্ব্বণ ॥ ১৮৮ ॥

koṭi-candra-jini' mukha ujjvala-varaṇa
millions of moons surpassing face bright in colour
dāḍimba-bīja-sama dante tāmbūla-carvaṇa
of pomegranate seeds like in the teeth betel chewing

188 His bright face outshone millions of moons; as He chewed betel, His teeth looked like pomegranate seeds.[11]

প্রেমে মত্ত অঙ্গ ডাহিনে বামে দোলে ।
'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' বলিয়া গম্ভীর বোল বলে ॥ ১৮৯ ॥

preme matta aṅga ḍāhine vāme dole
with love intoxicated body to the right to the left sways
'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' baliyā gambhīra bola bale
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa saying deep words speaks

189 Intoxicated with love, His body swayed to right and left, and in a deep voice He called, "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!"

রাঙ্গা-যষ্টি-হস্তে দোলে যেন মত্ত সিংহ ।
চারি পাশে বেড়ি আছে চরণেতে ভৃঙ্গ ॥ ১৯০ ॥

rāṅgā-yaṣṭi-haste dole yena matta siṁha
red staff in the hand sways like a mad lion
cāri pāśe veḍi āche caraṇete bhṛṅga
four sides surrounding are at the feet bees

190 With a red staff in His hand He swayed like a maddened lion, and bees hovered all around His feet.

পারিষদগণে দেখি' সব গোপ-বেশে ।
'কৃষ্ণ' 'কৃষ্ণ' কহে সবে সপ্রেম আবেশে ॥ ১৯১ ॥

pāriṣada-gaṇe dekhi' saba gopa-veśe
the associates I see all in cowherd dress
'kṛṣṇa' 'kṛṣṇa' kahe sabe saprema āveśe
Kṛṣṇa Kṛṣṇa say all with love in rapture

191 I saw His associates, all dressed as cowherds, all calling "Kṛṣṇa! Kṛṣṇa!" in loving rapture.

শিঙ্গা বাঁশী বাজায় কেহ, কেহ নাচে গায় ।
সেবক যোগায় তাম্বূল, চামর ঢুলায় ॥ ১৯২ ॥

śiṅgā vāṁśī bājāya keha, keha nāce gāya
horns flutes plays someone someone dances sings
sevaka yogāya tāmbūla, cāmara ḍhulāya
a servant offers betel a cāmara waves

192 Some played horns and flutes, some danced and sang; one servant offered betel, another waved a cāmara.

On seeing Nityānanda, the author is immersed in bliss —

নিত্যানন্দ-স্বরূপের দেখিয়া বৈভব ।
কিবা রূপ, গুণ, লীলা — অলৌকিক সব ॥ ১৯৩ ॥

nityānanda-svarūpera dekhiyā vaibhava
of Nityānanda-svarūpa seeing the splendour
kibā rūpa, guṇa, līlā — alaukika saba
what form qualities pastimes unearthly all

193 I beheld the splendour of Nityānanda Svarūpa — what form, what qualities, what pastimes, all beyond this world!

আনন্দে বিহ্বল আমি, কিছু নাহি জানি ।
তবে হাসি' প্রভু মোরে কহিলেন বাণী ॥ ১৯৪ ॥

ānande vihvala āmi, kichu nāhi jāni
with bliss overwhelmed I anything not know
tabe hāsi' prabhu more kahilena vāṇī
then smiling the Lord to me spoke words

194 Overwhelmed with bliss, I knew nothing at all. Then, smiling, the Lord spoke to me:

Nityānanda orders the author to go to Vṛndāvana —

আরে আরে কৃষ্ণদাস, না করহ ভয় ।
বৃন্দাবনে যাহ, — তাঁহা সর্ব্ব লভ্য হয় ॥ ১৯৫ ॥

āre āre kṛṣṇadāsa, nā karaha bhaya
O O Kṛṣṇadāsa not make fear
vṛndāvane yāha, — tāṁhā sarva labhya haya
to Vṛndāvana go there all attainable is

195 "O Kṛṣṇadāsa, Kṛṣṇadāsa, do not be afraid! Go to Vṛndāvana: there everything can be attained."

Nitāi disappears —

এত বলি' প্রেরিলা মোরে হাতসান দিয়া ।
অন্তর্দ্ধান কৈল প্রভু নিজগণ লঞা ॥ ১৯৬ ॥

eta bali' prerilā more hātasāna diyā
so saying He sent me a touch of the hand giving
antardhāna kaila prabhu nija-gaṇa lañā
disappearance made the Lord His own associates taking

196 Saying this, He touched me with His hand and sent me forth; and the Lord disappeared with His associates.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Hātasāna means a touch of the hand.

মূর্চ্ছিত হইয়া মুঞি পড়িনু ভূমিতে ।
স্বপ্নভঙ্গ হৈল, দেখি, হঞাছে প্রভাতে ॥ ১৯৭ ॥

mūrcchita haiyā muñi paḍinu bhūmite
unconscious becoming I fell on the ground
svapna-bhaṅga haila, dekhi, hañāche prabhāte
of the dream breaking came I see it has become morning

197 I fell senseless to the ground; my dream broke, and I saw that morning had come.

কি দেখিনু কি শুনিনু, করিয়ে বিচার ।
প্রভু-আজ্ঞা হৈল বৃন্দাবন যাইবার ॥ ১৯৮ ॥

ki dekhinu ki śuninu, kariye vicāra
what I saw what I heard I make reflection
prabhu-ājñā haila vṛndāvana yāibāra
the Lord's order was to Vṛndāvana to go

198 I reflected on what I had seen and heard: the Lord had ordered me to go to Vṛndāvana.

Kavirāja Gosvāmī goes to Vṛndāvana —

সেইক্ষণে বৃন্দাবনে করিনু গমন ।
প্রভুর কৃপাতে সুখে আইনু বৃন্দাবন ॥ ১৯৯ ॥

sei kṣaṇe vṛndāvane karinu gamana
at that moment to Vṛndāvana I made departure
prabhura kṛpāte sukhe āinu vṛndāvana
the Lord's by mercy happily I came to Vṛndāvana

199 At that very moment I set out, and by the Lord's mercy I reached Vṛndāvana in happiness.

A prayer to Śrī Nityānanda —

জয় জয় নিত্যানন্দ, নিত্যানন্দ-রাম ।
যাঁহার কৃপাতে পাইনু বৃন্দাবন-ধাম ॥ ২০০ ॥

jaya jaya nityānanda, nityānanda-rāma
glory glory Nityānanda Nityānanda-Rāma
yāṁhāra kṛpāte pāinu vṛndāvana-dhāma
whose by mercy I attained the abode of Vṛndāvana

200 Glory, glory to Nityānanda, to Nityānanda-Rāma, by whose mercy I attained the abode of Vṛndāvana!

জয় জয় নিত্যানন্দ, জয় কৃপাময় ।
যাঁহা হৈতে পাইনু রূপ-সনাতনাশ্রয় ॥ ২০১ ॥

jaya jaya nityānanda, jaya kṛpā-maya
glory glory Nityānanda glory full of mercy
yāṁhā haite pāinu rūpa-sanātanāśraya
from whom I attained Rūpa Sanātana the shelter

201 Glory, glory to Nityānanda! Glory to Him who is full of mercy, through whom I attained the shelter of Rūpa and Sanātana!

যাঁহা হৈতে পাইনু রঘুনাথ-মহাশয় ।
যাঁহা হৈতে পাইনু শ্রীস্বরূপ-আশ্রয় ॥ ২০২ ॥

yāṁhā haite pāinu raghunātha-mahāśaya
from whom I attained Raghunātha the great soul
yāṁhā haite pāinu śrī-svarūpa-āśraya
from whom I attained Śrī Svarūpa's shelter

202 Through Him I attained the great soul Raghunātha; through Him I attained the shelter of Śrī Svarūpa.

Anubhāṣya.
For one who longs to serve Śrī Rādhā-Govinda, the one desirable goal of life is to gain the shelter and grace of Śrī Svarūpa, Rūpa, Sanātana, and Raghunātha Gosvāmī Prabhus. These two *payāras* show that this can be gained only by the power of Nityānanda's mercy. On Śrī Dāmodara Svarūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu, see Ādi 4.160–161.

সনাতন-কৃপায় পাইনু ভক্তির সিদ্ধান্ত ।
শ্রীরূপ-কৃপায় পাইনু ভক্তিরসপ্রান্ত ॥ ২০৩ ॥

sanātana-kṛpāya pāinu bhaktira siddhānta
by Sanātana's mercy I attained of bhakti the conclusions
śrī-rūpa-kṛpāya pāinu bhakti-rasa-prānta
by Śrī Rūpa's mercy I attained of bhakti-rasa the nearness

203 By Sanātana's mercy I came to know the conclusions of bhakti; by Śrī Rūpa's mercy I came near to bhakti-rasa.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.
Bhakti-rasa-prānta means only nearness to *bhakti-rasa*.

Anubhāṣya.
Śrī Sanātana Gosvāmī Prabhu is the ācārya of the conclusions of bhakti (*bhakti-siddhānta-ācārya*). At the end of the fourth chapter of the Antya-līlā of this book, the author writes: "Sanātana wrote the book *Bhāgavatāmṛta*, from which we learn the truth about the devotee, devotion, and Kṛṣṇa. He wrote the *Daśama-ṭippanī*, a book that is the essence of conclusions, from which we learn Kṛṣṇa's pastimes, rasa, and prema. He wrote the book *Hari-bhakti-vilāsa* on Vaiṣṇava conduct, in which we find the full extent of a Vaiṣṇava's duties."[22] Śrī Raghunātha dāsa Gosvāmīpāda writes of Śrī Sanātana in his prayer *Vilāpa-kusumāñjali*: "I was blind

and had no wish to drink, yet with great effort he made me drink the nectar of devotion joined with renunciation. He is an ocean of mercy, and he suffers at the suffering of others. I take shelter of that master, Sanātana."[23] Śrī Kavirāja Gosvāmī (Antya 4.236) first names Śrī Rūpa, Śrī Sanātana, and Śrī Jīva, and then writes: "These three gurus and Raghunātha dāsa — I worship the feet of them all, for I am their servant." Śrī Raghunātha dāsa, too, calls Śrī Sanātana Prabhu the ācārya of the conclusions of bhakti.

Śrī Rūpa Gosvāmī Prabhu is the ācārya of *bhakti-rasa* (*bhakti-rasa-ācārya*). (Antya 4.224): "Rūpa Gosāñi wrote the *Rasāmṛta-sindhu*, the essence, in which we find the full expanse of the rasa of devotion to Kṛṣṇa; and another book named *Ujjvala-nīlamaṇi*, in which we find the full extent of the rasa of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa's pastimes."[24]

জয় জয় নিত্যানন্দ-চরণারবিন্দ ।
যাঁহা হৈতে পাইনু শ্রীরাধাগোবিন্দ ॥ ২০৪ ॥

jaya jaya nityānanda-caraṇāravinda
glory glory of Nityānanda to the lotus feet
yāṁhā haite pāinu śrī-rādhā-govinda
from which I attained Śrī Rādhā-Govinda

204 Glory, glory to the lotus feet of Nityānanda, through which I attained Śrī Rādhā-Govinda!

Anubhāṣya.
Śrīla Narottama Ṭhākura sings in his *Prārthanā*: "When will Nitāi-cāṅd be merciful to me? When will worldly desires become trifling to me? When will my mind give up the objects of the senses and become pure? When will I see Śrī Vṛndāvana? When will an ardent longing for the feet of Rūpa and Raghunātha awaken in me? When will I understand the love of the Divine Couple?" And again: "Without such a Nitāi, brothers, Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa cannot be attained. Hold fast to the feet of Nitāi."

The author's words of humility —

জগাই মাধাই হৈতে মুঞি সে পাপিষ্ঠ ।
পুরীষের কীট হৈতে মুঞি সে লঘিষ্ঠ ॥ ২০৫ ॥

jagāi mādhāi haite muñi se pāpiṣṭha
Jagāi Mādhāi than I am more sinful
purīṣera kīṭa haite muñi se laghiṣṭha
of excrement the worm than I am lower

205 I am more sinful than Jagāi and Mādhāi, lower than a worm in excrement.

মোর নাম শুনে যেই তার পুণ্য ক্ষয় ।
মোর নাম লয় যেই তার পাপ হয় ॥ ২০৬ ॥

mora nāma śune yei tāra puṇya kṣaya
my name hears whoever his piety is destroyed
mora nāma laya yei tāra pāpa haya
my name takes whoever his sin there is

206 Whoever hears my name loses his piety; whoever utters my name commits sin.

এমন নির্ঘৃণ মোরে কেবা কৃপা করে ।
এক-নিত্যানন্দ বিনু জগৎ ভিতরে ॥ ২০৭ ॥

emana nirghṛṇa more kebā kṛpā kare
such despicable me who mercy shows
eka-nityānanda vinu jagat bhitare
one Nityānanda except of the world within

207 Who in all the world but Nityānanda alone would show mercy to one as despicable as I?

The author tells of Nityānanda's mercy to himself —

প্রেমে মত্ত নিত্যানন্দ কৃপা-অবতার ।
উত্তম, অধম, কিছু না করে বিচার ॥ ২০৮ ॥

preme matta nityānanda kṛpā-avatāra
with love intoxicated Nityānanda of mercy the avatāra
uttama, adhama, kichu nā kare vicāra
high low any not makes distinction

208 Intoxicated with love, Nityānanda is the avatāra of mercy; He makes no distinction between the high and the low.

যে আগে পড়য়ে, তারে করয়ে নিস্তার ।
অতএব নিস্তারিলা মো-হেন দুরাচার ॥ ২০৯ ॥

ye āge paḍaye, tāre karaye nistāra
who before (Him) falls him He makes deliverance
ataeva nistārilā mo-hena durācāra
therefore He delivered like me a sinner

209 He delivers whoever falls before Him; and so He delivered even a sinner like me.

মো-পাপিষ্ঠে আনিলেন শ্রীবৃন্দাবন ।
মো-হেন অধমে দিলা শ্রীরূপচরণ ॥ ২১০ ॥

mo-pāpiṣṭhe ānilena śrī-vṛndāvana
me most sinful He brought to Śrī Vṛndāvana
mo-hena adhame dilā śrī-rūpa-caraṇa
like me to the lowly He gave Śrī Rūpa's feet

210 He brought me, the most sinful, to Śrī Vṛndāvana, and to one as low as I He gave the feet of Śrī Rūpa.

By Nityānanda's mercy the author attains the service of Śrī Madana-mohana —

শ্রীমদনগোপাল-শ্রীগোবিন্দ-দরশন ।
কহিবার যোগ্য নহে এসব কথন ॥ ২১১ ॥

śrī-madana-gopāla-śrī-govinda-daraśana
Śrī Madana-Gopāla's Śrī Govinda's sight
kahibāra yogya nahe esaba kathana
to tell fit is not all this account

211 The sight of Śrī Madana-Gopāla and Śrī Govinda — all this is not fit to be told.

Śrī Madana-Gopāla, the companion of Śrī Rādhā —

বৃন্দাবন-পুরন্দর শ্রীমদনগোপাল ।
রাসবিলাসী সাক্ষাৎ ব্রজেন্দ্রকুমার ॥ ২১২ ॥

vṛndāvana-purandara śrī-madana-gopāla
of Vṛndāvana the lord Śrī Madana-Gopāla
rāsa-vilāsī sākṣāt vrajendra-kumāra
the enjoyer of the rāsa directly of the king of Vraja the son

212 Śrī Madana-Gopāla is the lord of Vṛndāvana, the enjoyer of the rāsa dance, the son of the king of Vraja Himself.

শ্রীরাধা-ললিতা-সঙ্গে রাস-বিলাস ।
মন্মথ-মন্মথরূপে যাঁহার প্রকাশ ॥ ২১৩ ॥

śrī-rādhā-lalitā-saṅge rāsa-vilāsa
with Śrī Rādhā Lalitā together the rāsa pastime
manmatha-manmatha-rūpe yāṁhāra prakāśa
of Cupid the enchanter in the form whose manifestation

213 With Śrī Rādhā and Lalitā He dances the rāsa, appearing in a form that enchants even Cupid.

(Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, Canto 10, Chapter 32, verse 2)

তাসামাবিরভূচ্ছৌরিঃ স্ময়মানমুখাম্বুজঃ ।
পীতাম্বরধরঃ স্রগ্বী সাক্ষান্মন্মথমন্মথঃ ॥ ২১৪ ॥

tāsām āvirabhūc chauriḥ
among them appeared Śauri
smayamāna-mukhāmbujaḥ
smiling lotus-faced
pītāmbara-dharaḥ sragvī
yellow garments wearing garlanded
sākṣān manmatha-manmathaḥ
directly of Cupid the enchanter

214 "Among them appeared Śauri (Kṛṣṇa), His lotus face smiling, wearing yellow garments and a garland — the very enchanter of Cupid." (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam, 10.32.2)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

In the rāsa pastime the gopīs bitterly lamented in separation. Suddenly Madana-mohana Himself appeared among them — in yellow garments, with a garland of forest flowers, and with a smile on His face.

Anubhāṣya.

During the rāsa dance Kṛṣṇa disappeared. The gopīs, longing to see Śrī Kṛṣṇa, lost all composure and wept. Then Govindadeva appeared before the cowherd women.

tāsām (among those gopīs, worn out with sorrow) **smayamāna-mukhāmbujaḥ** (He whose lotus face was smiling), **pītāmbara-dharaḥ** (wearing yellow garments), **sragvī** (wearing a garland), **sākṣāt manmatha-manmathaḥ** (He whose form enchants Kāmadeva himself) — **śauriḥ** (Kṛṣṇa) **āvirabhūt** (appeared).

স্বমাধুর্য্যে লোকের মন করে আকর্ষণ ।
দুই পাশে রাধা-ললিতা করেন সেবন ॥ ২১৫ ॥

sva-mādhurye lokera mana kare ākarṣaṇa
by His own sweetness of people the minds makes attraction
dui pāśe rādhā-lalitā karena sevana
on both sides Rādhā Lalitā render service

215 By His own sweetness He draws the minds of all, and on either side Rādhā and Lalitā serve Him.

নিত্যানন্দ-দয়া মোরে তাঁরে দেখাইল ।
শ্রীরাধা-মদনমোহনে প্রভু করি' দিল ॥ ২১৬ ॥

nityānanda-dayā more tāṁre dekhāila
Nityānanda's mercy to me Him showed
śrī-rādhā-madana-mohane prabhu kari' dila
Śrī Rādhā-Madanamohana as Lord making gave

216 Nityānanda's mercy showed Him to me and gave me Śrī Rādhā and Madanamohana as my Lady and Lord.

By Nityānanda's mercy the author attains the service of Śrī Govinda —

মো-অধমে দিল শ্রীগোবিন্দ দরশন ।
কহিবার কথা নহে অকথ্য-কথন ॥ ২১৭ ॥

mo-adhame dila śrī-govinda daraśana
to me the lowly gave of Śrī Govinda the sight
kahibāra kathā nahe akathya-kathana
to tell a matter is not the indescribable telling

217 To me, so lowly, He gave the sight of Śrī Govinda. It is not a thing to be told; it is beyond all telling.

Śrī Rādhā-Govinda beneath the desire tree, served by the sakhīs —

বৃন্দাবনে যোগপীঠে কল্পতরু-বনে ।
রত্নমণ্ডপ, তাহে রত্নসিংহাসনে ॥ ২১৮ ॥

শ্রীগোবিন্দ বসিয়াছেন ব্রজেন্দ্রনন্দন ।
মাধুর্য্য প্রকাশি' করেন জগৎ মোহন ॥ ২১৯ ॥

vṛndāvane yoga-pīṭhe kalpa-taru-vane
in Vṛndāvana at Yogapīṭha of wish-fulfilling trees in the grove
ratna-maṇḍapa, tāhe ratna-siṁhāsane
a jewelled pavilion there on a jewelled throne
śrī-govinda vasiyāchena vrajendra-nandana
Śrī Govinda is seated of the king of Vraja the son
mādhurya prakāśi' karena jagat mohana
sweetness manifesting makes of the world enchantment

218–219 In Vṛndāvana, at Yogapīṭha, in a grove of wish-fulfilling trees, there is a pavilion of jewels, and there on a jewelled throne sits Śrī Govinda, the son of the king of Vraja. Revealing His sweetness, He enchants the whole world.

বাম-পার্শ্বে শ্রীরাধিকা সখীগণ-সঙ্গে ।
রাসাদিক-লীলা প্রভু করে কত রঙ্গে ॥ ২২০ ॥

vāma-pārśve śrī-rādhikā sakhī-gaṇa-saṅge
on the left side Śrī Rādhikā with Her friends together
rāsādika-līlā prabhu kare kata raṅge
the rāsa and other pastimes the Lord makes with how many joys

220 On His left is Śrī Rādhikā with Her friends, and with them the Lord delights in the rāsa and so many other pastimes.

The one Brahmā worships — the Deity to whom the eighteen-syllable mantra is addressed —

যাঁর ধ্যান নিজ-লোকে করে পদ্মাসন ।
অষ্টাদশাক্ষর-মন্ত্রে করে উপাসন ॥ ২২১ ॥

yāṁra dhyāna nija-loke kare padmāsana
on whom meditation in his own world makes the lotus-seated
aṣṭādaśākṣara-mantre kare upāsana
with the eighteen-syllable mantra makes worship

221 In his own world Brahmā, who sits on the lotus, meditates on Him and worships Him with the eighteen-syllable mantra.

Anubhāṣya.

Brahmā, who sits on the lotus, together with the residents of his own world, Brahmaloka, meditates on the form of Govinda, the Deity to whom the mantra is addressed (*abhidheya-vigraha*). This Govinda, on whom the residents of the fourteen worlds meditate, is worshipped with the eighteen-syllable mantra.

চৌদ্দভুবনে যাঁর সবে করে ধ্যান ।
বৈকুণ্ঠাদি-পুরে যাঁর লীলাগুণ গান ॥ ২২২ ॥

caudda-bhuvane yāṁra sabe kare dhyāna
in the fourteen worlds on whom all make meditation
vaikuṇṭhādi-pure yāṁra līlā-guṇa gāna
in Vaikuṇṭha and other abodes whose pastimes qualities singing

222 All the fourteen worlds meditate on Him, and in Vaikuṇṭha and the other abodes they sing of His pastimes and qualities.

যাঁর মাধুরীতে করে লক্ষ্মী আকর্ষণ ।
রূপগোসাঞি করিয়াছেন সে-রূপ বর্ণন ॥ ২২৩ ॥

yāṁra mādhurīte kare lakṣmī ākarṣaṇa
whose by the sweetness makes Lakṣmī attraction
rūpa-gosāñi kariyāchena se-rūpa varṇana
Rūpa Gosāñi has made of that form description

223 His sweetness attracts even Lakṣmī. Rūpa Gosāñi has described that form:

Anubhāṣya.

Ādi 4.147: "Kṛṣṇa's sweetness has a natural power: it makes all men and women restless, beginning with Kṛṣṇa Himself."

In Śrī Rūpa Prabhu's *Laghu-bhāgavatāmṛta*, where the supremacy of Kṛṣṇa's sweetness is described (sections 351–352), a story from the *Padma Purāṇa* is retold: "Lakṣmī-devī saw the sweetness of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, longed for it, and began to perform austerities. Śrī Kṛṣṇa asked her, 'Why are you performing austerities?' Lakṣmī replied, 'I wish to enjoy pastimes with You in Vṛndāvana in the form of a gopī.' Śrī Kṛṣṇa said, 'That is very hard to attain.' Lakṣmī spoke again: 'O Lord,

then I wish to stay on Your chest like a golden line.' And Śrī Kṛṣṇa said, 'So be it.' Since then Lakṣmī has remained on Kṛṣṇa's chest as a golden line." In the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* (10.16.36) the wives of the serpent say: "Lakṣmī is the most beautiful of all, and yet she longed for the dust of Your feet. For its sake she gave up all desires, took vows, and performed austerities for a long time."

(Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, Eastern Division, second wave — sādhana-bhakti, verse 239)

স্মেরাং ভঙ্গীত্রয়পরিচিতাং সাচিবিস্তীর্ণদৃষ্টিং
বংশীন্যস্তাধরকিশলয়ামুজ্জ্বলাং চন্দ্রকেণ ৷
গোবিন্দাখ্যাং হরিতনুমিতঃ কেশিতীর্থোপকণ্ঠে
মা প্রেক্ষিষ্ঠাস্তব যদি সখে বন্ধুসঙ্গেঽস্তি রঙ্গঃ ॥ ২২৪ ॥

smerāṁ bhaṅgī-traya-paricitāṁ sāci-vistīrṇa-dṛṣṭiṁ
smiling by three bends marked sidelong wide glance
vaṁśī-nyastādhara-kiśalayām ujjvalāṁ candrakeṇa
on the flute placed lips tender as shoots radiant with a peacock feather
govindākhyāṁ hari-tanum itaḥ keśi-tīrthopakaṇṭhe
Govinda named Hari's form here Keśī-tīrtha near
mā prekṣiṣṭhās tava yadi sakhe bandhu-saṅge 'sti raṅgaḥ
do not look of you if O friend for relatives' company there is fondness

224 "O friend, if you still care for the company of your relatives, do not look at that form of Hari called Govinda, standing here by Keśī-tīrtha: He smiles, His body bends in three places, His wide glance falls sidelong, His lips, tender as new shoots, rest upon the flute, and a peacock feather makes Him radiant." (Bhakti-rasāmṛta-sindhu, 1.2.239)

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

O friend, if you cherish the company of your relatives, do not look at the form of Govinda near Keśī-ghāṭa. He is gently smiling, His body is bent in three places, and He casts sidelong glances to the left. The flute rests on His lips, tender as young lotus shoots, and a peacock feather lends Him wondrous beauty. The meaning is this: whoever sees the form of Śrī Govinda will lose all attraction for anything else.

Anubhāṣya.

sakhe (O friend), **yadi tava bandhu-saṅge** (in the company of those attached to sons, wife, and other worldly things) **raṅgaḥ** (interest) **asti** (there is), [then] **itaḥ** (here) **keśi-tīrthopakaṇṭhe** (near Keśī-tīrtha on the bank of the Yamunā) **smerām** (smiling), **bhaṅgī-traya-paricitām** (bent in three places — at the neck, the waist, and the knees), **sāci-vistīrṇa-dṛṣṭim** (casting wide sidelong glances), **vaṁśī-nyastādhara-kiśalayām** (whose lips, tender as young shoots, are placed on the flute), **candrakeṇa** (with a peacock feather) **ujjvalām** (shining, full of supreme beauty) **govindākhyām** (named Govinda) **hari-tanum** (the form of Hari, the son of Nanda) **mā prekṣiṣṭhāḥ** (do not look at). (Under the guise of a prohibition, it is said here that this form, the abode of supreme beauty, must certainly be seen. Once you taste His sweetness, you will think everything else worthless. Therefore look at Him alone — that is the intent.)

To see mundane stone, wood, or metal in the transcendental Deity is a grave offence —

সাক্ষাৎ ব্রজেন্দ্রসুত ইথে নাহি আন ।
যেবা অজ্ঞে করে তাঁরে প্রতিমা-হেন জ্ঞান ॥ ২২৫ ॥

sākṣāt vrajendra-suta ithe nāhi āna
directly of the king of Vraja the son in this there is no other
yebā ajñe kare tāṁre pratimā-hena jñāna
whoever the fool makes of Him like an image the notion

225 He is the son of the king of Vraja Himself — of this there is no doubt. The fool who thinks of Him as a mere image

সেই অপরাধে তার নাহিক নিস্তার ।
ঘোর নরকেতে পড়ে, কি বলিব আর ॥ ২২৬ ॥

sei aparādhe tāra nāhika nistāra
for that offence his there is no deliverance
ghora narakete paḍe, ki baliba āra
terrible into hell falls what shall I say more

226 has no deliverance for that offence; he falls into a terrible hell. What more can I say?

Anubhāṣya.

The *Bhakti-sandarbha* (section 286) says: "The highest worshippers see the Deity as none other than the Supreme Lord Himself. For as soon as the idea of difference arises, bhakti is broken; therefore only this is proper."

The highest worshippers see the Deity (*śrī-mūrti*) as the Supreme Lord Himself. If one considers Bhagavān's Deity different from Bhagavān, bhakti is broken. Therefore one must regard the Deity as Bhagavān Himself. Once fallen from bhakti, the jīva becomes a nondevotee and falls into offences. A verse of the *Padma Purāṇa* says: "One who sees stone in the worshipable Viṣṇu … is a dweller in hell." By its meaning, a jīva who thinks that the form of Śrī Viṣṇu is made of material substance, or is only a symbol (*pratīka*), earns the name *nārakī*, a dweller in hell. The impersonalists are deprived of seeing the Deity with eyes of love, and their vision is mundane. Therefore Vaiṣṇavas call them "offensive Māyāvādīs." And the *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam*, in the verse *yasyātma-buddhiḥ* ("one who takes [the body] as the self…"),[25] says that a person with such notions as *bhauma ijya-dhīḥ* ("regarding earthly things as worshipable") does not gain eligibility for service, because of his ignorance.

হেন যে গোবিন্দ প্রভু, পাইনু যাঁহা হৈতে ।
তাঁহার চরণ-কৃপা কে পারে বর্ণিতে ॥ ২২৭ ॥

hena ye govinda prabhu, pāinu yāṁhā haite
such that Govinda the Lord I attained from whom
tāṁhāra caraṇa-kṛpā ke pāre varṇite
His feet's mercy who can describe

227 Through Him I attained such a Lord as Govinda — who can describe the mercy of His feet?

To be a Vaiṣṇava is to worship Rādhā-Govinda under the shelter of Nityānanda

and Gaura —

বৃন্দাবনে বৈসে যত বৈষ্ণব-মণ্ডল ।
কৃষ্ণনাম-পরায়ণ, পরম-মঙ্গল ॥ ২২৮ ॥

vṛndāvane vaise yata vaiṣṇava-maṇḍala
in Vṛndāvana dwell all Vaiṣṇava circles
kṛṣṇa-nāma-parāyaṇa, parama-maṅgala
to Kṛṣṇa's name devoted supremely auspicious

228 All the circles of Vaiṣṇavas who dwell in Vṛndāvana are devoted to the name of Kṛṣṇa and are supremely auspicious.

যাঁর প্রাণধন — নিত্যানন্দ-শ্রীচৈতন্য ।
রাধাকৃষ্ণ-ভক্তি বিনে নাহি জানে অন্য ॥ ২২৯ ॥

yāṁra prāṇa-dhana — nityānanda-śrī-caitanya
whose of life the treasure Nityānanda-Śrī Caitanya
rādhā-kṛṣṇa-bhakti vine nāhi jāne anya
to Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa devotion except not know anything else

229 Nityānanda and Śrī Caitanya are the treasure of their lives; they know nothing but devotion to Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa.

Anubhāṣya.

All the Vaiṣṇavas who live in Śrī Vṛndāvana bring supreme good. They are devoted to Kṛṣṇa's name and have taken shelter of the bhakti called *kīrtana*. The treasure of their lives is Śrī Gaura-Nityānanda. Apart from the eternal service of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, they know no other, invented bhakti. But nowadays some abandon the worship of the pure devotees of old and devise new paths! Some say, "Whether Śrī Gaurāṅga is Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa or not, we like His name Gaura; the name Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa does not give us as much taste." Others hold that "Gaura-bhakti" is worshipping Gaura in *madhura-rasa* (*sambhoga*) in the mood of "Nadīyā-nāgarī"! If, they say, Gaura is not worshipped in the mood of a *nāgarī*, what is the point of Śrī Gaurāṅga's separate avatāra? Such wicked views did not exist before. But as Kali grows, such grotesque ideas are spreading under the garb of Vaiṣṇavas, and the pure devotees grieve to see it. These people have become playthings of insurmountable māyā and consider Śrī Gaurāṅga a little greater than Śrī Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa. They reason:

“Gaurāṅga is the united body of Rādhā and Kṛṣṇa, and so He is greater than Kṛṣṇa alone.” Others again bow at the feet of the mundane *smārtas* and the society of *pañcopāsakas*; they oppose Gaura, Gaura’s abode, Gaura’s *śakti*, and devotion to Gaura, and they invent the worship of Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa by the power of knowledge born of the material senses. Both these groups oppose the pure teaching of the six Gosvāmīs. They therefore lack devotion to Bhagavān; they are given to the senses, godless, and servants of Kali. Śrī Kavirāja Gosvāmī, all-seeing and all-knowing, foresaw this: in the future, proud people averse to Hari will try by force of imagination to pass themselves off as most dear to Śrī Gaurasundara. They will forget the real Gaura, abandon devotion to Rādhā-Kṛṣṇa, and extol a Gaura of their own invention, born from the womb of their wicked desires, to deceive unfortunate jīvas. Needless to say, in truth the only object of worship for those who have taken shelter at the feet of Śrī Gaurāṅga is the two feet of Śrī Gāndharvikā-Giridhārī.

Only by Nityānanda’s mercy does one attain the lotus feet of the Vaiṣṇavas —

সে বৈষ্ণবের পদরেণু, তার পদছায়া ।
অধমেরে দিল প্রভুনিত্যানন্দ-দয়া ॥ ২৩০ ॥

se vaiṣṇavera pada-reṇu, tāra pada-chāyā
of those Vaiṣṇavas the dust of the feet their feet’s shade
adhamere dila prabhu-nityānanda-dayā
to the lowly one gave of Lord Nityānanda the mercy

230 The dust of those Vaiṣṇavas’ feet and the shelter of their shade — this the mercy of Lord Nityānanda gave to me, the lowly one.

‘তাঁহা সর্ব্ব লভ্য হয়’ — প্রভুর বচন ।
সেই সূত্র, এই তার কৈল বিবরণ ॥ ২৩১ ॥

‘tāṁhā sarva labhya haya’ — prabhura vacana
there all attainable is the Lord’s words
sei sūtra, ei tāra kaila vivaraṇa
that the sūtra this of it I have made the explanation

231 “There everything can be attained” — these words of the Lord are the sūtra, and this is my explanation of it.

Anubhāṣya.

In Vṛndāvana the author wrote *Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta* at the order of the Vaiṣṇavas, but the root and source of this work is Nitāi's merciful order. See Ādi 5.196.[26]

By Nityānanda's mercy all desires are fulfilled —

সে সব পাইনু আমি বৃন্দাবনে আয় ।
সেই সব লভ্য এই প্রভুর কৃপায় ॥ ২৩২ ॥

se saba pāinu āmi vṛndāvane āya
that all attained I to Vṛndāvana coming
sei saba labhya ei prabhura kṛpāya
that all attained by this Lord's mercy

232 All this I attained when I came to Vṛndāvana, and all of it I attained by the mercy of this Lord.

Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya.

Āya means having come.

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the "Amṛta-pravāha-bhāṣya."

আপনার কথা লিখি নির্লজ্জ হইয়া ।
নিত্যানন্দগুণে লেখায় উন্মত্ত করিয়া ॥ ২৩৩ ॥

āpanāra kathā likhi nirlajja haiyā
my own story I write shameless becoming
nityānanda-guṇe lekhāya unmatta kariyā
Nityānanda's qualities make me write mad making

233 Shamelessly I write my own story: Nityānanda's qualities have made me mad and make me write.

নিত্যানন্দ-প্রভুর গুণ-মহিমা অপার ।
'সহস্রবদনে' শেষ নাহি পায় যাঁর ॥ ২৩৪ ॥

nityānanda-prabhura guṇa-mahimā apāra
of Nityānanda Prabhu's of qualities the glory boundless
'sahasra-vadane' śeṣa nāhi pāya yāṁra
with a thousand mouths Śeṣa (the end) not finds of which

234 The glory of Nityānanda Prabhu's qualities is boundless: even Śeṣa with His thousand mouths cannot reach its end.

Anubhāṣya.
See Madhya 21.10 and 12, and *Bhāgavatam* 2.7.41 and 10.14.7.

Thus ends the fifth chapter of the "Anubhāṣya."

শ্রীরূপ-রঘুনাথ-পদে যাঁর আশ ।
চৈতন্যচরিতামৃত কহে কৃষ্ণদাস ॥ ২৩৫ ॥

śrī-rūpa-raghunātha-pade yāṁra āśa
Śrī Rūpa's, Raghunātha's at the feet whose hope
caitanya-caritāmṛta kahe kṛṣṇadāsa
"Caitanya-caritāmṛta" narrates Kṛṣṇadāsa

235 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Śrī Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, narrate the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.

Notes

1. The same verse as Ādi 1.7. ↩
2. The same verse as Ādi 1.8. ↩
3. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «নাহিক নিয়ম» (another reading: «নাহি তাঁর সীমা»). ↩
4. The same verse as Ādi 1.9. ↩
5. The same verse as Ādi 2.67. ↩
6. The same verse as Ādi 2.55. ↩
7. The same verse as Ādi 1.10. ↩
8. The same verse as Ādi 1.11. ↩
9. The Gauḍīya Maṭha edition reads «অধম জীবেরে চড়াইল ঊর্দ্ধ সীমা» ("He raised a fallen soul to the highest limit"), with the heading "The greatness of Nityānanda's

mercy shown by the author's own story." Other editions read «যৈছে চড়াইল» ("how He raised…"). ↩

10. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «বসিয়া» ("sitting"; another reading: «আসিয়া», "having come"). ↩
11. As in the Gauḍīya Maṭha edition: «দন্তে» ("in the teeth"; another reading: «দন্ত»). ↩
12. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.1.31. ↩
13. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 2.6.43–45. ↩
14. The edition reads *loka-draṣṭā* ("who beholds the worlds"); the verse has *loka-sraṣṭuḥ* ("of the creator of the worlds"). Possibly a misprint. ↩
15. The verse translation reads differently: the knowledge that the avatāra and the source of the avatāras are nondifferent is ascribed to those who know the truth; Bhaktivinoda calls "one who sees no difference" the person who confuses them. ↩
16. The verse translation reads differently: it takes kadamba as the kadamba flower ("like kadamba blossoms"). ↩
17. Skt. *tantreṇa*, a grammatical term: one and the same word read in two senses at once. The edition's Bengali paraphrase below takes it as "in the *tantra* scriptures." ↩
18. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 7.1.31. ↩
19. The words of the Earth to Dharma: *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 1.16.30 (the edition has "the first chapter of the first canto"). ↩
20. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.39.55. ↩
21. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.1.24. ↩
22. Caitanya-caritāmṛta, Antya 4.219–221 (in the verse numbering of the translation used in this edition). ↩
23. *Vilāpa-kusumāñjali* 6. ↩
24. The edition cites Antya 4.224; in the verse numbering of the translation used here the passage is verses 223–224. ↩
25. *Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam* 10.84.13. ↩
26. Cf. verses 195–196: in 195 Nityānanda tells the author to go to Vṛndāvana; in 196 He sends him off with a gesture of His hand and disappears. ↩